

Ashby, Massachusetts
Annual Reports | 2024



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The Ashby First Parish Unitarian Universalist Church, Ashby, MA.*

ANNUAL REPORTS

For the Year
2024



TOWN OF ASHBY
MASSACHUSETTS

Accountant	7
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USEFUL DEFINITIONS

AVAILABLE FUNDS - Free cash, reserves, and unexpected balances available for appropriation.

CHAPTER 90 - General Law which provides for contributions by the State for construction and maintenance of certain town roads; usually roads leading from one town to another.

CHERRY SHEET - Details of State and County charges and reimbursements used in determining the tax rate; known as “Cherry Sheet” due to color of the paper originally used.

ESTIMATED RECEIPTS - Estimate of miscellaneous receipts based on previous year’s receipts deducted by the Assessors from gross amount to be raised by taxation.

FREE CASH - Amount certified by the Department of Revenue determined by any excess revenue and unexpended appropriations of the prior year.

MATCHING FUNDS - Amount made available by special State and Federal acts to supplement local appropriations for specific types of projects.

PROVISION FOR ABATEMENTS & EXEMPTIONS

(formerly OVERLAY) - Amount raised by Assessors for purpose of creating a fund to cover abatements granted.

PROVISION FOR ABATEMENTS & EXEMPTIONS SURPLUS

(formerly OVERLAY SURPLUS) - Excess determined by the Assessors (exceeding tax balance for that year) which may be voted for extra-ordinary or unforeseen purposes.

RESERVE FUND - Amount appropriated for unforeseen or emergency purposes, controlled exclusively by the Finance Committee.

SELECTBOARD

January – April

The year 2024 began with a significant change in town administration. This appointment marked a new chapter in Ashby's governance, promising more efficient and dedicated management of town affairs.

In February, Mary Daughraty was hired as the full-time Town Administrator and commenced her duties. The Selectboard demonstrated their commitment to addressing educational challenges by attending the North Middlesex Regional School District joint boards budget hearing. The meeting focused on rising costs, budget concerns, and the potential impact of an override.

April saw the re-election of Jessica Kallin to the Selectboard for a three-year term.

May – August

The Annual Town Meeting was scheduled for May 4, providing residents with the opportunity to participate in local decision-making.

The Selectboard introduced the use of CART (Communication Access Realtime Translation) services for town meetings, enhancing accessibility for all attendees

A notable improvement in civic engagement was implemented as Selectboard members began holding office hours on a rotating basis, with one member available each month. This initiative aimed to increase accessibility and communication between town officials and residents

A Special Town Meeting was held on August 20, addressing specific issues that required immediate attention from the town's residents

September – December

Following the failure of the override vote, the Selectboard and Town Administrator took decisive action to address the school district budget deficit. They implemented a multi-pronged approach, utilizing stabilization funds, maintaining a level-funded budget, and instituting a spending and hiring freeze for the 2024 calendar year.

On November 18, the Selectboard attended a North Middlesex Regional School District Public Forum. This meeting provided an opportunity to discuss the budget and decisions made to address rising costs, ensuring transparency and public involvement in these critical financial matters

The year concluded with another Special Town Meeting on December 3, allowing the town to address any remaining issues before the close of the year

Throughout 2024, the Town of Ashby demonstrated resilience and adaptability in

facing various challenges, particularly in education and fiscal management. The proactive measures taken by the Selectboard and the new Town Administrator reflect a commitment to maintaining services and addressing the needs of the town.

FINANCE COMMITTEE
No Report Submitted

ASHBY BOARD OF ASSESSORS

The Board of Assessors is responsible for the valuation of real estate and personal property subject to taxation. The Registry of Motor Vehicles is responsible for motor vehicle valuations and supplies the data for excise bills. Assessed values for Real and Personal Property are based on “full and fair cash value” as of the January 1st preceding each fiscal year.

The Assessors were able to successfully complete our 5 year recertification process with the Massachusetts Department of Revenue, thanks in large part to the help and cooperation of the taxpayers of the town, to whom we are grateful. As always, if you have any questions regarding any assessing issues, please feel free to contact the office at 978-386-2427 x15 or by email at assess@ashbyma.gov. The Assessors Clerk’s office hours are Mon-Thu 8:00am-Noon, Wed 5:00pm-8:00pm. Office hours for our Regional Assessor, Michael Saltsman of Regional Resource Group, are Thursday mornings from 9:00am to Noon. You can also reach Michael at other times by e-mail, msaltsman@rrgsystems.com, or by telephone at 978-218-6071. The Board of Assessors normally meets on the last Wednesday of the month at 4:30 PM.

Respectfully submitted by the Board of Assessors,

Charles Pernaa, <i>Chairman</i>	Harald Scheid, <i>Regional Tax Assessor</i>
Jeffery Childs, <i>Member</i>	Michael Saltsman, <i>Regional Tax Assessor</i>
Dorothea Rourke, <i>Member</i>	

Fiscal 2024 Assessments and Revenues by Major Class				
Property Class	Levy Percent	Valuations by Class	Tax Rate	Tax Levy
Residential	94.1415%	479,092,131	15.53	7,440,300.79
Commercial	2.5033 %	12,739,670	15.53	197,847.08
Industrial	0.2020%	1,028,200	15.53	15,967.95
Personal Property	3.1532%	16,046,576	15.53	249,203.33
TOTALS	100%	508,906,577	15.53	7,903,319.15

Historical Total Assessments and Property Tax Revenues

Fiscal Year	Tax Rate	Total Valuation	Accounts	Tax Levy	Changes %
2024	15.53	508,906,577	1,738	7,903,319.15	7.7848
2023	16.42	446,559,064	1,711	7,332,499.82	3.3703
2022	17.69	400,985,327	1,710	7,093,430.43	4.6698
2021	18.55	365,334,675	1,707	6,776,958.22	3.2270
2020	18.83	348,651,237	1,707	6,565,102.80	-8.9486
2019	21.93	328,788,414	1,698	7,210,329.92	19.6196
2018	20.17	298,845,721	1,704	6,027,718.20	6.5140
2017	20.83	271,679,626	1,711	5,659,086.61	4.3495
2016	20.10	269,811,112	1,712	5,423,203.35	3.0624

Fiscal Year 2024 Abstract of Assessments

Property Class Code/Description	Accounts	Class Valuation	Average Value
101 Residential Single Family	1,131	430,851,500	\$380,947
102 Residential Condominiums	0	0	0
012-043 Mixed Use Properties	14	31,507,119	\$2,250,509
104 Residential Two Family	15	5,372,500	\$358,167
105 Residential Three Family	2	1,051,400	\$525,700
103, 109 Miscellaneous Residential	8	1,143,500	\$142,938
111-125 Apartments	1	357,100	\$357,100
130-132, 106 Vacant Land	304	12,293,800	\$40,440
300-393 Commercial	20	7,789,400	\$389,470
400-442 Industrial	5	1,028,200	\$205,640
501-508 Personal Property	111	16,046,576	\$144,564
600-821 Chapter 61, 61A, 61B	127	1,465,482	\$11,539
Exempt 900's	135	23,106,800	\$171,161
TOTALS	1,873	523,013,377	

Assessor's Account for Exemptions and Abatements

Description	FY2024	FY2023	FY2022	FY2021	FY2020
Assessor's Overlay	98,348.52	100,155.02	98,260.07	89,672.79	91,066.80
Overlay Deficits	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	2,634.66
Charges to 6/30/2023	83,132.84	74,922.14	83,755.68	82,139.79	80,899.95
Potential Liability	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Total Balance	15,215.68	25,232.88	14,504.39	7,533.00	7,532.19

New Growth Revenue

Fiscal Year	Added Valuation	Tax Rate	New Revenues	Change %
2024	4,283,735	16.42	70,340	27.18
2023	3,126,501	17.69	55,308	-42.04

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2022	5,144,022	18.55	95,422	122.50
2021	2,277,517	18.83	42,886	-42.24
2020	3,385,550	21.93	74,245	21.17
2019	3,037,880	20.17	61,274	31.87
2018	2,230,812	20.83	46,467	43.12
2017	1,615,283	20.10	32,468	5.05
2016	1,570,475	19.68	30,908	-2.20
2015	1,654,636	19.10	31,604	-13.63

TREASURER

As of December 31, 2024, available cash was equal to \$2,043,301.10 and a total of \$64,367.21 was earned in interest from the general fund accounts.

The sum of \$63,484.10 was collected in tax title receipts and or foreclosure redemptions.

The following trust fund balances as of December 31, 2024 are:

Clock Fund	
John Forbes Memorial.....	\$1,568.78
School Funds	
Jesse Foster.....	\$1,303.53
Samuel P. Gates.....	\$26,024.25
Sumner Taylor.....	\$3,441.29
Cemetery Funds	
Sale of Lots	\$69,805.00
Perpetual Care	\$132,399.91
Rosanna Robbins.....	\$76,304.30
Open Space Acquisition Fund	\$634.63
Federal Forfeiture Fund.....	\$2,344.26
Stabilization Fund.....	\$453,428.65
Police-Law Enforcement Trust.....	\$2,429.23
Library Trust Funds	\$376,692.34
Memorial Trusts.....	\$6,010.36

Payments for the Public Safety Building long term borrowing began on 1/26/2024.

Respectfully submitted,
Kate E. Stacy, *Treasurer*

TAX COLLECTOR

These charts summarize calendar year 2024 collection activity.

Respectfully submitted,
Kate Stacy, *Collector*

COLLECTION ACTIVITY: January 1, 2024 - December 31, 2024		
Sum Total of "Turned-Over" Deposits		
2025	Real Estate Tax	3,796,108.59
2024	Real Estate Tax	4,029,968.49
2024	Real Estate Supplemental Tax	0.00
2024	Personal Property Tax	247,672.74
2023	Personal Property Tax	All Collected
2022	Personal Property Tax	All Collected
2021	Personal Property Tax	All Collected
2020	Personal Property Tax	All Collected
2024	Motor Vehicle Excise Tax	498,595.98
2023	Motor Vehicle Excise Tax	29,880.44
2022	Motor Vehicle Excise Tax	5,563.32
2021	Motor Vehicle Excise Tax	336.29
2020	Motor Vehicle Excise Tax	660.56
2019	Motor Vehicle Excise Tax	642.45
	Prior Year Excise Tax	0
	City of Fitchburg - In Lieu Of Tax	18,909.12
	Demand & Warrant Fees	12,551.47
	Deputy Notice & Service Fees	10,745.26
	RMV Non-renew al Mark Fees	7,747.37
	Municipal Lien Certificate Fees	1,675.00
	Duplicate Bill/Tax Service File Fees	1,117.00
	Title V Liens (amortized w /RE bill)	93.40
	CDBG Lien (full payoff)	0.00
	Chapter Rollback Penalty RE Tax	17,388.91
		\$ 8,679,656.39

COLLECTION ACTIVITY						
REAL ESTATE TAX BILLINGS (3 yrs) includes Title V & Supplemental Taxes						
	Balance on <u>1/1/2024</u>	Commitments <u>during 2024</u>	Payments (-) <u>Refunds (+)</u>	Exemptions (-) <u>Abatements (-)</u>	Transfer to <u>Tax Title (-)</u>	Balance on <u>12/31/2024</u>
FY 2025	0.00	3,879,457.05	3,796,108.59 0.00	0.00 0.00	0.00	83,348.46
FY 2024	4,101,055.51	0.00	4,030,061.89 29,202.02	50,452.13 12,436.24	37,277.63	29.64
FY 2023	0.00	0.00	0.00 0.00	0.00 0.00	0.00	0.00
PERSONAL PROPERTY TAX BILLINGS						
		<u>Commitments</u>	<u>Payments (-)</u>	<u>Abatements (-)</u>	<u>Refunds (+)</u>	Balance on <u>12/31/2024</u>
FY 2025		258,727.65	0.00	0.00	0.00	258,727.65
FY 2024	249,203.35	0.00	247,672.74	1,663.15	234.73	102.19
FY 2023	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
FY 2022	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
FY 2021	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
FY 2020	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
MOTOR VEHICLE EXCISE TAX BILLINGS (7yrs)						
		<u>Commitments</u>	<u>Payments (-)</u>	<u>Abatements (-)</u>	<u>Refunds (+)</u>	Balance on <u>12/31/2024</u>
FY 2024	0.00	529,893.03	498,595.98	9,289.27	8,180.42	30,188.20
FY 2023	40,103.75	0.00	29,880.44	1,451.20	1,541.45	10,313.56
FY 2022	15,027.38	0.00	5,563.32	108.75	108.75	9,464.06
FY 2021	4,350.74	0.00	336.29	0.00	0.00	4,014.45
FY 2020	3,905.82	0.00	660.56	0.00	0.00	3,245.26
FY 2019	2,573.53	0.00	642.45	0.00	0.00	1,931.08
FY 2018	1,039.69	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	1,039.69

ACCOUNTANT

ASHBY
Combined Balance Sheet - All Fund Types and Account Groups
as of June 30, 2024
(Unaudited)

ASSETS										
Cash and cash equivalents	1,985,861.49	1,127,785.04	154,486.36	3,253.70	1,283,169.53					4,554,556.12
Investments										0.00
Receivables:										
Personal property taxes	1,272.26									1,272.26
Real estate taxes	91,386.93									91,386.93
Allowance for abatements and exemptions	(105,545.25)									(105,545.25)
Tax liens	64,015.49									64,015.49
Deferred taxes	34,181.29									34,181.29
Motor vehicle excise	138,976.27									138,976.27
Rollback taxes	2,202.09									2,202.09
Departmental	68,383.28									68,383.28
Special assessments		425.50								425.50
Total Assets	2,280,733.85	1,128,210.54	154,486.36	3,253.70	1,283,169.53	6,552,161.50				11,402,015.48
LIABILITIES AND FUND EQUITY										
Liabilities:										
Warrants payable	217,516.55	50,527.94		2,147.37	4,707.00					274,898.86
Withholdings	103,001.65									103,001.65
Other liabilities	17.74									17.74
Deferred revenue:										
Real and personal property taxes	(12,886.06)									(12,886.06)
Tax liens	64,015.49									64,015.49
Deferred taxes	34,181.29									34,181.29
Motor vehicle excise	138,976.27									138,976.27
Rollback taxes	2,202.09									2,202.09
Departmental	68,383.28									68,383.28
Special assessments		425.50								425.50
Tallings	113.20									113.20
Agency Funds					12,749.92					12,749.92
Bonds payable						6,552,161.50				6,552,161.50
Total Liabilities	615,521.50	50,953.44	0.00	2,147.37	17,456.92	6,552,161.50				7,238,240.73
Fund Equity:										
Reserved for encumbrances	96,061.52									96,061.52
Reserved for expenditures				250.00						250.00
Reserved for continuing appropriations	56,166.13									56,166.13
Reserved for petty cash	404.46									404.46
Reserved for snow and ice deficit	(50,103.49)									(50,103.49)
Undesignated fund balance	1,562,683.73	1,077,257.10	154,486.36		1,265,712.61					4,060,139.80
Unreserved retained earnings				856.33						856.33
Total Fund Equity	1,665,212.35	1,077,257.10	154,486.36	1,106.33	1,265,712.61	0.00				4,163,774.75
Total Liabilities and Fund Equity	2,280,733.85	1,128,210.54	154,486.36	3,253.70	1,283,169.53	6,552,161.50				11,402,015.48

	REVENUE		FY24 ESTIMATE	FY24 ACTUAL	FY24 DIF
Acct #	TAXES & EXCISE				
110	Personal Property			\$249,701.33	249,701.33
120	Real Estate Taxation		\$7,654,115.82	\$7,531,789.94	-122,325.88
	Total Property Taxes:		\$7,654,115.82	\$7,781,491.27	127,375.45
	STATE AID				
800	Lottery		\$523,451.00	\$523,451.00	0.00
800	State Owned Land		\$186,712.00	\$186,712.00	0.00
800	Exemptions:Vets, Blind, Surv Spouse,Eld		\$33,242.00	\$3,514.00	-29,728.00
800	Veterans Benefit		\$14,112.00	\$7,094.47	-7,017.53
	Total State Aid		\$757,517.00	\$720,771.47	-36,745.53
	TAX LIENS				
	Tax Liens		0	\$37,620.44	37,620.44
	Foreclosures		0		0.00
	Total Tax Liens		0	\$37,620.44	37,620.44
	LOCAL RECEIPTS				
150	MV Excise		\$497,000.00	\$470,134.29	-26,865.71
170	Tax Interest		\$15,500.00	\$12,805.88	-2,694.12
170	MV Tax Interest		\$15,000.00	\$19,688.48	4,688.48
170	Tax Lien Interest		\$4,500.00	\$10,597.79	6,097.79
180	PILOT		\$18,000.00	\$18,909.12	909.12
	Penalties & Interest/MV Exercise		\$550,000.00	\$532,135.56	-17,864.44

	Licenses & Permits -				
122	Liquor		\$1,700.00	\$1,300.00	-400.00
122	Common Vic		\$0.00		0.00
122	Used Car		\$0.00	\$870.00	870.00
122	Video Licensing		\$0.00		0.00
161	Business License		\$600.00	\$480.00	-120.00
161	Raffle Permits		\$0.00	\$25.00	25.00
241	Building		\$72,500.00	\$34,440.00	-38,060.00
243	Gas and Plumbing		\$3,000.00	\$3,605.00	605.00
245	Electrical		\$7,300.00	\$7,960.00	660.00
510	Board of Health		\$1,200.00	\$813.00	-387.00
	Total Licenses and Permits		\$86,300.00	\$49,493.00	-36,807.00
	Fines & forfeitures				
772	Court Fines		\$6,900.00	\$18,934.54	12,034.54
161	Dog License Fines			\$670.00	670.00
800	RMV		\$2,000.00	\$8,931.96	6,931.96
	Total - Fines & Forfeitures		\$8,900.00	\$28,536.50	19,636.50
	Other Departmental Revenue				
422	Highway Miscellaneous		0	\$0.00	0.00
	Total Other Dept. Revenue:		0	\$0.00	0.00
	Miscellaneous				
623	Medicaid		\$16,000.00	\$14,384.00	-1,616.00
820	Bank Interest		\$34,500.00	\$77,637.96	43,137.96
	Total Miscellaneous:		\$50,500.00	\$92,021.96	41,521.96

	Charges for services				
232	Ambulance		\$150,000.00	\$133,270.44	-16,729.56
	Total chgs. For Services		\$150,000.00	\$133,270.44	-16,729.56
	Rentals				
122	Comm Tower Lease Payments		\$22,000.00	\$20,429.40	-1,570.60
122	Use - Occupancy Fees	0		\$1.00	1.00
	Total Rentals		\$22,000.00	\$20,430.40	-1,569.60
	Fees				
122	Cable			\$315.50	315.50
122	Cannabis Tax		\$136,000.00	\$103,920.50	-32,079.50
141	Board of Assessors-abuttor's list		\$0.00	\$80.00	80.00
145	Treasurer - Misc		\$2,300.00	\$300.00	-2,000.00
146	Collector		\$20,000.00	\$1,204.00	-18,796.00
146	Collector - Municipal Liens		\$1,500.00	\$2,150.00	650.00
161	Town Clerk Fees/Street Listings		\$250.00	\$383.00	133.00
161	Town Clerk Zoning By-laws			\$5.00	5.00
161	Town Clerk Dog License Fees		\$3,000.00	\$3,061.00	61.00
161	Town Clerk Early Voting			\$728.50	728.50
161	Town Clerk Misc Rcpts		\$1,800.00	\$1,732.63	-67.37
175	Planning Board		\$1,200.00	\$1,172.84	-27.16
176	Zoning Board of Appeals		\$500.00	\$0.00	-500.00
210	Police FID		\$2,000.00	\$2,387.50	387.50
210	Police Court		\$300.00	\$77.50	-222.50
210	Police Adm chrgs/Detail		\$2,500.00	\$4,613.00	2,113.00

210	Police-Misc		\$1,500.00	\$60.00	-1,440.00
220	Fire Smoke Detector		\$2,000.00	\$2,000.00	0.00
220	Fire-Fuel Storage		\$400.00	\$150.00	-250.00
220	Fire-Burn Permits		\$800.00	\$850.00	50.00
220	Fire-Propane		\$800.00	\$1,000.00	200.00
220	Fire-Tank Removal		\$0.00	\$250.00	250.00
220	Fire-Open Air		\$4,000.00	\$3,455.00	-545.00
220	Fire-Tank Install		\$100.00	\$50.00	-50.00
220	Fire-Misc		\$50.00	\$0.00	-50.00
610	Library-Misc			\$470.00	470.00
	Total Fees		\$181,000.00	\$130,415.97	-50,584.03
	Misc Non-recurring				
900	Misc Non-recurring		0	\$52,973.75	52,973.75
900	Sale of Fixed Assets		0		0.00
900	Insurance Recoveries		0		0.00
	Total Misc Non-recurring		0	\$52,973.75	52,973.75
	Total Local Receipts		\$1,048,700.00	\$1,039,277.58	-9,422.42
	TOTAL		\$9,460,332.82	\$9,579,160.76	118,827.94

[illegible]

Assessor Expense	01-5-141-520	1,700.00	0.00	1,700.00	564.10	1,135.90
Map Maintenance	01-5-141-535	5,800.00	0.00	5,800.00	6,150.59	-350.59
Assessors Software	01-5-141-545	4,175.00	0.00	4,175.00	4,104.67	70.33
Treasurer Salary	01-5-145-500	39,500.00	0.00	39,500.00	39,500.00	0.00
Treasurer Assist.	01-5-145-505	0.00	1,365.00	1,365.00	1,365.00	0.00
Treasurer Expense	01-5-145-520	6,970.00	0.00	6,970.00	5,539.95	1,430.05
Tax Title Expense	01-5-145-540	15,060.00	0.00	15,060.00	8,029.89	7,030.11
Collector Salary	01-5-146-500	37,500.00	0.00	37,500.00	37,500.00	0.00
Collector Wages	01-5-146-505	7,350.00	-1,365.00	5,985.00	3,335.00	2,650.00
Collector Expense	01-5-146-520	13,190.00	0.00	13,190.00	9,572.71	3,617.29
Collector Software	01-5-146-545	2,828.90	0.00	2,828.90	107.00	2,721.90
Legal Counsel Services	01-5-151-520	45,000.00	14,283.09	59,283.09	59,283.09	0.00
Technology & Systems	01-5-155-520	70,000.00	375.00	70,375.00	70,374.65	0.35
Town Clerk Salary	01-5-161-500	50,000.00	0.10	50,000.10	50,000.08	0.02
Asst. Town Clerk Wages	01-5-161-505	0.00	217.50	217.50	217.50	0.00
Elec and Reg Stipend	01-5-161-510	8,300.00	-217.60	8,082.40	4,586.25	3,496.15
Town Clerk Expense	01-5-161-520	4,000.00	0.00	4,000.00	2,852.44	1,147.56
Public Records Preservation	01-5-161-555	525.00	0.00	525.00	214.91	310.09
Elec and Reg Expense	01-5-161-558	7,375.00	0.00	7,375.00	6,803.24	571.76
Town Reports	01-5-163-520	2,500.00	0.00	2,500.00	1,965.05	534.95
Conservation Commission	01-5-171-520	1,150.00	0.00	1,150.00	954.50	195.50
Planning Board Expense	01-5-175-520	2,275.00	291.00	2,566.00	2,565.50	0.50
Zoning Board Expense	01-5-176-520	1,000.00	-291.00	709.00	0.00	709.00
Land Use Agent	01-5-177-500	11,000.00	0.00	11,000.00	3,690.00	7,310.00
Land Use Expense	01-5-177-520	700.00	0.00	700.00	23.00	677.00
Mont Plan Comm Assessment	01-5-177-560	1,157.15	0.00	1,157.15	1,157.15	0.00
T. Office Expense	01-5-192-520	25,150.00	7,058.00	32,208.00	32,207.80	0.20

T. Office Custodian	01-5-192-565	2,480.00	125.00	2,605.00	2,605.00	0.00
T. Office Fuel and Electric	01-5-192-590	21,400.00	10,892.00	32,292.00	32,291.68	0.32
Care of Town Clock	01-5-193-520	500.00	0.00	500.00	500.00	0.00
Municipal Grounds Wages	01-5-198-505	9,900.00	54.00	9,954.00	9,953.12	0.88
Municipal Building Repair	01-5-198-520	64,000.00	-54.00	63,946.00	63,641.51	304.49
TOTAL GENERAL GOVERNMENT		813,034.05	35,733.09	848,767.14	711,945.66	136,821.48
PROTECT PERSONS & PROP						
Police Chief Salary	01-5-210-500	101,000.00	-2,040.67	98,959.33	60,597.84	38,361.49
Police Wages	01-5-210-505	744,857.00	-63,847.55	681,009.45	681,009.15	0.30
Police Expense	01-5-210-520	101,950.00	65,888.22	167,838.22	82,514.65	85,323.57
Police Cruiser/Lease Purchase	01-5-210-600	20,000.00	0.00	20,000.00	20,298.25	-298.25
Public Safety Building Expenses	01-5-215-520	51,500.00	968.00	52,468.00	52,467.61	0.39
Fire Chief Salary	01-5-220-500	89,000.00	0.10	89,000.10	89,000.08	0.02
Firefighters' Wages	01-5-220-505	25,000.00	-2,835.00	22,165.00	22,165.00	0.00
Firefighter EMT Wages	01-5-220-508	95,425.00	19,435.36	114,860.36	114,860.36	0.00
Firefighter Stipends	01-5-220-510	12,000.00	376.00	12,376.00	12,376.00	0.00
Firefighter/EMT Overtime Wages	01-5-220-515	15,000.00	21,282.00	36,282.00	36,281.70	0.30
Fire Dept. Expenses	01-5-220-520	42,850.00	0.00	42,850.00	38,651.40	4,198.60
Fire Station-Equipment Replacement	01-5-220-610	47,000.00	0.00	47,000.00	39,028.00	7,972.00
Fire Station - Holes/Hydrants	01-5-220-635	3,500.00	0.00	3,500.00	3,146.00	354.00
EMT Wages	01-5-232-505	89,000.00	0.00	89,000.00	82,906.22	6,093.78
EMT Stipends	01-5-232-510	33,150.00	0.00	33,150.00	16,991.17	16,158.83
EMT Expense	01-5-232-520	32,750.00	0.00	32,750.00	27,752.83	4,997.17
EMS ALS Charges & Fees	01-5-232-615	35,000.00	0.00	35,000.00	34,001.65	998.35
Emergency Management Stipends	01-5-235-505	654.66	0.00	654.66	0.00	654.66
Emergency Management Expense	01-5-235-520	2,500.00	1,425.00	3,925.00	3,924.79	0.21

E-911 Expenses	01-5-238-520	175.00	0.00	175.00	175.00	0.00
Bldg/Zoning Insp Salary	01-5-241-500	19,723.00	0.00	19,723.00	19,723.00	0.00
Bldg/Zoning Insp Expense	01-5-241-520	300.00	0.00	300.00	23.00	277.00
Plumbing/Gas Inspect Salary	01-5-243-500	7,650.00	0.00	7,650.00	7,650.00	0.00
Plumbing/Gas Inspect Expense	01-5-243-520	150.00	75.00	225.00	225.00	0.00
Electrical Insp Salary	01-5-245-500	7,634.00	0.00	7,634.00	7,634.00	0.00
Electrical Insp Expense	01-5-245-520	900.00	0.00	900.00	0.00	900.00
Dog Off/Animal Enf Salary	01-5-292-500	16,651.00	0.00	16,651.00	16,651.00	0.00
Dog Off/Animal Enf Expense	01-5-292-520	1,400.00	0.00	1,400.00	0.00	1,400.00
Dispatcher Expenses	01-5-299-520	139,000.00	-968.00	138,032.00	78,811.82	59,220.18
TOTAL PROTECT PERS & PROP		1,735,719.66	39,758.46	1,775,478.12	1,548,865.52	226,612.60
EDUCATION						
Reg Voc Tech School Expense	01-5-300-560	392,887.00	0.32	392,887.32	392,887.32	0.00
NMRSD Reg School Assessment	01-5-305-560	4,088,383.00	0.00	4,088,383.00	3,848,969.00	239,414.00
NMRSD Reg. School Transportation	01-5-305-705	388,370.00	0.00	388,370.00	350,846.00	37,524.00
NMRSD Debt Service	01-5-305-710	610,221.00	0.00	610,221.00	565,106.00	45,115.00
TOTAL EDUCATION		5,479,861.00	0.32	5,479,861.32	5,157,808.32	322,053.00
PUBLIC WORKS AND FACILITIES						
Highway Super. Wages	01-5-422-500	75,000.00	0.00	75,000.00	74,084.00	916.00
Highway Department Wages	01-5-422-505	265,000.00	0.00	265,000.00	199,249.73	65,750.27
Highway Regular Overtime	01-5-422-515	9,000.00	0.00	9,000.00	7,786.32	1,213.68
Highway Department Expense	01-5-422-520	336,980.00	99,125.00	436,105.00	440,389.54	-4,284.54
Highway Dump Truck Lease	01-5-422-600	40,000.00	0.00	40,000.00	39,298.70	701.30
Hwy Winter Operation Overtime	01-5-423-515	13,000.00	0.00	13,000.00	36,475.62	-23,475.62
Highway Winter Expense	01-5-423-520	87,000.00	0.00	87,000.00	113,627.87	-26,627.87

Street Lights	01-5-424-520					0.00			0.00
Tree Warden Expenses	01-5-425-520					0.00			0.00
Cemetery Wages	01-5-491-505	15,000.00	-1,181.00			13,819.00	12,242.48		1,576.52
Cemetery Maintenance	01-5-491-520		1,181.00			1,181.00	1,180.22		0.78
TOTAL PUBLIC WORKS AND FAC.		840,980.00	99,125.00			940,105.00	924,334.48		15,770.52
HUMAN SERVICES									
Board of Health Expense	01-5-510-520	911.00	0.00			911.00	170.24		740.76
Town Nurse Assessment	01-5-510-560	4,908.44	0.00			4,908.44	4,908.44		0.00
Nashoba Board of Heath Assess	01-5-510-562	10,709.32	0.00			10,709.32	10,709.32		0.00
Landfill Operations	01-5-510-650	8,500.00	0.00			8,500.00	7,502.80		997.20
Animal Inspector	01-5-515-510	1,000.00	0.00			1,000.00	1,000.00		0.00
Animal Inspector-Expense	01-5-515-520	400.00	0.00			400.00	120.00		280.00
ATM 05/05/21 Art10 COA Coord.	01-5-541-122	14,460.00	140.00			14,600.00	14,599.49		0.51
Council on Aging Wages	01-5-541-505	21,750.00	-140.00			21,610.00	21,494.00		116.00
Council on Aging Expense	01-5-541-520	5,100.00	0.00			5,100.00	4,936.87		163.13
Veterans Agent Salary	01-5-543-500	2,058.94	0.00			2,058.94	0.00		2,058.94
Memorial Day	01-5-543-655	2,500.00	0.00			2,500.00	2,500.00		0.00
Veterans Benefit Expense	01-5-543-660	39,500.00	0.00			39,500.00	14,802.07		24,697.93
TOTAL HUMAN SERVICES		111,797.70	0.00			111,797.70	82,743.23		29,054.47
CULTURE AND RECREATION									
Librarian Salary	01-5-610-500	33,800.00	104.00			33,904.00	33,904.00		0.00
Library Assist. Wages	01-5-610-505	28,080.00	-460.00			27,620.00	26,613.75		1,006.25
Library Expenses	01-5-610-520	6,450.00	0.00			6,450.00	5,140.75		1,309.25
Library Custodial Services	01-5-610-565	330.00	0.00			330.00	189.57		140.43
Library Building Maintenance	01-5-610-595	22,475.00	356.00			22,831.00	24,256.68		-1,425.68

Library Books	01-5-610-665	22,222.00	0.00	22,222.00	22,244.57	-22.57
Band Concerts Details	01-5-630-505	1,450.00	0.00	1,450.00	213.56	1,236.44
Band Concerts	01-5-630-520	8,400.00	0.00	8,400.00	7,500.00	900.00
July 3rd Band Expense	01-5-632-520	1,200.00	0.00	1,200.00	1,200.00	0.00
TOTAL CULTURE AND REC		124,407.00	0.00	124,407.00	121,262.88	3,144.12
DEBT SERVICE			-			
Fire Truck Payment	01-5-710-700	52,232.00	0.50	52,232.50	52,232.47	0.03
LT Debt Principle	01-5-710-710	104,507.50	8,331.00	112,838.50	112,838.50	0.00
LT Debt Interest	01-5-751-710	149,962.50	0.00	149,962.50	149,962.50	0.00
ST Debt Interest	01-5-752-520	1,000.00	0.00	1,000.00	0.00	1,000.00
TOTAL DEBT SERVICE		307,702.00	8,331.50	316,033.50	315,033.47	1,000.03
INTERGOVERNMENTAL Expense						
RMV Non Renewal Surcharge	01-5-810-560	3,920.00	0.00	3,920.00	3,920.00	0.00
Air Pollution Assessment	01-5-811-560	933.00	0.00	933.00	933.00	0.00
Mont RTA Assessment	01-5-812-560	8,165.00	0.00	8,165.00	8,165.00	0.00
MBTA Trans Assessment	01-5-813-560	15,028.00	0.00	15,028.00	15,028.00	0.00
TOTAL INTERGOV EXP		28,046.00	0.00	28,046.00	28,046.00	0.00
MISCELLANEOUS Expense						
Middlesex Retirement System	01-5-911-560	254,095.00	0.00	254,095.00	254,095.00	0.00
Unemployment Compensation	01-5-913-520	15,000.00	-10,707.92	4,292.08	2,274.00	2,018.08
Employee Benefit Expense	01-5-914-520	683,627.12	-169,240.45	514,386.67	438,107.24	76,279.43
Workers Comp. Insurance	01-5-915-520	20,400.00	-7,584.00	12,816.00	7,802.00	5,014.00
Insurance-Liab, Prop &Caus, Fire Police	01-5-916-520	136,500.00	0.00	136,500.00	116,547.00	19,953.00

FICA	01-5-919-520	29,389.12	0.00	29,389.12	27,609.02	1,780.10
TOTAL MISCELLANEOUS EXP.		1,139,011.24	-187,532.37	951,478.87	846,434.26	105,044.61
SPECIAL ARTICLES						
FY18						
A2STM5/5/18Harris Rd Land	02-5-171-801	54,558.84	0.00	54,558.84	0.00	54,558.84
FY19						
Public Safety Bldg Design Art. 21	02-5-210-806	1,607.29	0.00	1,607.29	0.00	1,607.29
TOTAL SPECIAL ARTICLES		56,166.13	-5,902.28	56,166.13	0.00	56,166.13
TOTAL EXPENSES		10,795,687.77	-10,486.28	10,791,103.77	9,829,169.23	961,934.54

Town of Ashby
CHANGES IN FUND BALANCE FOR SPECIAL REVENUE FUNDS
July 1, 2023 - June 30, 2024

REVENUE CATEGORY	BEGINNING BALANCE	RECEIPTS	EXPENDED	TRANSFER IN/OUT	ENDING BALANCE
FEDERAL GRANTS - PUBLIC SAFETY					
FEMA - Covid 19 Grant	3,527.43	0.00	0.00	0.00	3,527.43
Fed. Assist to Firefighters Grant	-8,565.65	1,796.00	1,796.00		-8,565.65
Total Federal Public Safety Grants	-5,038.22	1,796.00	1,796.00	0.00	-5,038.22
FEDERAL GRANTS - OTHER					
State - Public Health Emerg Response Grant	922.50	0.00	0.00	0.00	922.50
ARPA	504,952.11	0.00	198,861.14		306,090.97
Total Federal - Other Grants	505,874.61	0.00	198,861.14	0.00	307,013.47
STATE GRANTS - TITLE V					
Septic Title V Grant	33,824.22	847.35	0.00	0.00	34,671.57
Total State - Title V Grants	33,824.22	847.35	0.00	0.00	34,671.57
OTHER SPECIAL REVENUE - GIFTS & DONATIONS					
Garden Club Donations	154.64	0.00	0.00	0.00	154.64
Marijuana Impact Fees	124,414.59	58,151.59	0.00	0.00	182,566.18
Marijuana Non Profit Donations	8,300.00	0.00	6,296.00	0.00	2,004.00
PEG Access Fund - Operating	307,267.82	32,079.47	195,219.94	0.00	144,127.35
PEG Access Capital	20,000.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	20,000.00
Centennial Commission	2,253.81	0.00	0.00	0.00	2,253.81
Police Dept Donation	909.46	0.00	0.00	0.00	909.46
Dog/Kennel Donations	55.37	0.00	0.00	0.00	55.37

Town Common Tree Donations		125.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	125.00
Council on Aging Donations		4,363.63	955.00	1,061.94	0.00	0.00	4,256.69
Allen Field Donations		584.69	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	584.69
Allen Field Playground Donations		229.34	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	229.34
Library - Donations/Gifts		5,377.16	238.13	800.00	0.00	0.00	4,815.29
Hist Commission - Old Fire House Donations		441.81	11.07	0.00	0.00	0.00	452.88
Other Spec Rev - Gifts & Donations		474,477.32	91,435.26	203,377.88	0.00	0.00	362,534.70
WETLANDS							
Conservation Wetland Act		32,275.14	687.50	91.77	0.00	0.00	32,870.87
Total State - Wetlands		32,275.14	687.50	91.77	0.00	0.00	32,870.87
REVOLVING FUNDS							
Cemetery Revolving Burial Fund		27,010.89	8,400.00	5,000.00	0.00	0.00	30,410.89
Fire 111F Revolving		936.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	936.00
Library - Book Fine Revolving Fund		119.09	39.00	158.09	0.00	0.00	0.00
Revolving Funds		28,065.98	8,439.00	5,158.09	0.00	0.00	31,346.89
OTHER SPECIAL REVENUE							
Insurance Proceeds		59,518.56	18,600.00	41,800.29	0.00	0.00	36,318.27
Landfill Operations/Monitor		13,805.50	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	13,805.50
Site Plan Review		702.75	0.00	702.75	0.00	0.00	0.00
RRA Transportation		18.70	6.70	0.00	0.00	0.00	25.40
Fire Insurance Reimburse							0.00
Nashoba Valley Healthcare Fund		11,620.14	0.00	4,799.00	0.00	0.00	6,821.14
CDBG 620		4,049.99	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	4,049.99
CDBG		164,224.21	2,739.38	0.00	0.00	0.00	166,963.59

Title V	17,050.74	93.40	0.00	0.00	0.00	17,144.14
Library ALA Transforming Communities	0.00	10,000.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	10,000.00
Library ARSL Grant	15,000.00	0.00	15,000.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Library MCC Grant	759.80	0.00	759.80	0.00	0.00	0.00
Library LTC Small Communities Grant	-127.77	20,000.00	17,556.82	0.00	0.00	2,315.41
Library Art for Everyone CFNCM Grant	0.00	2,000.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	2,000.00
Total - Other Spec Rev	286,622.62	53,439.48	80,618.66	0.00	0.00	259,443.44
STATE - PUBLIC SAFETY						
CSTF Grant FY22	0.00	78.71	0.00	0.00	0.00	78.71
DOJ Police Bulletproof vests Grant	2,750.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	2,750.00
Public Safety Grant	-1,750.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	-1,750.00
Fire- Senior Safe Grant	1,471.28	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	1,471.28
Fire AED Equipment Grant	179.50	12,480.31	12,480.31	0.00	0.00	179.50
Police bridge Training	3,000.00	0.00	3,000.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Police Edward J.B Memorial Grant	0.00	18,915.68	31,310.28	0.00	0.00	-12,394.60
Police Health Equity Partnership Grant	0.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
EMPG Grant	-2,839.44	2,700.00	2,700.00	0.00	0.00	-2,839.44
Fire Safety Equipment Grant	-12,141.06	0.00	19.69	0.00	0.00	-12,160.75
Training & EMD Grant	1,768.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	1,768.00
Fire VFA Forestry Grant	0.00	704.00	704.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
E-911 Dept Support & Inc Grant	13,220.95	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	13,220.95
Log Cabin Rd Fire	-140,045.11	137,717.13		2,327.98	0.00	0.00
Total State - Public Safety	-134,385.88	174,095.83	51,714.28	2,327.98	-9,676.35	
STATE GRANTS- PUBLIC WORKS						
Chapter 90 Funds	0.00	534,360.97	534,360.97	0.00	0.00	0.00
Winter Road Recovery Grant	0.22	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.22

Shared Streets Grant							0.00
Total State - Public Works							0.22
STATE GRANTS - CULTURE & RECREATION							
Arts Lottery Council - Cultural Council Grant							6,278.59
Total State Grants - Culture & Recreation							6,278.59
STATE GRANT - COUNCIL ON AGING							
Council on Aging Grant							11,977.53
Council on Aging Earmark Grant							4,983.39
State Grant - Council on Aging							16,960.92
STATE GRANT - LIBRARY							
State Aid to Libraries							16,119.49
Total State Grants - Library							16,119.49
STATE GRANTS - OTHER							
Town Clerk - State Extended Polling							4,469.17
Small Communities Conservation Assistance							9,844.33
Community Compact Grant							100.00
Community Compact IT Grant							0.00
Green Community Funding							10,093.02
Recycling Dividend							224.99
Total State Grants - Other							24,731.51
Total All							1,077,257.10

Town of Ashby
COMBINING BALANCE SHEET - ALL CAPITAL PROJECT FUNDS
30-Jun-24

	LANDFILL CLOSURE
	PUBLIC SAFETY BUILDING
ASSETS	
Cash	\$154,486.36
TOTAL ASSETS	\$154,486.36
LIABILITIES AND FUND EQUITY	
Liabilities:	
Warrants Payable	\$0.00
Fund Equity:	
Fund Balances:	
Reserved for Special Purposes	\$154,486.36
Total Fund Equity	\$154,486.36
TOTAL LIABILITIES AND FUND EQUITY	\$154,486.36

Town of Ashby — Ashby Recycling and Transfer Station Enterprise Fund
FY2022 Statement of Revenue & Expenses
July 1, 2023 - June 30, 2024

	ORIGINAL BUDGET	BUDGET REVISIONS	REVISED BUDGET	ACTUAL EXPENDED	BALANCE
Expense					
Salary and Wages	8,540.00	0	8,540.00	6,587.01	\$1,952.99
General Operating Exp	3,270.00	6584	9,854.00	2,615.43	\$7,238.57
Trash Disposal Exp	10,355.00	0	10,355.00	16,298.42	(\$5,943.42)
Trucking Services	7,495.00	0	7,495.00	8,375.00	(\$880.00)
Recycling Exp	10,765.00	0	10,765.00	12,754.28	(\$1,989.28)
Emergency Reserve Fund	0.00	0	0.00	0	\$0.00
Devens Collection	1,575.00	0	1,575.00	0.00	\$1,575.00
Total Expenses RCTS	42,000.00	6,584.00	48,584.00	46,630.14	1,953.86
	ORIGINAL BUDGET	BUDGET REVISIONS	REVISED BUDGET	ACTUAL RECEIPTS	BALANCE Over/(Under) Budget
Revenue					
Recyclable Fees	17,740.00	0.00	17,740.00	14,461.81	-3,278.19
Hauler Fees	4,000.00	0.00	4,000.00	1,500.00	-2,500.00
Trash Disposal Fees	19,400.00	0.00	19,400.00	19,380.00	-20.00
Recyclable Sales	400.00	0.00	400.00	49.11	-350.89
Compost Bins/Pails	460.00	0.00	460.00	9.41	-450.59
Total RCTS Receipts	42,000.00	0.00	42,000.00	35,400.33	-6,599.67

Town of Ashby
ALL TRUST AND AGENCY FUNDS
30-Jun-24

	NON- EXPENDABLE TRUSTS FD 81	NON- EXPENDABLE TRUSTS FD 82	OTHER LIB TRUSTS FD83	OTHER TRUSTS FD84	AGENCY FD85	TOTALS (MEMORANDU M ONLY)
ASSETS						
=====						
Cash	311,907.94	136,990.50	56,776.55	760,037.62	17,456.92	1,283,169.53
Investments, at cost						
TOTAL ASSETS	311,907.94	136,990.50	56,776.55	760,037.62	17,456.92	1,283,169.53
=====						
LIABILITIES AND FUND EQUITY						
=====						
Liabilities:						
Accrued Payroll	-	-	-	-	0.00	3,843.00
Warrants Payable	-	-	-	-	4,707.00	2,605.00
Escrow	-	-	-	-	134.50	134.50
Off-Duty Work Details	-	-	-	-	-10,595.59	-12,258.44
Fire Details					11,004.31	11,980.30
Police Evidence	-	-	-	-	1,006.84	1,006.84

Due to Com of Ma - Sales Tax	-	-	-	-	-38.06	-28.31
Due to Com of Ma - Firearms Records	-	-	-	-	300.00	525.00
Due to Dept Fees	-	-	-	-	4,941.35	7,885.35
Due to Tax Collector	-	-	-	-	5,863.00	5,503.00
Due to Town Clerk/Assist Town Clerk	-	-	-	-	-66.43	-66.43
TOTAL LIABILITIES	-	-	-	-	17,256.92	21,129.81
Fund Equity:						
Fund Balances:						
Reserved for Endowments	311,907.94	136,990.50	56,776.55	760,037.62	200.00	1,265,912.61
TOTAL FUND EQUITY	311,907.94	136,990.50	56,776.55	760,037.62	200.00	1,265,912.61
TOTAL LIABILITIES AND FUND EQUITY	311,907.94	136,990.50	56,776.55	760,037.62	17,456.92	1,283,169.53

Town of Ashby
Ashby Free Public Library Trust Funds

	7/1/2023 BALANCE	CONTRIBUTI ON	EXPENDED	INTEREST	TRANSFER	6/30/2024 BALANCE
Non - Expendable Library Trust Funds						
Library Group Trust	\$2,832.14	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$8.53	\$0.00	\$2,840.67
Alonzo Carr Trust	\$5,601.32	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$16.96	\$0.00	\$5,618.28
Dr. Haskell Trust Fund	\$2,826.79	\$0.00	\$700.00	\$8.95	\$0.00	\$2,135.74
Freida Lyman Library	\$5,612.21	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$18.46	\$0.00	\$5,630.67
Freida Lyman Scholarship	\$33,122.62	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$96.29	\$0.00	\$33,218.91
Ruth Brooks Trust Fund	\$192,189.61	\$0.00	\$3,500.00	\$543.61	\$0.00	\$189,233.22
Ashby Alumni Trust	\$9,221.43	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$54.40	\$0.00	\$9,275.83
AAW Locke Trust	\$5,591.85	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$16.42	\$0.00	\$5,608.27
Edward & Barbara Lyman Trust	\$5,624.98	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$17.17	\$0.00	\$5,642.15
Grace E. & Everett W. Coats Fund	\$18,823.19	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$18,823.19
Todd Wright Memorial Fund	\$31,147.62	\$0.00	\$54.50	\$2,787.89	\$0.00	\$33,881.01
Total Non Exp. Trust Funds	\$312,593.76	\$0.00	\$4,254.50	\$3,568.68	\$0.00	\$311,907.94
Library Expendable Trust Funds						
Library Group Trust	\$335.97	\$0.00	\$250.00	\$41.30	\$0.00	\$127.27
Alonzo Carr Trust	\$741.91	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$81.78	\$0.00	\$823.69
Dr. Haskell Trust Fund	\$737.06	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$40.64	\$0.00	\$777.70
Freida Lyman Library	\$1,291.58	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$88.98	\$0.00	\$1,380.56
Freida Lyman Scholarship	\$2,890.41	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$464.22	\$0.00	\$3,354.63
Ruth Brooks Trust Fund	\$12,042.71	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$2,610.73	\$0.00	\$14,653.44
Ashby Alumni Trust	\$918.24	\$24,212.94	\$0.00	\$376.29	\$0.00	\$25,507.47
AAW Locke Trust	\$547.34	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$79.15	\$0.00	\$626.49
Edward & Barbara Lyman Trust	\$798.45	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$82.84	\$0.00	\$881.29

Todd Wright Memorial Fund	-\$824.28	\$200.00	\$0.00	\$224.25	\$0.00	-\$400.03
Francis Marston General	\$3,733.24	\$722.75	\$0.00	-\$194.69	\$0.00	\$4,261.30
Francis Marston Scholarship	\$9.30	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$255.30	\$0.00	\$264.60
Grace E. & Everett W. Coats Fund	\$3,851.95	\$0.00	\$1,017.01	\$352.96	\$0.00	\$3,187.90
Total Expendable Trust Funds	\$27,073.88	\$25,135.69	\$1,267.01	\$4,503.75	\$0.00	\$55,446.31
Expendable Memorial Funds						
Barbara Lyman Memorial	\$3,319.42	\$0.00	\$0.00	-\$2,487.25	\$0.00	\$832.17
Edward Connor Memorial	\$27.82	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.44	\$0.00	\$28.26
General Library Memorial	\$462.60	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$7.21	\$0.00	\$469.81
Total Memorial Funds	\$3,809.84	\$0.00	\$0.00	-\$2,479.60	\$0.00	\$1,330.24
Total Expendable Trust Funds	\$30,883.72	\$0.00	\$1,267.01	\$2,024.15	\$0.00	\$56,776.55
Total Trust Funds in Custody of Library Trustees	\$343,477.48	\$0.00	\$5,521.51	\$5,592.83	\$0.00	\$368,684.49

Town of Ashby
Trust Funds - Statement of Activity
July 1, 2023 - June 30, 2024

Account	7/1/2023 BALANCE	CONTRIBUTIONS	EXPENDED	INTEREST	TRANSFER	6/30/2024 BALANCE
Expendable Trust Funds in Custody of Treasurer						
Sumner Taylor School Fund	\$665.31	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$51.40	\$0.00	\$716.71
Jesse Foster School Fund	\$250.53	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$19.46	\$0.00	\$269.99
Samuel P Gates School Fund	\$4,965.75	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$388.57	\$0.00	\$5,354.32
Rosanna Robbins Chapel Fund	\$107,355.50	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$1,670.92	\$0.00	\$109,026.42
Stabilization Fund	\$498,823.96	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$9,110.24	\$47,528.43	\$555,462.63
Cemetery Perpetual Care Interest	\$13,624.05	\$300.00	\$0.00	\$1,932.23	\$0.00	\$15,856.28
Cemetery Sale of Lots Fund	\$66,763.87	\$1,500.00	\$0.00	-\$735.01	\$0.00	\$67,528.86
Open Space Land Aquis Trust Fund	\$608.82	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$9.47	\$0.00	\$618.29
John Forbes Memorial Clock Fund	\$504.96	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$23.44	\$0.00	\$528.40
Federal Forfeiture Police	\$2,248.98	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$34.97	\$0.00	\$2,283.95
Law Enforcement Trust Fund	\$2,418.89	\$0.00	\$0.00	-\$27.12	\$0.00	\$2,391.77
Total Expendable Trust Funds	\$698,230.62	\$1,800.00	\$0.00	\$12,478.57	\$47,528.43	\$760,037.62
Non-Expendable Trust funds in Custody of Treasurer						
Cemetery Perpetual Care Principal	\$111,154.50	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$1,200.00	\$0.00	\$112,354.50
Sumner Taylor School Fund Principal	\$2,636.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$2,636.00
Jesse Foster School Fund	\$1,000.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$1,000.00
Samuel P Gates School Fund	\$20,000.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$20,000.00
John Forbes Memorial Clock Fund	\$1,000.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$1,000.00
Total Non-Expendable Trust Funds	\$135,790.50	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$1,200.00	\$0.00	\$136,990.50
Total Trust Funds in Custody of Treasurer	\$834,021.12	\$1,800.00	\$0.00	\$13,678.57	\$47,528.43	\$897,028.12

Town of Ashby
Agency Funds
July 1, 2023 - June 30, 2024

	7/1/2023	RECEIPTS	EXPENDED	6/30/2024
	BALANCE		TRANSFERRED	BALANCE
BID DEPOSIT				
PLANNING BRD - DLR Realty Trust	134.5	0	0	134.5
	\$134.50	0	0	\$134.50
OTHER AGENCY				
Warrants Payable	2,605.00	0.00	-2,102.00	4,707.00
Payroll Payable	3,843.00	0.00	3,843.00	0.00
Due to Commonwealth - Firearms	525.00	6,712.50	6,937.50	300.00
Due to Commonwealth - Sales Tax	-28.31	47.76	57.51	-38.06
Due to Assist Town Clerk	-161.05	0	0	-161.05
Due to Town Clerk	94.62			94.62
Due to Deputy Collector	7885.35	9,477.50	12,421.50	4,941.35
Due to Tax Collector	5503	360.00		5,863.00
Police Special Detail	-12,258.44	99,722.36	98,059.51	-10,595.59
Police Evidence	1,006.84			1,006.84
Fire Details	11,980.30		975.99	11,004.31
Big Yellow School Bus Grant Due to AES	200	0	0	200
	21,195.31	116,320.12	120,193.01	17,322.42
TOTAL	21,329.81	116,320.12	120,193.01	17,456.92

TOWN CLERK’S FINANCIAL REPORT

2024 DOG LICENSES ISSUED:

		EACH	TOTAL
47	MALES/ FEMALES	\$10.00	\$470.00
366	SPAYED/ NEUTERED	6.00	2196.00
3	KENNEL \$25.00	25.00	75.00
0	KENNEL \$50.00	50.00	0.00
4	KENNEL \$75.00	75.00	300.00
59	LATE FEES	10.00	590.00
	TOTAL.....		\$3631.00
MISCELLANEOUS			\$3899.63
PAYMENTS TO TOWN TREASURER			\$7530.63

REGISTRARS REPORT

State law requires that the Town Clerk’s office be open to the public from 9am to 5pm on the 10th day prior to any Town Meetings or Elections as the last day to register to vote. The grid below details the dates of those events, the event type and the day and date that the Clerk’s office was open to the public from 9am to 5pm.

DATE OF EVENT	EVENT TYPE	LAST DAY TO REGISTER TO VOTE
March 5, 2024	Presidential Primary	Saturday: February 24, 2024
April 22, 2024	Annual Town Election	Friday: April 12, 2024
May 4, 2024	Special and Annual Town Meetings	Wednesday: April 24, 2024
June 18, 2024	Special Town Election	Saturday: June 8, 2024
August 20, 2024	Special Town Meeting	Saturday: August 10, 2024
September 3, 2024	State Primary	Saturday: August 24, 2024
November 5, 2024	State Election	Saturday: October 26, 2024
December 3, 2024	Special Town Meeting	Saturday: November 23, 2024

ELECTED TOWN OFFICIALS 2024

		TERM
MODERATOR	Nancy E. Chew	2025
TOWN CLERK	Angela Jack	2025
SELECTBOARD	David Nadeau	2026
	Jessica Kallin	2027
	Doug Leab	2025
ASSESSORS	Charles Perna	2025
	Jeff Childs	2027
	Dorothea Rourke	2026
TREASURER	Kate Stacy	2025
TAX COLLECTOR	Kate Stacy	2027
NORTH MIDDLESEX SCHOOL DISTRICT COMMITTEE	June McNeil	2025
NORTH MIDDLESEX SCHOOL DISTRICT SCHOOL COMMITTEE		
AT-LARGE	Lisa Bloom	2026
	Randee J. Rusch	2026
	Lisa M Martin	2026
LIBRARY TRUSTEES	Dwight F. Horan	2026
	Claire Hutchinson-Lavin	2026
	Geraldine Zagarella	2026
	Roberta Flashman	2027
	Christina Ewald	2027
	Lynne Carpenito	2027
	Joseph Cantor	2025
	Jane Pankosky	2025
	Dierdre Haynie	2025
CONSTABLE	VACANT	2025
TREE WARDEN	Jim Martin	2026
BOARD OF HEALTH	Cedwyn Morgan	2025
	Harold Chattaway	2026
	Eric Moeller	2027
PARK COMMISSIONERS	James Joseph	2025
	Patrick Lyden	2027
	Randy Stacy	2026
CEMETERY COMMISSIONERS	Matt Blood	2025
	VACANT	2027
	VACANT	2026
PLANNING BOARD	Alan W. Pease	2027
	Jean Lindquist	2028

	Andrew Leonard	2027
	Patricia Foster	2025
	Terri Cantor	2026
FINANCE COMMITTEE		
	VACANT	2025
	VACANT	2025
	VACANT	2023
	VACANT	2023
	VACANT	2024

APPOINTED TOWN OFFICIALS 2024

TOWN ADMINISTRATOR	Mary Daughraty
Michael Bussell, res.	
ACCOUNTANT	Elizabeth Braccia
Richard Howarth, res.	
ADA COORDINATOR	Mary Daughraty
April Forest, res.	
ASSISTANT TOWN ACCOUNTANT	Marybeth Erickson
ANIMAL CONTROL OFFICER	Victoria Collins
Mary Letourneau, res.	
ANIMAL INSPECTOR	Victoria Collins
REGIONAL ASSESSOR	Harald Scheid
ASSOC. REGIONAL ASSESSOR	Michael Saltsman
ASSESSOR'S CLERK	Barbara Thorpe
COLLECTOR CLERICAL SUPPORT	Diane Fors
AGRICULTURAL COMMISSION	Robert Burnham
Paula Packard, res.	
CEMETERY GROUNDSKEEPERS	Raymond Godin
Wayne Stacy	
CERTIFIED WATER OPERATOR	Michael Bussell
CHARITABLE FUNDING COMMITTEE	Terri Cantor
June McNeil	Alissa Johnson
COMCAST ADVISORY BOARD	Kenneth LeBlanc Jr.
Heather Brodie Perry	
CONSERVATION COMMISSION	Tim Bauman
Robert Leary	Roberta Flashman
Cathy Kristofferson	
COUNCIL ON AGING	Jo Helander
Helen Alden	Peg Vanhillo
Marcia Cronin	Carol Lielasus
Susan Creighton	Neal Marshall, res.
COA DIRECTOR	April Lynn Forest

**COA COORDINATOR
CULTURAL COUNCIL**

Angela Lyden
Sandra Heyes

E-911 COORDINATORS

Chris Regan

EARTH REMOVAL BOARD

James Hargraves
Robert Leary
Doug Leab
Dave Nadeau, res.

ELECTION OFFICERS

Deb Theall
June McNeil
Deb Dancause
Tracey Robinson-Harris
Angie Godin
Emma Jack
Katie Marsh

EMS MANAGEMENT DIRECTOR

EMS MANAGEMENT DEPUTY DIRECTOR

Patrick Roy, res.

ENERGY EFFICIENCY COMMITTEE

ETHICS COMMISSION LIASON OFFICER

Michael Bussell, res.

FIELD DRIVER

Mary Letourneau, res.

FIRE CHIEF

FULL TIME FIREFIGHTER/EMT

Michelle Calhoun

HARRIS ROAD MGMT COMMITTEE

Kate Stacy
Rebecca Day

HEALTH AGENT

Nashoba Board of Health

HIGHWAY DEPARTMENT

Sam Stacy
Noah Leblanc
Trent Elsea

HIGHWAY DEPARTMENT ADMIN ASST

HISTORICAL COMMISSION

Paul Lieneck
Alan Pease

Nadine Callahan
Mary Kate Bourne
John McKendry
Deb Dancause
Ian Martin

Gary Baer
Cedwyn Morgan
Mary Calandrella, res.

Betty Tiilikkala
Linda Stacy
Joyce Hopkins
Susan Creighton
Barbara Thorpe
Sandi Heyes
Gary Asher
Jill Niemi
Michael Bussell
Brian Reichelt

James Hubert
Mary Daughraty

Victoria Collins

Michael Bussell
Brian Reichelt

Cedwyn Morgan
Brendan McNeil
Roberta Flashman

Rick Metcalf
Steve Nims, Superintendent
Eric Jenks
Heath Thompson

Jill Blood
Claire Hutchinson-Lavin
Rebecca Walsh
Heather Perry

HISTORIC DISTRICT COMMISSION

Maureen Davi

John Vogt

INSPECTORS ADMIN ASST

BUILDING INSP./ZONING OFFICER

BUILDING INSP. ALTERNATE

ELECTRICAL INSPECTOR

ELECTRICAL INSP. ALT.

Cameron Milewski, res.

PLUMBING & GAS INSPECTOR

PLUMBING & GAS INSP. ALTERNATE

KEEPER OF THE TOWN CLOCK

LAND USE AGENT

LEGAL COUNSELS:

TOWN COUNSEL

SPECIAL COUNSEL

SPECIAL COUNSEL

LIBRARY DIRECTOR

LIBRARY ASSISTANTS

Jennifer Washington

Gabrielle Renzi

MART ADVISORY BOARD

MONTACHUSETT JOINT

TRANSPORTATION COMMITTEE

MONTACHUSETT REGIONAL

PLANNING COMMISSION

Alan Pease

MONTACHUSETT REGIONAL

TECH SCHOOL COMMITTEE

Peter Capone, res.

MOTH SUPERINTENDENT

MUNICIPAL GROUNDSKEEPER

NORTH MIDDLESEX AREA EMERGENCY

PLANNING COMM. (NMAEPC)

Jim Martin

PATRIOT REGIONAL DISPATCH BOARD

David Nadeau, res.

PEG BROADCAST TECHNICIANS

Emma Jack

PLANNING BOARD ASSOC. MEMBER

Andrew Leonard, res.

POLICE CHIEF

POLICE CHIEF ADMIN ASST

Claire Hutchinson-Lavin

Rebecca Walsh

Alan Ewald

Angela Jack

Mike Savageau

Vacant

Stephen Dubois Jr.

Vacant

Richard Kapenas

David Lammi

Bill Arnold

Elizabeth Wood

KP Law

Coppola & Coppola, P.C.

Mirick O'Connell

Heather Brodie Perry

Sandra Schippers

Kierstyn Snow

James Porter

April Lynn Forest

Alan Pease

Doug Leab

Shelly Jones

Charles E. Pernaa

William Ladue

Michael Bussell

Patrick Roy

Mary Daughraty

Joseph Laszlo

David Masse

Jim Hargraves

Wayne Stacy, res.

Derek Pepple

Angela Garhart

**POLICE MATRON
REGISTRARS OF VOTERS**

Deborah Vogt
Edward Jack

RECORDS ACCESS OFFICER

Derek Pepple, res.
Fred Alden, res.

**RIGHT-TO-KNOW-LAW COORDINATOR
SENIOR TAX WORK-OFF PROGRAM**

Angie Godin
Lisa Lavargna, res.

**SOLID WASTE DEPT SUPERINTENDENT
SOLID WASTE DEPT ATTENDANT**

Dean Thomas, res.

**SUPERINTENDENT OF SCHOOLS
TAX COLLECTOR**

TELLERS

Pam Peeler
Mary Allen
Dawn Roy
Deb Dancause
Shawn Keating
Garry Baer
Gary Asher
Sandi Heyes
Emma Jack
Nancy Richards
Ava McNeil
June McNeil
Barbara Thorpe
Roberta Flashman
Susan Peikofer
Matthew Carmack

VETERANS' AGENT

Lynette Gabrila, res.

**WIITA/BLOOD HILL LAND
MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE**

Cathy Kristofferson
Paula Packard
Bob Leary

ZONING BOARD OF APPEALS

Alan Pease
Justin Baer

Bonnie Murray

Carleton Mountain
Krishnabai (Assistant)

Angela Jack, Ashby Town Hall
Michael Bussell, Ashby Fire-EMS
Angela Garhart, Ashby Police Dept.

Michael Bussell
April Lynn Forest
Joan Chandley, res.

Brendan McNeil
Rick Raymond

Brad Morgan
Kate Stacy

Deb Pillsbury
Katie Marsh
Jill Niemi
Teresa Nagle
Joyce Hopkins
Tracey Robinson-Harris
Patricia Wayrynen
Michael Harrison
Martha Morgan
Angie Godin
Brendan McNeil
Deb Theall
Terri Cantor
Dan Dufour
Dawn Roy
Neal Anderson
Cory Hasselmann

Cedwyn Morgan
Roberta Flashman
Emily Merlino

Garry Baer
Matt Johnson, alt.

**ADDITIONAL INFORMATION:
ASHBY’S JUSTICE OF THE PEACE**

Carleton J. Mountain

POLICE DEPARTMENT

In 2024 we continued to rebuild the police department. In January Brian Vautour was officially promoted to the rank of Sergeant after being in the roll as acting sergeant for several months. Alexandra Hecker was promoted from Reserve Officer to full time Patrolman making her the first full time female police officer for the Town of Ashby. In April we hired Ethan Goodreau as a full time Patrolman which completed our ranks. Unfortunately, we were only fully staffed for a few months. In July Officer Hecker resigned after giving birth to a healthy baby and chose to leave law enforcement to raise her new bundle of joy.

In February we officially joined the Northeastern Massachusetts Law Enforcement Council (NEMLEC) which is a consortium of Police and Sheriff’s Departments in Middlesex and Essex Counties which share resources and personnel. More information can be found at their website at www.nemlec.com.

We’ve received several grants throughout the year. In April we received a \$1,500.00 grant for a Sharps Kiosk for the lobby of the public safety building. We also received a \$1,300.00 grant for the disposal fees associated with the Sharps Kiosk. In September we received a \$25,000.00 check with the help of Representative Margaret Scarsdale towards the upfitting cost of a new police cruiser. In December we received a grant for \$15,000.00 to implement a body worn camera program.

This year officers and staff have attended over 2000 hours of training. Some of these trainings include: Inservice, firearms qualification, firearms legal updates, detective training, evidence room, Taser instructor, field training officer and many more.

During 2024 the Ashby Police officers responded to, or were involved in, 9160 incidents, criminal investigations, traffic enforcement and community policing events.

Activity	Totals
Directed Patrols (Building Checks / House Watches / Radar Assignments)	4654
MV Crashes	50
B&E / Larceny	25
Fraud / ID Theft Reports	26
Domestic Incidents	30
Sex Offenses Investigations	1
Suspicious Activity Reports	81

Prescription Drugs Disposed (<i>lbs.</i>)	36.2
Arrests	20
Criminal Complaints	85
MV Stops	2,060
Citations Issued	1,330

We would like to remind our residents there is a drop box in the lobby of the Public Safety Building where unused medications and syringes can be safely and properly disposed in partnership with the DEA. The lobby of the Public Safety Building can be accessed any time.

We must acknowledge the continuing support we receive from the residents of the community. Without this support we could not be successful in our mission. We also would like to thank Patriot Regional Emergency Dispatch Center, Ashby Fire/EMS, Ashby Highway and the Administrative Offices of Town Hall.

Additional information, safety tips, and current activity can be viewed on the police department’s webpage at www.ashbypolice.org , our Facebook page and our X page.

2024 DEPARTMENT ROSTER

Police Department

Derek J. Pepple	Chief of Police
Angela D. Garhart	Administrative Assistant
Brian F. Vautour	Sergeant
Dylan J. Denis	Senior Patrolman
Kyle S. Dodge	Patrolman
Eldon J. Garhart	Patrolman
Christopher M. Davis	Patrolman
Ethan L. Goodreau	Patrolman
Vacant	Patrolman

Respectfully,
Derek J. Pepple, *Chief of Police*

FIRE AND EMS DEPARTMENT

General update and outlook:

Ashby Fire and EMS Department responded to approximately 623 calls this year. This included 263 EMS calls, 197 service calls, 50 fires, 31 alarm activations, 29

motor vehicle accidents, 21 hazmat incidents, 2 pressure vessel ruptures and 2 special incidents. There was a notable increase in the severity of EMS calls as we have utilized ALS resources from surrounding communities more often. Medical emergencies were our most prevalent calls this year, but there was a drastic increase in fires fueled by the dry summer season. Of the 50 fires, 16 were building fires, 22 outdoor fires, 5 cooking fires, 4 chimney fires, 1 vehicle fire, and 1 boiler fire. The department completed 131 inspections, 16 senior safe home visits, 5 public education sessions, and 5 fire drills.

The Department would like the residents of the town to know that their first responders are ready to respond to any emergency, despite the staffing challenges that are prevalent in the industry. The fire-response component of the department continues to struggle with an aging fleet of apparatus, with some relief from the leased fire engine. Our Engine 1 has been placed out of service due to its age and inability to pass its pump certification testing. We are currently limited in our ability to draft water in the event of a fire in town because of this. The remainder of the fleet, some of which are significantly beyond their NFPA designed life span, continue to result in rising repair costs. With the continued increase in calls for service, it is more important than ever that the town's emergency response vehicles and equipment are reliable and up to current standards for the safety of our citizens and department members. With the condition of the supply chain, the lead time has increased to 3 years from date of order to receipt of a new apparatus. It is imperative that we start the process of replacing our older pieces of equipment now, so we do not find ourselves without a lifesaving piece of apparatus. The department looks forward to a promising future as new growth within the community allows us to provide improved services to the town.

Membership:

The department is pleased to report that we have promoted our full-time Captain/EMT to the rank of Deputy. Our full-time firefighter/EMT has been aggressively pursuing additional training opportunities to bring new skills back to the department. On-call and volunteer membership has decreased this year. Many of our per-diem members work full-time at other fire departments and/or do not live in town to be able to respond from home. We are advertising and accepting applications for these positions. This year multiple members of the fire department have completed their EMT-B certifications and are completing the onboarding process to be an EMT for the department. Our Jr. Auxiliary member roster has grown this year. These individuals are under the age of 18 and exploring their passion for the fire service. The program continues to grow and provide valuable information and training to the next generation of firefighters. This is a unique opportunity and program that we are proud to offer. Years of service acknowledgements for this year are as follows: 5 years: FF Charlie Bergeron and FF Ian Martin, 10 years: FF/EMT Brian Nielsen, 15 years FF/EMT Sarah Berlinger, 25 years Captain Randy Stacy. The Fire Fighter of the Year Award went to FF Mike Brown. The EMT of the Year Award went to EMT Griffin Petrucci. The Chief's Award went to FF/A-EMT Chris Regan. The Chaplains Award went to AUX Pierce Fellows.

Our current roster at the conclusion of 2024:

Full time:

Chief Mike Bussell, Deputy Brian Reichelt, and Firefighter/EMT Michelle Calhoun

Officers:

Deputy James Joseph, Deputy Patrick Roy, Captain Randy Stacy, Captain Jim Martin, Lieutenant Eric Brown, Lieutenant Chris Borneman, Lieutenant Cameron Milewski, and Lieutenant Sergio Longley-Martines.

Firefighters:

Ian Martin, Mike Brown, Tim Kelley, Sawyer Curtin, and Charlie Bergeron.

EMTs:

Kari Rantala, Alexandra Hecker, Griffin Petrucci, and Steve Sheldon.

Firefighter/EMTs:

Sarah Berlinger, Hannah Barbati, Brian Nielsen, Jeremy Salo, Don Lane, Keagan Sheridan, Chris Regan, Ronald Petrucci, Chris Bjornson, and Zach Racicot.

Chaplain:

Ken Johnson

We are proud to have these, and all our members continue the tradition of the Ashby Fire Department.

EMS:

Our BLS ambulance service continues to provide expanded treatment options as they are approved by our medical director and in accordance with the state treatment protocols; including intramuscular epinephrine (for anaphylaxis and severe difficulty breathing), intramuscular glucagon (for diabetic emergencies), administration of CPAP (continuous positive airway pressure used for respiratory distress), administration of nebulized medications (for bronchospasm associated with Asthma and COPD) and 12-Lead ECG acquisition and transmission which will allow us to improve and expedite cardiac care and shorten Paramedic-intercept times, providing ECG tracings to intercepting paramedics on arrival. Our ambulance service has also renewed our medical control and hospital agreement with Leominster Hospital to implement additional improvements in service. We had a very successful ambulance inspection from OEMS that yielded zero negative findings. This is a testament to the hard work and dedication of our EMS Coordinator. Additionally, we have continued to nurture our mutual aid agreements with surrounding communities to ensure rapid and quality care is provided to the residents of our community and the surrounding towns.

Regular Training:

Over the past year there has been regularly scheduled monthly training as well as

several special training exercises. We host 12 monthly training sessions, 52 weekly drill nights, 4 joint department training sessions, and specialized training sessions, as needed for firefighters. We host weekly AUX member training courses throughout the year. Department training covers all aspects of firefighting and emergency services. Training introduces new members to the craft of firefighting and emergency services and keeps veteran members' skills sharp. Additionally, the department maintains regularly scheduled monthly EMS training approved for continuing education credit by the regional EMS council. Our regular training helps our EMTs maintain and refine their skills while earning credit for their bi-annual recertification. We have a new EMS training system that allows members to gain continuing education credits and keep protocols fresh, remotely online. This system will soon include skills needed for firefighting and other emergencies and supplement the in-person, hands-on training that we have in place. Some specialty training this year has included combined sessions with the Ashby Police Department and surrounding police and fire departments on advanced law enforcement rapid response and utility related emergencies. We had one member complete the Firefighter I/II certification through the state academy and are gearing up two more for this coming session.

Fire Prevention and Community Programs:

The Department's Fire Prevention Team conducted fire safety awareness education with children at Ashby Elementary, once again. This year's presentation included fun videos, demonstrations and activities for all the students. The Fire Prevention Group also conducted fire safety luncheons in conjunction with the COA to inform and educate seniors on best practices for home fire safety. The department has continued to provide our senior population with a smoke and carbon monoxide detector installation program placing new safety equipment in the homes of senior citizens free of charge. This year we were happy to expand on this program, offering house number signs, vials of life and night lights for travel areas in the home, to prevent falls in the dark and get pertinent information to responders. The department wrote for, and was awarded, a grant for \$1800 from the Department of Fire Services to help fund this program. The department will continue to apply for this grant and other funding opportunities to continue and grow this program into the future. Please see our advertisements with the COA for additional information if you or a loved one could benefit from this service.

This year saw a great revival of local events in town. The Ashby Fire Department partnered with the Ashby Fire and EMS Association for the outreach events in town. The annual July 3rd Bonfire showed a record attendance. This year we were able to add vendors and activities for attendees of all ages and are looking to continue to grow the event for years to come. Members were also happy to take part in set-up and cooking for some of the town band concerts as well as the Ashby Festival, and Pumpkin Festival. Partnering with the Police and Highway departments we hosted a successful Halloween Trick-Or-Treat on Main Street, once again. Members also partnered with a local car club to continue the tradition of the Car Show for Veterans and First Responders in September. This year we had a record number of vehicle entries

into the show and received great feedback from attendees. The Association partnered with the Ashby Patrolman's Association to obtain, wrap and deliver Christmas gifts to town families in need. Ashby Fire and Police competed in the Fight for Air Climb event in Boston to raise money for the American Lung Association. We look forward to continuing to grow our community outreach opportunities and give the residents an opportunity to meet us and ask questions.

Facilities and Buildings:

We have settled into the new building that we share with the Ashby Police Department. We have been able to organize and maintain smooth operation throughout the year. We are grateful for the opportunity to serve the community out of this facility.

Vehicle Update:

The department is pleased to report that the ambulance and leased engine have been running well and are serving the community without issue. Engine 1, made in 2000, has failed its annual pump testing and has been taken out of service for major mechanical and pump safety reasons. This leaves a major hole in our response model as it was our primary drafting engine to get water in the event of a fire. Engine 2, made in 1999, has suffered many mechanical failures throughout the year, but has been able to remain in service for the time being while utilizing our entire fleet maintenance budget. It did not pass its annual pump test but is still being used to fill the need. The 1999 ambulance has continued to prove useful and is dispatched while the primary ambulance receives regular maintenance, such as tire rotation or is engaged on another call and responds as our primary tech rescue vehicle. We are seeing an increase in maintenance costs as this ambulance is reaching the end of its effective duty cycle. The Department continues to have other fire apparatus that are over 20 years old and showing their age. The Department continues to repair this equipment, and the costs associated with these repairs continue to rise. The apparatus receives preventative maintenance but continues to be plagued with mechanical problems and breakdowns consistent with their age. We are in dire need of a replacement for Engine 1 to fulfill the fire response requirements in town. Unfortunately, it is not likely that we will be able to continue indefinitely to repair the pumps, plumbing, and electrical systems on these older vehicles as availability of replacement parts is reduced and costs increase. This year, with the assistance of local vendors, we were able to successfully refurbish Forestry 1, the brush fire response apparatus. This unit should last us for years to come and prove to be extremely capable in response and extinguishment of outdoor fires.

Alternative Funding Sources:

In addition to the funding provided by the town, the Fire and EMS Department continues to seek alternative funding sources to reduce the burden on the taxpayer, while still improving services. This year the department has written for \$1.4 million and received \$20,000 in grant funding. The department was awarded the Volunteer Fire Assistance Grant which allowed us to replace the damaged forestry fire pump mounted on Forestry 1. The department was awarded the Emergency Management

Performance Grant that allowed us to purchase wildland protective gear to ensure the safe operation of our personnel at brush fires. The department was awarded the Department of Fire Services Grant which allowed us to replace out-of-date SCBA bottles and outfit some of our members in NFPA compliant gloves and hoods to keep firefighters safe while operating. Finally, the Senior Safe grant was awarded to allow us to purchase smoke and carbon monoxide detectors, as well as vials of life, house number signs and nightlights to help locate and protect our seniors in town.

Messages to the Community:

The Ashby Fire Department would like to remind all homeowners to dispose of ashes from a wood stove or fireplace properly by placing them in a metal container with a lid and putting them outside away from buildings. As a reminder, never place hot ashes/coal on a porch, deck, leaves or in a cardboard box as they can stay hot for days and possibly ignite a fire. Please keep in mind that hot ashes and coal also give off carbon monoxide (CO) and should never be stored inside a building. Each year we respond to many CO (carbon monoxide) related calls that are a result of wood burning stoves.

The Fire Department would like to ask any residents that are interested in joining the department as a Firefighter or an EMT to please either stop into the station or call 978-386-5522 for more details. We always welcome new members and are always in need of their help to support our community.

Finally, I would like to thank the Department's Firefighters and EMTs for their continued support and professionalism. I would also like to thank all the other town departments and committees for their continued support as we work to improve services and provide protection to the community.

Respectfully submitted,
Michael Bussell, *Fire Chief*

EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT

Emergency Management continues to support the planning and preparedness functions for the Town of Ashby. The department provides planning for mitigation in the event of a large-scale incident, natural or human-caused disaster. Emergency management coordinates with all town departments to update these plans each year. The Emergency Management Department works closely with all Public Safety and essential town services to ensure resources can be coordinated and deployed quickly. The Emergency Management department maintains a comprehensive plan to respond to emergencies based on Ashby's needs and resources.

Ashby continues to participate in Regional and State disaster planning groups and continues to maintain Ashby's eligibility for grant funding. The Department continues

to analyze large scale weather events to determine if FEMA (Federal Emergency Management Agency) funding may be available to help offset mitigation costs.

The winter of 2024 brought multiple severe snowstorms to our town. Emergency Management communicated with all departments during these events in case they needed assistance.

As we grow public events in our community, Halloween, Fourth of July, etc. Emergency Management partners with multiple first responder departments (Fire, EMS, Police and Highway) to review all safety and preplanning of these events.

I would like to recognize the Ashby Fire/EMS (Emergency Medical Services), Ashby Police, Highway Department, and Town Hall personnel for their continued support and the essential role they play in our community.

Thank you,
Michael Bussell, *Emergency Management Director*

HIGHWAY DEPARTMENT

The Ashby Highway Department is located at 92 Breed Road. You can reach the department by calling 978-386-2272 Monday through Friday 7:00 AM to 3:00 PM.

The Highway Department maintains over 53 miles of Town roads. The Highway Department also maintains all Town properties and continues to assist other departments with their endeavors such as the July 4th Bonfire, Tractor Parade, and the Town Wide Halloween Trick or Treating event.

This past year, drainage work consisted of 500 feet of new drainage on Jones Hill Road. Also, a new Salt Shed was recently constructed at the Highway Department, which will be used for storage in the off season.

The Town received \$226,119.73 in Chapter 90 money and also \$114,579.00 in Fair Share funds from the State. With these funds, the Highway Department paved the dirt portion of Jones Hill Road, upper Turnpike Road and purchased a 2024 John Deere Loader.

The Town was able to start a brush cutting program with an outside contractor. The following roads were brush cut: Erickson Road, Wilder Road, Wares Road, Page Road, Mill Creek Drive, Stone Brook Road, Mason Road, Locke Road, Frost Road, New Ipswich Road, Harris Road, Jones Hill Road, Turnpike Road, County Road and Watatic Mountain Road. We hope to continue this program in the following years.

It is our goal to provide you with the highest quality service within our resources and

capabilities. The Department is committed to providing a professional staff that is responsible for the needs of the entire Town. For occasional downed tree limbs, snow removal or natural disasters, the Highway staff are many times the first to respond in the event of emergencies and are on call 24 hours a day, 365 days a year. If you have any questions and or concerns please let us know by calling the Highway Department at 978-386-2272.

Respectfully submitted,
Steve Nims, *Interim Highway Superintendent*

TREE WARDEN
No Report Submitted

ANIMAL CONTROL OFFICER

Late last year, I took over as Ashby's Animal Control Officer. I took the classes needed for the position and have thoroughly enjoyed every second of the job. I have helped several dogs make their way back home, a few cats, and currently giving a small dog a new life. I have done a few kennel inspections as well and they were a breeze, we have some wonderful kennels in town!

Victoria Gallant

ANIMAL INSPECTOR

I'm a few years into my position and I still enjoy every second of it! I am still meeting new families coming into town and finding families here that never knew they needed inspections, though I do find some people ignore my knocks and letters left for inspections and would love to find a way to reach out to them. Bites are much lower this year than any other year!

Victoria Gallant

PLANNING BOARD

James W. Hargraves began serving on the Ashby Planning Board in 1974 and was one of the architects of the Town's first Zoning. He served for 50 years and was the Chair of the Board for most of those years. He retired from public service in April this year. At the beginning of the Annual Town Meeting, the Planning Board and Town Moderator honored Mr. Hargraves and presented him with a Citation from the State Legislature recognizing his half century of service. Thank you, Jim!

As usual, the Planning Board spent the first quarter of the year preparing for the Annual Town Meeting. The Board was involved with five articles leading up to Town Meeting. The Light Industrial District bylaw passed. The Scenic Roads bylaw failed by one vote after three rounds of counting. The Planning Board worked extensively with the Earth Removal Board to craft an Earth Removal Bylaw. This was a Town Bylaw and was presented to Town Meeting by the Earth Removal Board. The bylaw passed.

The Planning Board held hearings on these and on two other bylaws proposed by the Select Board; a Home Occupation Bylaw and a bylaw change to the number of marijuana establishments allowed in the Industrial District. The Home Occupation article was passed over and the Marijuana article failed.

Andrew Leonard was elected to the Planning Board in April. We are happy to welcome him back.

The Board has begun a comprehensive update of our Subdivision Regulations. This will be an ongoing project into 2025.

In June we rescinded the approval of a subdivision on Old Northfield Rd. that was granted in 2017 and extended in 2019 but never built.

The Board has been working on three projects to come before Town Meeting in 2025:

- We are modifying our existing bylaw so it meets the legal requirements of the new state law permitting Accessory Dwelling Units (ADU).
- FEMA is producing new Flood Insurance Rate Maps (FIRMs) for the region. The Planning Board, in coordination with the State, updated our Flood Insurance bylaw to reference the new maps and address new requirements of the national Flood Insurance Program.
- We have spent many hours addressing compliance with the state mandated MBTA Adjacent Communities zoning requirement. We held public presentations, solicited public input, picked a proposed zoning overlay district, and began crafting a bylaw which will comply with the mandate. The State law requires that the Planning Board bring an article to Town Meeting for a vote.

Our Land Use Agent helped secure funding for a multi-modal transportation planning grant for the Town Center. She also secured \$110,000 for a Grange Restoration grant, \$14,750 from Mass Housing Partnership, and \$25,726 from Mass Broadband Institute for Digital Equity Planning.

Respectfully submitted,

Jean Lindquist, *Chair* (2028)
Alan Pease, *Clerk* (2027)
Terri Cantor, *Secretary* (2026)
Tricia Foster (2025)
Andrew Leonard (2029)

CONSERVATION COMMISSION

The Ashby Conservation Commission meets on the first and third Tuesdays of each month. The exception to this would be if conflicted with a National Holiday, an Election Day, or a Civic Event when the meeting would be scheduled for the following day, Wednesday. Additional meetings may be called as needed. All Commission Meetings were virtual Zoom meetings under Governor Healy's COVID-19 Open Meeting Law directive. This practice has proven to be very workable and will continue until further notice. Site visit guidelines have returned to a more normal format for outdoor events.

The Commission is charged with the protection of the Town's wetland resources. This requires anyone who intends to alter wetland areas, that is: land within 100 feet of any wetland or within 200 feet of any perennial stream, must apply to the Conservation Commission, along with the State Dept. of Environmental Protection (DEP), prior to such activity. This application is done through the permit application of a Notice of Intent (NOI) or a Request for Determination of Applicability (RDA). In each case site inspections are conducted, and a public hearing is held for the NOI before a decision is rendered. State Regulations provide the guiding principles for best practices. The statutes and regulations for wetlands protection are available online within the MassDEP website. The Commission also has several self-help brochures for those interested in managing their own projects. If in doubt, it is always better to ask questions of the Commission.

The 2024 calendar year continued to be very active for the Commission with numerous filings leading to 35 hearings and continuations. These projects ranged from Notices of Intent to Requests for Determination. 17 permits were issued for projects. The Commission conducted 104 site visits, by all or part of the Commission, with property owners, wetland professionals, engineers, and contractors. The Commission did find it necessary to issue three Enforcement Orders for non-compliance with the State Wetlands Protection Act. 11 Certificates of Compliance were issued for successfully completed projects, which allows removal of the Order of Conditions (wetlands permit) from the property deed.

The Commissioners continue to see a high rate of activity within the Town, and we will continue with diligence to protect our wetlands according to regulations. The Commission is also responsible for annually monitoring permanently protected land in the community, notably those protected by the Federal Forest Legacy Program.

Additionally, the Commission reviews Forest Cutting Plans usually prior to approval by the State Forester. We also reviewed and signed building permits that may have wetland implications.

The present members of the Ashby’s Commission combined represent over 100 years of service to Ashby on the Commission. The Membership is as follows:

- Tim Bauman - Chair
- Robert Leary - Vice Chair
- Roberta Flashman - Secretary
- Cathy Kristofferson – Treasurer
- (With currently one open seat)

CEMETERY COMMISSION
No Report Submitted

NASHOBA BOARD OF HEALTH

Nashoba Associated Boards of Health continues to serve the Ashby Board of Health in meeting the challenges of environmental and public health needs in your community.

In 2024, the Nashoba Associated Boards of Health (NABH) continued to advance regional public health through the ongoing support of two key grants: the Public Health Excellence (PHE) Grant and the Contact Tracing and Case Investigation (CT/CI) Grant.

Since 2022, the PHE Grant has enabled the onboarding of staff over time, including two Health Agents, an Education/Communication Specialist, and part- time staff to help with food inspections and manage the grant. This growing team has enhanced NABH’s ability to provide inspections, community outreach, and health education, fostering a more robust and adaptable public health infrastructure across participating municipalities.

The CT/CI Grant has further supported NABH by funding a full-time Public Health Nurse, enabling enhancements to the regional public health database, and incorporating advanced analytical tools to improve data tracking and reporting.

Together, these grants have strengthened NABH’s ability to meet evolving community needs, improving disease surveillance, emergency preparedness, and equitable access to high-quality public health services. Through a collaborative and resource-sharing approach, NABH has built a resilient and modern public health system that continues to effectively serve all member communities.

Environmental Health Department

The Nashoba Sanitarian serving your community is always available at our Ayer office and has regular hours in the Town Hall to serve your residents and work with you Town Hall staff.

Food Service Licensing and Inspections

6

This office licenses, inspects, responds to complaints and conducts follow-up on concerns in licensed operations. Our staff reviews plans for new/renovated facilities to ensure they are constructed in accordance with the Food Code.

Recreational Permitting and Inspections

14

This office licenses, inspects and responds to complaints regarding recreational camps for children, bathing beaches and public and semi-public pools. We sample bathing beaches weekly, providing the results to community partners to ensure swimming only occurs at the public and semi-public beaches which meet State regulations.

Housing & Nuisance Investigation

25

This office inspects dwelling units for compliance with the State Sanitary Code on complaint and prior to occupancy. We issue orders to affect corrective actions, reinspect, and initiate legal action if necessary. Similarly, complaints from residents concerning unsanitary conditions and/or pollution are investigated.

Title 5 related work – On-site Sewage Disposal

We received 42 applications for soil testing (testing necessary for the design of a sewage disposal system) and witnessed 182 tests performed (perc tests and soil evaluation holes).

We received 16 applications for sewage disposal systems and reviewed 28 plans for new and replacement systems.

Our office prepared 12 sewage disposal system permits for the Board's review and approval: 6 for new construction and 6 for the replacement of failed systems.

We conducted 42 inspections during the construction of sewage disposal systems.

We reviewed 19 Title 5 inspection reports, and we were available to provide consultation to your residents on matters relating to sewage disposal systems.

Private Wells

Private wells are regulated by local regulation, and we issued 7 permits for new and replacement private water supply wells.

We reviewed water quality and quantity reports and interpreted the results for your residents. As water quality awareness has increased, we have assisted communities with systematic water testing programs (generally upon property transfer.)

Rabies Clinics

The number of residents attending our community clinics has dropped. Understanding the importance of service, we have modified our clinic offerings to ensure convenient access to a clinic.

Community Health Nursing

Nashoba’s Community Health Nursing program provides an essential public health service to its member communities guided by the American Nurses Association (ANA) 16 Standards of Public Nursing Practice.

The Nashoba nursing team reviewed, investigated and reported on all mandated communicable and infectious diseases (including respiratory diseases) while working closely with the Massachusetts Department of Public Health’s (MDPH) epidemiology team. Though this daily reporting and investigation work is not always visible, it is vital to protect the public from the spread of disease and includes:

- Working with MDPH and other local boards of health to identify and manage clusters of disease/exposures in the district.
- Working with school nurses and childcare providers in the district to provide information, offer advice and support.
- In conjunction with our Health Agents, we work with individuals in challenging living conditions (unsanitary, hoarded) to facilitate services to mitigate situations which would allow an individual to remain in their home.

Communicable Disease Number of Cases investigated:

Babesiosis.....	1
Campylobacteriosis.....	1
Group A Streptococcus	1
Hepatitis C	2
Human Granulocytic Anaplasmosis.....	3
Influenza	19
Novel Coronavirus (SARS, MERS, etc).....	26
Tuberculosis (latent).....	1

The Nashoba nursing staff provided monitoring and guidance to travelers and residents testing positive for TB infection (not contagious) 61 throughout the district this calendar year and have also been managing 2 active TB cases in the District since Spring/Summer 2024 and continue to date. The towns in the Nashoba District fall into a LOW RISK TB category (as defined by MDPH).

In addition to the mandated disease surveillance and reporting, our staff serves as a resource to the community, addressing questions and concerns from the public on a variety of health and safety issues (immunizations, head lice, chronic disease management, safe drug/sharps disposal etc.) in a variety of ways including:

- Monthly town nurse hours have been & continue to be offered throughout the district. Nashoba nursing staff conducted 136 total town nurse hour events this year, including 11 in Ashby. Town nurse hours include an opportunity for blood pressure checks, blood sugar screenings, diet/nutrition information and teaching, medication review, and assistance with identifying and coordinating community resources and referral as needed. Districtwide flu clinics are held in the fall.
- Nashoba conducted seasonal flu clinics in each community to make vaccinations available to everyone, including homebound residents. In 2024 we administered 1256 flu shots to community members, including 33 Ashby residents.
- The nurses are available for & have made home visits to make general assessments, assist with coordinating care and services, provide support/teaching and make referrals to other local community resources. In 2024 we made 10 home visits in Ashby.
- Nashoba has offered community outreach and educational programs covering topics such as disease prevention, chronic disease management, emergency preparedness, mental health awareness, and overall wellness. We offered programs on Diabetes 101, Five Wishes and on going grief support group availability
- Nashoba staff attend and regularly participate in collaborative meetings, trainings, and conferences to keep current with the latest developments in local public health.
- Nashoba staff facilitated several meetings with key stakeholder groups to promote partnership, encourage strong regional communication, and foster working relationships. This has helped to identify common goals and guide future public health initiatives and outreach.

Community Health- Communications and Public Health Education Summary

The Public Health Educator/Communications Specialist (PHE/CS) role has continued to evolve since its inception in Sept 2021 to best support the needs of the district. In the past year, the PHE/CS has been communicating timely and relevant public health information to towns and stakeholders and providing educational opportunities across the District with a social determinants of health (SDOH) lens. This work has included:

- Providing community educational opportunities to residents both independently and collaboratively with the PH nursing team based on

community need- Harm reduction, emergency preparedness, etc.

- Overseeing and administering a grant and donation-funded community grief support program
- Offering and instructing adult mental health first aid certification courses for municipal staff, community volunteers, and other groups serving NABH region residents
- Providing education and advocacy related to harm reduction, treatment and de-stigmatization of substance use disorder
- Organizing technical assistance and resource-sharing meetings for municipalities related to opioid abatement settlement funds
- Collaborating with the new Shared Services Coordinator to build district understanding of the State's Blueprint for Public Health Excellence, maximize resources and identify opportunities for capacity building
- Maintaining up-to-date distribution lists, communicating within the district via channels such as quarterly newsletters, regular email updates, etc. pertaining to public health news, information, and events such as flu and rabies clinics. Continuing to explore and evaluate communication methods to reach as many community members as possible.
- Building and maintaining relationships with stakeholders through meetings and attending community events to represent NABH
- Finalizing an official agency "mission statement", approved by the NABH Executive Committee in 2024
- Serving as a resource for community members with public health related questions across a broad range of topics
- Attending trainings with an emphasis on health equity and public health service regionalization.
- PHE/CS has utilized an SDOH lens to identify health inequities that most impact the NABH region to focus efforts and collaborate with community partners to lessen these gaps.
- Developing educational and communications materials for district and individual towns by request including print, electronic, presentation, and TV/ news media materials
- Maintaining and improving upon NABH website to keep info relevant and accessible
- Maintaining agency social media to reach more people in district with current, relevant, and seasonal public health information

- Co-organizing events to facilitate the exchange of information such as a springtime public health conference called “Bridges to Health: Building Thriving Community Partnerships”

ASHBY BOARD OF HEALTH

The Ashby Board of Health as of January 2024 consisted of Daniel Ewald, Eric Moeller, and Cedwyn Morgan. The Board is assisted by our agent Rick Metcalf of Nashoba Associated Boards of Health, and currently meets on the third Thursday of every month at 7 pm, although there has been some variability in scheduling and it is best to check the web site or with our agent. All meetings in 2024 were held via Zoom. Additional or alternative meetings are occasionally scheduled as needed.

The primary regulatory activities performed by the board involve septic and well permitting. In addition to the standard permitting stream, the Board in 2024 successfully resolved several out-of-compliance properties and worked with the owners to bring their systems back into compliance. Permits for solid waste transport, tobacco, and food services are also processed.

The board passed a noise control regulation in 2024.

Nashoba Associated Boards of Health, of which Ashby is a member, had to terminate their hospice nursing program in early 2024 due to financial pressures.

The DEP Division of Solid Waste requires annual monitoring of the landfill, which is overseen by the Board of Health. The Board is currently working with the DEP regarding the monitoring program.

Other issues for the Board in 2023 included housing code violations and a tobacco permit violation. One member of the Board serves on the Ashby Earth Removal Board (ERB), which was active in 2023. The ERB’s recommendations were not acted on by the Select Board.

At the close of 2024 the Board began updating our solid waste hauler regulations to comply with DEP requests in this regard. The carrot offered by the DEP is that passage of the requested revisions, which are relatively minor, should make the town eligible for additional funding from the DEP for operation of the transfer station.

BUILDING INSPECTOR

The building department issued 149 permits in 2024. This is an increase of 15 permits compared to last year. The following is a summary of the year’s activities.

Permits

New Homes.....	3
Garages	1
Barns & sheds	9
Remodel, repair and additions	69
Wood stoves, pellet stoves & chimneys.....	11
Pools.....	0
Demolition	5
Solar Panels.....	46
Temp homes	1
Tents.....	0
Sheet Metal	1
Heat Pumps	1
Commercial.....	2
Total Permits	149
Annual Inspections.....	2
Yearly Inspection fees	\$200.00
Total permit fees	\$41,505.00
Total Work Value.....	\$3,798,074.08

Respectfully Submitted,
Michael Sauvageau, *Building Inspector*

ELECTRICAL INSPECTOR

We had a decrease of 24 electrical permits pulled as compared to last year. Revenue decreased by \$235.00.

Permits pulled for 2024 = 102 for total revenue of \$8835.00

Respectfully submitted,
Stephen DuBois Jr., *Wiring Inspector*

PLUMBING AND GAS INSPECTOR

Number of permits for the year 2022.....	60
Plumbing permits	31
Gas permits	29
Number of inspections (approximately)	74

Plumbing inspections36
Gas inspections 38

Total revenue generated \$4025.00

Respectfully submitted,
Richard Kapenas, *Plumbing and Gas Inspector*

ASHBY COUNCIL ON AGING

Mission Statement: The mission of the Ashby Council on Aging is to enhance the quality of life for Ashby’s residents by offering services that strive to promote each resident’s healthy, successful aging.

Meetings: The Council on Aging meets the second Thursday of each month at 11am in the Land Use Room, 1st floor of Ashby Town Hall. Meetings are open to the public.

Overview: The Ashby COA’s main purpose is to meet the needs of Ashby’s older residents with a focus on those most vulnerable. The COA serves any older residents in Ashby by providing information, guidance and services. Special focus and attention are given to the most vulnerable of the town’s older population. We are also a point of senior socialization. We are senior focused and community oriented!

Population Served: Based on the most recent census data available, there are approximately 1,100 residents over the age of 60 in Ashby.

Location: The Ashby COA Director has an office on the 1st floor of Ashby Town Hall. The Coordinator’s office is located in the COA Room, on the 1st floor of town hall, where the Council holds its monthly meetings, and functions are held. Both offices can be accessed by stairs or the elevator.

Community: The COA works directly with other community organizations to help facilitate their efforts to meet the needs of Ashby’s older citizens. Some of the organizations are: Massachusetts Council on Aging (MCOA), Massachusetts Office of Executive Affairs, Middlesex County Sheriff’s Office, Nashoba Associated Boards of Health, Aging Services of North Central Mass (ASNCM, previously Montachusett Home Care Corp.), SHINE (Serving the Health Information Needs of Elders), Making Opportunity Count (MOC, Meals on Wheels), Community Legal Aide, Ashby American Legion Post 361, Ashby Free Public Library, Townsend Ecumenical Outreach (TEO, a food & clothing pantry), Ashby Police, Ashby Highway, Ashby Fire & EMS

Current COA Initiatives: The COA serves as a “resource connector” to help meet

the needs of Ashby's older citizens by determining their needs, then connecting them with available resources. In the last 2 years, the COA has been integral in linking older adults to much needed resources, particularly food resources and applying for state assistance, like fuel assistance, SNAP benefits and Mass Health. There has been a large increase in requests from citizens needing food assistance and concerns about winter heating, as food costs along with many other life necessities have been steadily increasing. To assist our older citizens with dealing with this inflation, the COA has put initiatives in place and continues working to provide more. Those initiatives include but are not limited to:

Meals on Wheels - The Meals on Wheels program provides nutritious, prepared meals delivered Monday-Thursday by COA volunteers. Since the beginning of 2022 there has been a steady increase with zero decrease in program recipients. We now deliver meals to 11 residents. The Meals on Wheels Program is not only a crucial food safety net but a way to decrease social isolation among our homebound residents and those needing more support.

Outings – The Ashby COA coordinate outings for older residents such as shows, information seminars, luncheons, coffee hour, educational events and much more.

Information Sessions – The COA organizes community speakers and presentations on a variety of topics that are of interest the Ashby's older residents, such as nutrition, healthcare, safety, legal issues and much more.

Medicare Counseling – SHINE (Serving Health Information Needs of Elders): Ashby's SHINE Counselor is available to meet with individuals to assist them with Medicare related questions and concerns. SHONE Counseling is available via phone, email or in-person by appointment. Appointments can be made by contacting the Ashby COA Director.

Newsletter – The COA's "Scoop" Newsletter is a free monthly mailing via US Mail and/or email sent to over 600 residents. The newsletter serves as an important resource for information, services and events offered to the seniors in Ashby. It serves as the primary source of connection between the COA and residents.

MART Shuttle Bus Services – The MART Shuttle Service is available to all eligible (60 years and older or ADA qualified) individuals. Ashby residents may use the bus Monday – Friday for medical appointments, shopping and social day care. The bus is available from 8:00am to 5:00pm. Riders must schedule a ride the day before. To apply or schedule a ride please call Nadine Callahan or April-Lynn Forest Monday – Thursday, 978-386-2424 ext. 133 or 131

Sand Delivery – The Ashby COA coordinates a group of volunteers to deliver sand

to older residents in town that are unable to get to the town highway garage in the winter months. For winter 2023-2024, there are 36 residents currently receiving sand delivery.

Medical Equipment Loans – The COA has used, yet durable medical equipment available for loan to residents, at no cost. Items include, but not limited to, wheelchairs, walkers, canes, crutches, commodes, shower chairs, ice cooling machines and so much more. If you need medical equipment, please contact the COA.

Exercise – The COA holds chair yoga twice a week. Tai Chi weekly and walking club during nicer months. We will have pickle ball available on the newly paved courts in spring of 2025.

Coffee & Chit-Chat Socials – The COA holds a coffee & chit-chat social twice a month in the COA room, 1st floor, town hall

Community Creations – A social arts club designed to bring seniors and other community members together for creative fun. Some creations are made for town residents for various occasions, IE: birthdays, holidays, help lift spirits, and just for fun.

File of Life Magnets – We have FREE File of Life Magnets available and “file of life” stickers to assist in providing much needed information during an emergency. We suggest using pencil to fill out your information, keeping updating your file simple.

Food Pantry – The COA has had a successful Free Little Food Pantry at the entry to the Town Hall for over a year now, we are able to provide through generous donations nonperishables.

COVID-19 Antigen Rapid Home Tests – We have a large supply of at-home COVID tests available to all town residents. Each box contains 2 tests. Available for pick up on the 1st floor.

Friends of the COA- A fully developed 501(c) (3) non-profit corporation dedicated to improving the social outreach of the Ashby COA for the benefit of all Ashby seniors. Established in November 2021, the Friends of the Ashby COA have made a significant impact on the outreach portion of the COA. They have worked tirelessly at fundraising, event and trip planning, underwriting events and much more, to provide more of much needed social interaction with Ashby's seniors. We cannot thank them enough for all that they do.

In closing, we would like to thank all of our amazing volunteers, the Ashby Highway, Ashby Fire and EMS, Ashby Police, Meals on Wheels drivers, Friends of the Ashby

COA and everyone that has stepped up, showed support for the Ashby seniors and much more. Lending a helping hand goes a long way and you all have shown how amazing you truly are. Thank you all from the bottom of our hearts.

Respectfully Submitted,
The Ashby Council on Aging:

Peg Vanhillo – <i>President</i>	Susan Creighton – <i>Secretary</i>
Helen Alden – <i>Vice President</i>	Carol Lielasus – <i>Board Member</i>
Marcia Cronin – <i>2nd Vice President</i>	April-Lynn Forest - <i>Director</i>
Jo Helander- <i>Treasurer</i>	Nadine Callahan – <i>Coordinator</i>

VETERANS SERVICES DEPARTMENT

The mission of our office is to connect veterans with the benefits to which they are entitled. We primarily administer Chapter 115 benefits, a financial assistance program designed for low-income veterans and their dependents, including surviving spouses. In addition, we assist veterans with filing their VA disability claims and facilitate access to other essential resources, such as housing, food, and employment services.

Since our last update:

- October training through the Executive Office of Veterans Services (EOVS) in Leominster.
- June training through the Massachusetts Veterans Service Officer Association (MVSOA) in Hyannis.
- Cory and Nolan successfully completed the annual certification to be Veterans Service Officers (VSOs) this fall.
- Cory and Nolan received VA accreditation through EOVS to continue claims processing.
- Cory obtained VA accreditation through NACVSO, completing an additional skills training for claims.
- Cory was appointed President of the Worcester County Veteran Service Officer Association.
- Cory was appointed Junior Vice Commander of the Massachusetts Veterans Officers Association.

These appointments enhance our district’s ability to advocate effectively for veterans’ benefits within our coverage area.

Monthly Interactions	District	Ashby
7/2024	164	4
8/2024	211	6
9/2024	191	2
10/2024	241	4
11/2024	265	3
12/2024	229	2
1/2025	209	6
2/2025	214	5
3/2025 (As of 3/6/2025)	100	3
	1824	34
VA Claims	217	8
Chapter 115	69	0

Office hours: Monday-Thursday: 8am-430pm Friday: 8am-1pm

ASHBY CHARITABLE FUNDING COMMITTEE
No Report Submitted

CULTURAL COUNCIL

The Ashby Cultural Council (ACC) is a committee of at least 5 members appointed by the Board of Selectmen to serve 2 three-year terms. At the end of your term you must leave the ACC for 1 year. You are eligible for reappointment after the year off. The primary responsibility of the Council is to disburse funds received from the Massachusetts Cultural Council for the Arts whose purpose is to support the public programs that promote access, education, diversity and excellence in the arts, humanities and interpretive sciences in all the communities across Massachusetts.

The Massachusetts Cultural Council granted the ACC \$5,900 for 2025. We received 32 grant requests totaling \$24,503. With the MCC grant and funds from grantees that did not perform in 2024, we approved the following 30 grants in the amount of \$7,180.

These are the approved grants and amounts to be disbursed for 2025:

Ann-Marie LaBollita	Matisse and the Cut Outs	\$250
Ashby Council on Aging	Scott Babineau	\$275
Ashby Council on Aging	Vintage Vocal Quartet	\$350
Ashby Council on Aging	Slattery & Stewart	\$350

2024 Annual Reports

Ashby Free Public Library	Cranky Folk Art Music Program	\$250
Ashby Free Public Library	Pumpkin Festival	\$400
Daniel Kirouac	Folk-Rock Program for Ashby Library	\$450
Denis Cormier	Songs of Yesteryear	\$150
Facepaint, Inc.	Donation of books & online resources to AFPL	\$ 50
Hawthorne Brook MS	Chainsaws, Cheeseburgers & Rock N’ Roll	\$100
Hawthorne Brook MS	Myth Masters: Tales from Greek Mythology	\$100
Hawthorne Brook MS	Playful Engineering Traveling Maker Space	\$100
Hawthorne Brook MS	Spinning History: Heroines on the Home Front	\$100
Hawthorne Brook MS	Sub Zero Science Presentation	\$100
Hawthorne Brook MS	Traditions of Chinese Acrobatics	\$100
HBMS STEAM Committee	STEAM day Planetarium Presentation	\$100
Jennifer Powell	Outdoor Sculpture: “You are here”	\$200
Johnny Apple Seed Trail Assoc.	Johnny Apple Seed Visitor Center	\$200
John Waterman	Live Music: Making History Live	\$350
Julie Stepanek	Music & Movement for Young Children	\$250
Matt York	Songs & Stories: Johnny Cash	\$600
MUSIC Dance.edu	I am Autistic I Am Fantastic: The Musical	\$580
Nashoba Symphonic Band	Concert Series	\$500
NMRHS Project Graduation	DJ	\$100
NMRHS Project Graduation	Comedy Hypnotist	\$100
Pepperell Community Arts	Spring Production: Community Tickets	\$250
Peter Stickel	Nissitissit String Quartet	\$325
Roberta Flashman	Mural on side entrance of Ashby Library	\$200
Town of Winchendon	Haunted Fun Day	\$100
Winchendon Winds, Inc.	Winchendon Winds 2024 Concert Series	\$200

Ashby Cultural Council members: Chairperson; Mary-Kate Bourn, Angela Lyden, Secretary; Deb Dancause, Treasurer and members; Sandi Heyes and Peggy Ann Mosher

Respectfully submitted,
Deb Dancause, *Treasurer*

**ASHBY FREE PUBLIC LIBRARY
BOARD OF TRUSTEES**

The AFPL Board of Trustees is composed of nine members, three of whom are elected each year at the Annual Town Elections. Trustees serve without compensation for a term of three (3) years. The Board has responsibility for:

- management of the Library and of all property owned by the Town pertaining to the Library

- all monies appropriated by the Town, or received as gift or State Aid, for the Library
- establishing written policies governing library activities and services
- appointing a qualified Library Director who is the executive and administrative officer

The Director is responsible for implementation of policies approved by the Board, selection and supervision of personnel, selection of books and other materials, maintenance of library collections, expenditure of funds within the approved budget, direction of library operations and provision of services to the public.

The Trustees of the Ashby Free Public Library met monthly during the year, primarily meeting on Zoom. The board consisted of Roberta Flashman, Dwight Horan, Claire Lavin, Geraldine Zagarella, Lynne Carpenito, Jane Pankosky, Joe Cantor, Chris Ewald and Deirdre Haynie. The following officers were elected by the Board in April: Roberta Flashman, Chair; Chris Ewald, Vice-chair; Claire Lavin, Secretary; and Lynne Carpenito, Treasurer.

The Library Director completed the filing of all the financials, circulation, and other information required to keep the library certified with the Mass Board of Library Commissioners. Last year Ashby received a total of \$8,243.32 in State Aid. This year we are happy to announce that the first half of the State Aid 2025 award was \$4,675.10. With the 2nd half of the payment in March, our total State Aid for 2025 will be over \$9,000.00! The funds can be used for anything that the Library needs, except for staff positions that would normally be funded through the budget. We are grateful to MBLC for their confidence in us, thankful to the State Legislature for increase in grant funding and especially beholden to our Director who completed the application process and made this all possible.

Additionally, the Director applied for and received multiple grants over the past year. She has created programs, activities and expanded the library collections of books, audiobooks, movies and music. She has even created a tool library that can be loaned out, just like books! Read the Library Director's Annual Report to learn of all the programs happening at the library as a weekly, monthly, or special event. Sign up on the Library website, www.ashbylibrary.org, to receive a newsletter listing all the events for the upcoming month.

Dwight Horan serves as our scholarship committee. He manages the receipt of applications and verification of attendance so that we might award monies from trust funds set aside for this purpose. 10 scholarships of \$500.00 each were awarded in March 2024. We voted to award the same \$500 scholarship this year, and are awaiting completion of paperwork for 12 more students. The number of scholarships awarded

is only limited by the number of Ashby students who apply. If more would apply, we would happily award more scholarships. Students may receive scholarships for a maximum of 5 years, not necessarily consecutive. In addition, starting last year, there is an additional scholarship available for those students continuing their education in the STEM areas: science, technology, engineering and math.

We also are delighted to announce that Dwight was able to complete an agreement with the Ashby Alumni group to transfer their funds for the Irene Salminen Scholarship Fund to the library's control. This \$500 scholarship will be awarded, starting next year, on top of the regular Library Scholarship, to at least 4 students continuing their education in Education, Law Enforcement, Law, Emergency Medical, Fire Science, or other First Responder Programs as well as being available to any Honorably Discharged Veteran, residing in Ashby and enrolled in *any* accredited program.

We were able to work with the Planning Board, The Historic District Commission, and the Fire Department to purchase and install a double sided sign for the library with an area on each side for messaging. A generous donor made a substantial gift to help fund a new sign, with additional donations of money and time to cover the full cost.

The Director has accomplished all this on a tight budget, which has been made even tighter by the delayed maintenance coming home to roost, literally, in repairs of the slate and copper roof to stop leaks. And, despite our best efforts to anticipate increases by Unutil, the utility bill still consumes more than 25% of the budget.

The long term solution to the building problem is to raise money for large projects, which is beyond the scope of an annual budget. The first of these projects is huge: the preservation/protection of the exterior of the old building. A first small step to repairing the roof was done this fall with the replacement of 44 missing or cracked slates on the roof. Luckily we had a fairly large inventory of spare slate to work with. We don't have a similar large inventory of copper for use in fixing gutters and downspouts, so we may have to take a less expensive approach to direct water away from the building. In addition to searching for grant monies to assist in this task, we are investigating whether there is an advantage to getting the library building included on the National Register of Historic Buildings. Blaise Davi has donated his time and expertise from working on historic buildings within the National Parks system to introduce us to this option. Once we have stabilized the building, the next projects will be the purchase and installation of solar panels at the library followed by replacement of the current fossil fuel heating and cooling system with heat pumps.

The Library relies on the generosity of the residents of the town. A team of Volunteers donate their time every week to pull books to meet the requests of patrons and re-shelve books that have been returned. Their work powers much of what our budget cannot fund. Our volunteers provide creative solutions to our unique space and its

challenges. Jim Hubert continues to assist with building maintenance and Mike McCallum has peered into tight spaces to fix our air conditioning system when it stopped during the extreme heat of this past summer. Special events have received donations of refreshments, flowers and other niceties that set the tone for the event. Monetary donations to the library, now tax deductible when made payable to the new AFPL Fund, will move the library towards a sustainable future as town center and source of cultural enrichment. Thanks to all who donate.

Respectfully Submitted,
Roberta Flashman, *Chair, Ashby Free Public Library Board of Trustees*

LIBRARY DIRECTOR

The Ashby Free Public Library had an extraordinary year in 2024, filled with growth, innovation, and a deep connection to our community. None of this would have been possible without the support of our dedicated staff: Heather Brodie Perry, Library Director; Jennifer Washington, Sandra Schippers, and Kierstyn Snow, Library Assistants; and James Porter, Library Page. We also owe immense gratitude to our incredible volunteers: Hannelore Colasanto, Rita Poland, Vicki Mickola, Denise Lynch, Caitlyn Mayrand, Rebecca Anderson, Brenda Swift, Lynne Carpenito, Roberta Flashman, and Joe Cantor. Their contributions, along with the unwavering support of our Trustees, allow us to provide exceptional services and programs to Ashby residents.

The library benefited greatly from several grants in 2024, allowing us to enhance our offerings and improve accessibility. We completed a grant to better serve individuals with developmental disabilities and launched a new initiative to improve mobility access. A \$10,000 grant will bring the Smithsonian traveling exhibit *Voices and Votes* to Ashby in summer 2025, and a \$5,000 grant enabled us to establish a tool library, already hosting workshops on mat cutting and knife sharpening, with more planned for the coming year. Additional grants funded enriching art classes and live musical performances, further expanding the library's cultural and educational opportunities.

The library's statistics underscore its strong and growing impact. In 2024, we circulated 13,332 items, reflecting a 7.6% increase over last year. A total of 1,218 Ashby residents now hold library cards, including 126 new cardholders this year. Of these, 593 are adults aged 18–60, 303 are seniors over 60, 126 are young adults, and 121 are children. Many families share cards for convenience, so these figures only begin to reflect the full extent of library use. Additionally, our programs welcomed 3,649 attendees, showcasing the vibrant role the library plays in our community.

Children's programming remains a cornerstone of our mission. Story times, and the Right Start Playgroup, provided vital early literacy and developmental support. Popular programs like the Lego Club and Mario Kart Club fostered creativity and

collaboration. Quarterly sensory workshops and story times with Strega Mama created inclusive spaces for all children, while special vacation week events, such as learning about big predators and winter hibernators, kept young minds engaged. Summer reading highlights included *Anime and Tales with Motoko* and the *Let's Go Eco Show*. Visits from Santa and magician Stephanie Beach added extra magic to the year. Our monthly First Friday Family Movies are well attended and enjoyed by all. Additionally, the library became a hub for Ashby homeschoolers, whose regular meetings bring excitement and innovation to our space.

Adults also found a wealth of opportunities at the library. Weekly chair yoga classes, biweekly photography club meetings, and a monthly bereavement support group provided consistent programming, while special events like art classes, concerts, and the *Watatic* movie screening enriched our community life. The new tool library is an exciting addition, empowering residents to explore new skills and hobbies through hands-on workshops and encouraging sharing, reuse, and repair rather than making additional purchases of seldom used tools.

The Friends of the Library were instrumental in supporting the library's mission. They organized two vendor fairs, a spring book sale during the townwide yard sale, a fall book sale, and the lively AshbyFest in June, which featured artists, artisans, and live music. Their year-round sale of Ashby Library-branded merchandise and sponsorship of performers and supplies significantly enhanced our programs and services.

The Ashby Free Public Library remains a cornerstone of our community, offering educational, cultural, and recreational opportunities for all. We are proud to serve Ashby's residents and deeply appreciate the support that makes it all possible. Together, we made 2024 a remarkable year, and we look forward to an even brighter 2025. Thank you for your continued trust in and enthusiasm for your library.

Respectfully Submitted,
Heather Brodie Perry, *Library Director*

PARKS DEPARTMENT

Ashby Parks had a very busy and productive year. To start, one of our members did not run again but we would like to thank Rob Burnham for his time on the commission and all he did. Next we would like to welcome our newest member, Patrick Lyden for volunteering his time.

We had a great year with renewing the ballfields, painting the buildings and keeping up with the maintenance. The infields received multiple loads of material for the base lines. We purchased a special drag to help with the upkeep of the base lines, it works amazing. We purchased new bases for all the fields as well as home plates and pitching mounds.

The broken fences have been repaired on most of the fields. On the oldest minor league field we removed the fencing creating an open space.

The trees have been cleared along the back of the park and along Breed Rd to West. These trees have lived past their prime and started to die causing issues. This was why the decision was made to have them removed. Getting the stumps removed and land leveled is in progress.

We had a great year with the New England Ravens playing at the fields. The organization dedicated a lot of time into the spring cleanup as well as the regular maintenance. There were a lot of great games played along with great parent participation. We are looking forward to another great year with them utilizing Allen Field as their home turf!

We also had a lot of interest with the Sunday pickup softball games. It will be great to see this continue.

Allen Field held its annual 3rd of July Bonfire. It was another great event and had a huge attendance.

The annual Veterans and First Responders Car Show was again a great show. They had great participation once again.

The Parks Commission looks forward to another productive year and hopes everyone has a chance to enjoy the park.

NORTH MIDDLESEX REGIONAL SCHOOL DISTRICT



Lisa Martin, Chair, Pepperell
Randee Rusch, Member, Vice-Chair
Patrick McPhillips, Member, Pepperell
Bill Burg, Member, Townsend
Jill Twigg, Member, Pepperell
Brad Morgan – Superintendent of Schools
Gary Burboa-Reese – Assistant Superintendent

Thomas Casey, Member, Pepperell
Will Hackler, Member, Townsend
June McNeil, Member, Ashby
Lisa Bloom, Member, At-Large

REPORT OF SCHOOL COMMITTEE CHAIRPERSON

As we reflect on the past year, I wish to update you on the ongoing work and challenges facing the North Middlesex Regional School Committee. It has been a year of difficult decisions, extensive collaboration, and a continued focus on our mission to provide the best possible education for our students. However, we have also encountered substantial budgetary constraints that are threatening to impact our ability to deliver the level of educational services that we expect and that our communities deserve. These constraints are not just financial, but they also directly affect the quality of education our students receive, leading to potential cuts in programs, resources, and staff, a matter of grave concern for all of us.

School Committee Overview

The North Middlesex Regional School District School Committee is a team of nine dedicated members: three representatives from Pepperell, two from Townsend, one from Ashby, and three at-large representatives. Each member serves for a three-year term. Together, we are deeply committed to overseeing the district's policies, managing the annual budget, ensuring the financial health of our schools, and hiring and evaluating the Superintendent. In partnership with the school administration, we are unwavering in our mission to ensure that every child in our district has access to a high-quality education.

This year, the North Middlesex Regional School District mourned the loss of Susan Robbins, a dedicated School Committee member who served the district with distinction for 17 years. Known for her unwavering commitment to students, Ms. Robbins worked tirelessly on numerous subcommittees, always prioritizing the needs of the district and its community. Her deep devotion to education, family, and community left an indelible mark on all who knew her. In recognition of her remarkable contributions, a community member proposed naming the Performing Arts Center in her memory. This tribute is a fitting celebration of her legacy, as the center symbolizes the student achievements she passionately championed throughout her tenure.

In April 2024, the committee welcomed William Burg, Patrick McPhillips, and Jill Twigg as new members. At its annual organizational meeting on April 29, 2024, Lisa Martin was elected Chair, and Randee Rusch was elected Vice-Chair.

Throughout the year, committee members are invited to the schools to participate in or observe various activities. From reading to classes, observing STEM activities, listening to band and choral concerts, and watching drama productions and sporting events, these are opportunities to see our students fulfill their educational goals. One of the highlights of the year is celebrating the graduating class. Seeing the Class of 2024 walk across the stage is an emotional and inspiring event. Congratulations to the Class of '24!

Financial Strain: Facing Budget Deficits

The School Committee has been proactive in seeking solutions to these challenges. Unfortunately, our district's fiscal health has been a significant concern. Rising costs in many areas, including staffing, transportation, special education, and utilities, have remained challenging, and our available resources have remained limited. Our revenue sources, including town, state, and federal funding, have been unable to keep pace with these rising expenses.

As in years past, the FY25 budget development started early in the fall of 2023. The committee conducted budget summits with administration and town representatives. These summits allowed town and district leadership to communicate openly about the financial health of each town and the district as a whole.

Our committee held its annual budget public hearing on February 8, 2024. On March 14, 2024, the School Committee initially adopted a proposed FY25 budget of \$67,388,812, representing a 6.27% increase over the previous year. This budget was carefully crafted to maintain the quality of education and essential services while addressing the rising costs. It was presented to the towns of Pepperell, Townsend, and Ashby for approval. On April 29, 2024, the committee voted and approved a revised budget of \$67,084,143.

Pepperell successfully passed an override vote to support the school budget, but Townsend and Ashby did not. The School Committee revised the budget on June 28, 2024, voting to increase the Excess and Deficiency (E&D) amount to \$2,674,100 to mitigate shortfalls.

On July 9, 2024, the School Committee reduced the FY25 budget to \$66,084,143 to address the override failures in Townsend and Ashby. The final FY25 budget, representing a 4.21% increase, was approved at the Townsend and Ashby town meetings.

Looking Ahead

The North Middlesex Regional School Committee continues to grapple with a projected budget deficit of \$3 million for the upcoming year. This shortfall poses serious challenges, as we are responsible for ensuring that our students receive the highest-quality education without compromising on essential services.

We are advocating for increased funding at the state level. We encourage all residents to participate in conversations with local, state, and federal officials and make our voices heard on behalf of the future of our students at North Middlesex Regional School District.

Despite our challenges, the North Middlesex Regional School Committee remains committed to our mission of providing every student with a high-quality education. We are confident that with continued collaboration, innovative solutions, and the unwavering support of our community, we will emerge stronger and better equipped to face future challenges. Your support is our strength, and we are reassured by the knowledge that we are not alone in this journey.

To all the teachers, staff, students, committee members, and community members, we extend our heartfelt gratitude for your ongoing commitment to our schools and the NM community. Your support is invaluable and plays a crucial role in overcoming the financial hurdles. Together, we can ensure that our schools remain a source of pride for generations.

Respectfully Submitted,
Lisa Martin, *Chair, North Middlesex Regional School Committee*

REPORT OF THE SUPERINTENDENT OF SCHOOLS

Each year, it is the Superintendent's responsibility to advance the district with a strategic plan and budget that:

- Puts in place people, programs, and buildings;
- Supports energized instruction and engaged learning;
- Encourages innovation in all aspects of the school experience;
- Aligns with our core values; and
- Provides sufficient resources to ensure compliance with all federal, state, and locally mandated educational programs and requirements.

The Strategic Plan of the North Middlesex Regional School District serves as a road map for our work, with goals and strategies tied to our mission and vision. During the 2022-2023 school year, a committee was formed to update both NMRSD's Vision and Mission statements. The updated statements are as follows:

New Vision Statement:

We are NM: A safe, inclusive, student-centered community of persevering and empowered learners.

New Mission Statement:

At NM, we are committed to creating a diverse learning environment where students are provided a meaningful education through academic, social, and emotional learning experiences. Together with parents, caregivers, and the community, students are encouraged to ignite and embrace their individual potential to find success within NM and beyond.

As we enter the fifth and final year of our 5-Year Strategic Plan, we remain focused on addressing our three objectives:

1. **Consistent & Rigorous Curriculum:** Implement a rigorous and relevant curriculum while strengthening instructional practices that promote purposeful student engagement in learning.
2. **Meeting the Needs of All Students:** Develop and expand educational experiences to ensure all students receive high-quality learning opportunities for their academic, social, and emotional needs.
3. **Culture & Community:** Create opportunities to foster a cohesive district-wide climate, culture, and sense of community that benefits all stakeholders.

With our updated Vision and Mission, we will collaborate with stakeholders to develop:

- Updated Core Values to align with the new Vision and Mission statements;
- A Portrait of a Learner that reflects the attributes graduates of NMRSD will possess; and
- A new 5-Year Strategic Plan to outline our objectives for the coming years.

As in the past three years, NMRSD continues to make progress on initiatives within our strategic plan. These initiatives focus on student learning, social-emotional well-being, community, equity, anti-racism, and social justice.

Volunteerism and Donations

The North Middlesex Regional School District is a community built on volunteerism. The School Committee and administration are grateful to the individuals and groups who have contributed to district programs. We also extend our sincere appreciation to those who have donated countless hours to support and deliver services to the students of North Middlesex.

Personnel

The North Middlesex Regional School District bid farewell to 10 staff members who retired this past year:

- | | |
|-----------------------|------------------|
| • Michele Alfond | • Linda Dee |
| • Nina Arnold | • Heidi Delaney |
| • Tracey Burg | • Daniel Johnson |
| • Mary Ellen Cappucci | • Paula Mason |
| • Margaret Casson | • Wendy Orazio |

These dedicated staff members have left a lasting impact on education in Ashby, Pepperell, and Townsend. Their commitment to the students of the North Middlesex Regional School District will not be forgotten.

School District Budget

Highlights of the Fiscal 2024 Budget:

- The district's FY2024 operating budget consisted of \$63.1 million in current-year appropriations. There were no additional votes to increase or decrease the operating budget during the year. The district closed the year with 2.81% remaining in unencumbered expenditures. The Certified Excess and Deficiency (E&D) for the year was approved on October 3, 2024, for a total approved E&D of \$1,872,226.
- Revenues came in at \$621,963 higher than budgeted. Highlights include increases from the following lines:
 - Homeless Transportation \$69,944 over budget
 - Medicaid reimbursement \$68,908 over budget
 - Investment Income \$401,423 over budget
 - Miscellaneous Revenue, including Valley Collaborative Surplus, \$153,499 over budget
 - Chapter 71 and Charter Reimbursement (\$89,066) under budget
- The School Committee approved one budget transfer throughout the year to move additional funding to special education tuition, nursing, and legal lines. The transfer was covered with available funding in instructional support and operation and maintenance lines.

Capital Costs

Completed capital projects in FY2024 include:

- Ashby Elementary School - Cost of waste removal and hazardous disposal manifest
- Varnum Brook Elem. School - Destratification Fan (district portion of Green Community Grant)
- Nissitissit Middle School - Destratification Fan (district portion of Green Community Grant)
- Nissitissit Middle School - Nissitissit Middle School - Commercial tractor lease
- District-wide - Purchase of F350 Ford Truck
- District-wide - Partial cost of replacement motor for Ford Transit Van
- District-wide - Network equipment and switches refresh (to be completed in FY25)

Debt Service:

- The district renewed the short-term notes for the Hawthorne Brook/Squannacook Septic project, the accelerated repair projects, and the final

costs for the High School Construction project. The district continues to maintain its Aa3 general obligation bond rating.

Short-term bond (BANs) anticipation notes issued in FY2024:

- Accelerated Repair Feasibility Study Varnum Brook Elementary and Hawthorne Brook Middle School \$154,544
- Hawthorne Brook Middle School \$2,454,443, Varnum Brook Elementary School \$5,139,808, Squannacook Early Childhood Construction \$2,437,2148, North Middlesex Regional High School \$8,535,702

The long-term debt outstanding as of 6/30/2024:

- Nissitissit Middle School Construction Refunding \$230,000
- North Middlesex Regional High School Construction \$27,450,000

The General Fund expenditures & encumbrances for the year ending 6/30/24 were as follows:

Personnel Services	\$31,025,371
Contractual Services	\$ 1,202,340
Transportation, Regular ed	\$ 1,756,275
Supplies, Other	\$ 2,179,810
Utilities	\$ 1,454,186
Insurance & Retirement	\$10,942,696
Out of District Tuition & Transportation & Assess.	\$ 8,428,953
Transfer to Other Post Employment Trust	\$ 150,000
Transfer to Capital Projects	\$ 250,000
Debt Service	\$ 4,241,313
Total	\$61,630,944

2024 Federal and State Grants Awarded

Federal Grants:

105 Deeper Learning Implementation	\$ 14,000
116 Investigating History Expansion	\$ 11,200
140 Title IIA: Improving Educator Quality	\$ 62,372
151 Integrating SEL into Academic Learning	\$ 10,000
164 Instructional Math Materials	\$ 8,000
240 IDEA Special Education Allocation	\$ 964,204
262 SPED Early Education Allocation	\$ 38,846
274 SPED Program Improvement	\$ 33,085
305 Title I	\$ 391,250
309 Title IVA: Student Support & Acad. Enr.	\$ 30,634
653 Investigating History Pilot	\$ 63,378
729 Student Cellphone Use	\$ 8,000

State Grants:	
104 Financial Literacy Planning & Implem.	\$ 5,350
215 Genocide Education Grant	\$ 33,000
311 SEL & Mental Health	\$ 100,000
598 MyCAP Development & Implem.	\$ 14,984
School Health Services (DPH)	\$ 50,000
Other Grants:	
Chronic Absenteeism (Federal)	\$ 10,000
High Dosage Math Tutoring (Federal)	\$ 37,480
Project Lead the Way (Private)	\$ -
Total (FY24 Federal, State, & Other grant awards)	\$ 1,885,783

Respectfully submitted,
Brad Morgan, *Superintendent of Schools*

Special Education

The NMRSD Special Education Department annual report for the 2024-2025 school year provides an overview of the department's achievements, challenges, and ongoing initiatives supporting students with diverse learning needs.

The special education department oversees the special education eligibility, programming, and special education transportation provided to resident students attending our public schools, placed by parents in private schools, homeschooled, and attending out-of-district placements.

A free and appropriate public education (FAPE) is the fundamental Civil Right of students with disabilities in the least restrictive environment. By law, FAPE comes with a conference of ACADEMIC and FUNCTIONAL benefits, ensuring that the LRE is individualized to the needs of every student. LRE is not a specific location or placement, rather, it is the setting where a student with disabilities can receive FAPE.

The department’s mission is to provide high-quality, individualized, specially designed instruction and support to students with disabilities, fostering growth across all academic and functional areas. We envision an inclusive educational community where every student thrives.

The Special Education Department offers a wide array of programs tailored to meet the diverse needs of our students. These include individualized supports for students with autism, cognitive impairments, therapeutic/emotional disabilities, and specific learning disabilities (including dyslexia). Additionally, we provide robust supports for students who are included in general education classrooms for all or most of their day.

Programming for each student is individually tailored to meet their unique needs so that they can achieve their academic, functional, and personal goals.

Since 2021, there has been a significant increase in the number of students with disabilities requiring intensive, specially designed-instruction to access their education. The district has excelled in retaining students within our substantially separate programs from preschool through high school, supported by a team of knowledgeable, dedicated, and highly skilled special education professionals. These staff members consistently deliver specialized interventions and supports, enabling students to develop the skills necessary to access the curriculum and achieve independence as learners. Despite these efforts, the District continues to experience an annual increase in students with disabilities requiring intensive, specialized instruction that exceeds what can be feasibly provided within District programs, necessitating placement in separate public or private day schools and, on occasion, residential placements, all of which typically incur substantially higher costs.

The District's DESE-approved public day school program, the Learning Enrichment Autism Program (LEAP), serving students from preschool through grade four, has reached full capacity and can no longer accommodate additional students for the 2024-2025 school year. Furthermore, the District lacks comparable programming at these grade levels and does not offer similar programs at the middle or high school levels. As a result, future students requiring this level of support, or those needing continued programming beyond grade four, will need to be referred to public or private day school programs outside the District. This limitation will significantly impact the District's budget, as out-of-district placements typically incur substantially higher costs.

The special education department is in its first year of implementation with the new Individualized Educational Program (IEP) document. The new IEP document is student-centered and, in response, our staff are shifting the meeting format to facilitate more team discussion and collaboration. To implement this change and others associated with the new IEP document, staff are participating in ongoing professional development sessions focused on all aspects of the team meeting process and developing data-driven, student-centered IEPs.

Each day, I am profoundly reminded of and deeply grateful for our staff's professionalism, dedication, and unwavering commitment. Their efforts, coupled with the invaluable support of families in our communities, ensure that our students receive the education and care they need and deserve.

Respectfully submitted,
Erin Upton, *Director of Special Education*

Curriculum and Instruction

The curriculum and instruction department focuses on ensuring every student receives a guaranteed and viable curriculum experience that supports the district's strategic mission. The North Middlesex Regional School District's mission sets out "(t) to provide a comprehensive educational experience focused on students becoming contributing members of society."

Under the direction of the school superintendent and working collaboratively with the building administration, the curriculum office sought and received over \$140,000 in competitive grants through the Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education (DESE) to support educators in implementing new/updated curricula, enhance staff capacity to utilize high-quality instructional practices, and to provide acceleration support to students to address some of the missed learning opportunities as a result of the pandemic.

Our District Strategic Plan (located on our website) continues to address the three strategic objectives set out for our students, which include:

- Implement an engaging, rigorous curriculum aligned with state standards using high-quality instructional practices
- Develop and expand academic, social, and emotional learning experiences, programs, and supports that meet the individual needs, interests, and goals of our students.
- Establish and revise district and community initiatives that foster a climate and culture of respect and belonging.

Within the office for curriculum, we have been working hard to ensure that students are exposed to curriculum materials and resources that are in alignment with current research and the most effective practices. We are in the fourth year of fully implementing a highly rated (through both EdReports and DESE CURATE) reading curriculum for our elementary and middle school students, Expeditionary Learning (EL). This program is based on current research about the science of reading, which places a greater emphasis on building vocabulary and knowledge for reading success over rote drill and skill development. Additionally, we are in the third year of implementing a highly rated (through both Ed Reports and DESE CURATE) kindergarten - grade eight math curriculum called Illustrative Math (IM). We appreciate the continued support of families as teachers implement these programs.

I am thankful for the dedication and commitment of all school staff for their daily efforts to enrich our students' learning and support our families.

Respectfully submitted,

Gary Burboa-Reese, Ed.D., *Assistant Superintendent of Schools*

SQUANNACOOK EARLY CHILDHOOD CENTER

The NMRSD SECC preschool programming emphasizes each child's emotional, social, physical, and cognitive development. Alongside our integrated preschool classrooms, we proudly house two specialized programs:

- STEPS (*Positive Social Thinking Executive Planning Strategies*) Program
- LEAP (*Learning Enrichment Autism Program*) Classroom

Together, these programs encompass six classrooms that provide services to a diverse group of students, including those with developmental delays, autism spectrum disorder, and a variety of other disabilities. Each classroom is led by a Massachusetts Certified Special Education Teacher, supported by one to two paraprofessionals, ensuring high-quality and personalized care.

Our focus remains steadfast on fostering the growth and development of all children in our care. As was the case last year, we have experienced a continued increase in the number of children referred for special education evaluations. Referrals are often initiated by pediatricians, Early Intervention services, or parents/guardians. Despite this significant rise, our preschool evaluation staff—comprising a school psychologist, speech, occupational, and physical therapists, and classroom teachers—has done an outstanding job managing the increased demand. Their dedication has resulted in many children becoming eligible for the program and successfully transitioning into our classrooms.

I am incredibly proud of our preschool staff for the warm, welcoming, and supportive environment they create for all children enrolled in our program. Their efforts ensure that each child has the opportunity to thrive and grow within our community.

Thank you for allowing me to share our preschool program with the NMRSD community.

Respectfully Submitted,

Anne Cromwell-Gapp, M.Ed., CAGS in Ed. Leadership

Principal of AES/SECC and Director of Extended Day at AES/SMS/VBES

ASHBY ELEMENTARY SCHOOL

It is my privilege to present the twentieth annual report for Ashby Elementary School (AES), where our school climate is built on respect, responsibility, courage, and kindness.

Building Updates

In September 2022, the Ashby Building Committee—comprising June McNeil, Lisa Martin, Brad Morgan, Nancy Haines, Jeremy Hammond, David Amari, Dan Johnson,

Anne Cromwell-Gapp, Karen Walsh, David Nadeau, Scott Hobart, Dawn Roy, and Walter Hansen—focused on assessing and addressing our building's needs. Projects completed include:

- Installation of a new boiler
- Underground tunnel abatement
- Boarding and sealing off the old wing
- Completion of a heating study

The remaining projects include replacing lobby and hallway flooring and upgrading handicapped spaces in front of the building. These initiatives have been supported by \$300K in AARP funding.

Enrollment and Student Council

AES currently serves 155 students across eight classrooms:

- One kindergarten class
- Two first-grade classes
- One second-grade class
- One third-grade class
- Two fourth-grade classes

Our 13-member fourth-grade Student Council actively engages in community outreach, organizing coat and food drives, writing holiday cards for shut-ins, reciting morning announcements, and welcoming new students.

Curriculum and Instruction

Our curriculum programs include:

- Expeditionary Learning (EL) ELA Curriculum: Now in its third year
- Illustrative Math: Implemented district-wide, now in its second year
- Foundations Phonics Program: Used in grades K-3

Crew Activities: In their second year, AES staff have expanded Crew activities to Friday mornings, focusing on our four school-wide Habits of Character—*respect*, *responsibility*, *courage*, and *kindness*—through team-building and collaboration activities.

We also use technology-based learning tools, including:

- i-Ready: K-3 diagnostic assessments
- IXL (Math and Reading): Grades K-4
- Reflex Math: Grades 3-4 for math fluency

Additional curriculum includes the Pearson Social Studies Curriculum and Project Lead the Way for Science. AES follows the Second Step program for weekly SEL lessons, which build empathy, emotional management, and problem-solving skills. Additionally, the Massachusetts Aggression Reduction Center (MARC) provides

weekly anti-bullying lessons for each grade level, taught by the school counselor.

Special Services and Unified Arts

Our team includes:

- Two special education teachers and three paraprofessionals supporting grades K-4
- Speech and language services, occupational therapy, and physical therapy as needed

We offer robust Unified Arts programs, including computers, music, PE, library, and art. Additionally, our full-time interventionist provides small-group ELA support for K-2 students.

Communication and Community Partnerships

- The weekly S'mores Newsletter keeps families informed.
- The AES Facebook page shares updates several times weekly.
- We partner with local colleges to welcome Practicum and Pre-Practicum teachers, bringing fresh perspectives to curriculum and instruction.

School Council and Parent-Teacher Cooperative

The AES School Council meets monthly to align its Improvement Plan with the District Strategic Plan. Members include Mrs. Johnson, Mrs. Dancause, Mrs. Lyden, Mrs. McNabb, and Mrs. Haigh.

Our Parent-Teacher Cooperative (PTC) supports cultural and curriculum-based programs, hosting events like the Holiday Shopping event and assemblies. Contact us at agapp@nmrsd.org or (978) 743-1005 for more information.

Yearly Traditions and Extended Day Program

AES maintains beloved traditions such as:

- Digital yearbooks for fourth grade
- Dr. Seuss Book Giveaway
- Spirit Weeks, Field Day, music concerts, and Walk to School Days
- First-grade presentation of *"The Kissing Hand"* (sponsored by the Ashby Alumni Association)
- Dictionary giveaways for third graders (sponsored by the Beacon Lodge)

The Extended Day Program, now in its fourth year, serves 117 students across AES, Spaulding Memorial, and Varnum Brook Elementary Schools. Learn more about the AES Extended Day Program.

Respectfully Submitted,

Mrs. Cromwell-Gapp, M.Ed., CAGS in Ed. Leadership
Principal, Ashby Elementary School

HAWTHORNE BROOK MIDDLE SCHOOL

It is a privilege to share news about Hawthorne Brook Middle School with you. We ended 2024 with an enrollment of nearly 450 students. Our student body is becoming increasingly diverse, with a growing multilingual population. In addition to English, our students speak a number of languages, including Arabic, Chinese, French, Portuguese and Spanish. We value the variety of viewpoints each student brings when they enter our building. As our new student-painted mural proclaims, we tell all students that “You belong here.”

Students at Hawthorne Brook continue to experience a rigorous program of studies. Teachers use the EL curriculum as their foundation for language arts instruction. Math class is anchored by the highly-rated Illustrative Math program. Students in grades five through seven participate in the Investigating History program, while eighth graders complete a civics course and civics action project. Last year, students completed the civics action project in a collaboration that took place with the language arts teachers and the civics teachers, culminating in a civics project fair, held for families in May.

Science continues to be highlighted across the curriculum. Lessons in classrooms are interactive and hands-on. All students also take a STEM (science, technology, engineering and mathematics) course as one of their unified arts classes. STEAM day is always a highlight of the spring. HBMS brings in a variety of professionals, who complete an array of activities with students and showcase a number of different career opportunities for our middle schoolers.

STEM skills are also a highlight of several extracurricular activities. HBMS has a Robotics Club that competes against local high schools. Hawthorne Brook also hosts a Math Club that participates in a local competition.

Hawthorne Brook offers a wealth of unified arts classes. In addition to the STEM class, all students participate in a Media Studies Class, analyzing and creating media offerings. Arts classes include band, choir, music class, visual arts and theater class. A change from the previous year is that students across all grade levels have the opportunity to participate in theater (not only students in grades 5 & 6). Our extracurricular theater program is flourishing also, with participation in the spring theater festival, as well as an annual fall musical.

Our music program continues to grow: more than 30% of Hawthorne Brook students participate in band; 20% of students participate in choir. As is tradition, members of the band perform holiday songs in the lobby as students enter the building on the last day of school before winter break.

All students also take part in both physical education and health class. In addition to classes, there are a variety of other sporting opportunities. Many students come to

school in the morning before school officially begins to participate in open gym several times a week. There are also opportunities for students to participate in a variety of sports: basketball, cross country, field hockey, and track and field. In addition to the inter-district sports, HBMS is home to a fantastic intramural basketball program, in which more than a quarter of the student body participates.

The theme of belonging is highlighted across other extracurricular activities as well. Hawthorne Brook has an active student council, which supports the student body and the community in a variety of ways. This past year they hosted fundraisers for MS and breast cancer awareness. They also conduct a food drive every year around Thanksgiving. Our American Sign Language club, another example of inclusivity, is a very popular extracurricular offering, unique to Hawthorne Brook. Students also participate in the Yearbook Club and School Store.

As middle schoolers learn where they fit in the broader community, a highlight of eighth grade is the annual trip to Washington D.C. Students get to experience firsthand the workings of government, and see how their civics class applies to their own lives. Hawthorne Brook is grateful for continued support from both the community and from our outstanding Parent Teacher Organization. We recognize that “you belong here” is not limited only to students and staff, but also extends to the community as a whole. We are honored to play a role in the education of the community’s students, but we recognize that it truly takes a village.

We invite you to follow our weekly newsletter, posted on our school website (<https://hbms.nmrsl.org>) and our social media pages every Friday afternoon for more information. We at Hawthorne Brook wish you and your families a safe and healthy 2025. Thank you for your continued support.

Respectfully submitted,

Chantele Olmstead, *Principal, Hawthorne Brook Middle School*

Jason White, *Assistant Principal, Hawthorne Brook Middle School*

NORTH MIDDLESEX REGIONAL HIGH SCHOOL

North Middlesex Regional High School, home to approximately 700 students and 80 dedicated faculty and staff, continues to thrive as a vibrant hub of academic and extracurricular excellence.

Middle School Collaboration and NM Showcase

This year, we proudly launched the *NM Showcase*, a new initiative developed in collaboration with our middle school administrators. Replacing the traditional 8th Grade Open House, the Showcase offered incoming students and their families a dynamic and comprehensive preview of high school life. Through interactive

presentations, attendees explored our academic programs, athletic opportunities, and extracurricular offerings, creating excitement for their upcoming journey at NM.

School Strengths

We are proud to offer a diverse range of programs that nurture talent, foster growth, and prepare students for success:

- **Performing Arts:** Our Band and Choral programs are celebrated for their outstanding achievements and dedication to artistic excellence.
- **Service Learning:** Students actively participate in meaningful projects that give back to the community while developing real-world skills. Notable initiatives include the New York and New Orleans Service Learning trips and *The Giving Tree* program.
- **Creative Arts and Engineering:** From vibrant art classes to hands-on engineering experiences, students develop both creativity and technical expertise.
- **Advanced Academics:** With 17 Advanced Placement (AP) courses, our students are challenged to excel and prepare for college-level academics.
- **Inclusion Opportunities:** Our thriving *Best Buddies* program continues to build connections and promote inclusivity. This year, we're excited to introduce two new courses in the English and Physical Education departments modeled after *Best Buddies*.

Athletic Achievements

NM offers a robust athletic program, including 23 varsity sports, five co-op teams, and three unified sports (Basketball, Strength & Conditioning, and Track & Field).

This past year, many of our athletic teams showcased exceptional talent and determination:

- Baseball, Boys Lacrosse, Girls Lacrosse, Boys Volleyball
- Golf, Girls Volleyball, Girls Soccer, and Field Hockey

All competed in postseason tournaments, making our school and community proud.

Student Honors

We are thrilled to recognize the exceptional accomplishments of our students:

- **Tri-M Honor Society:** Celebrating excellence in music.
- **National Honor Society:** Recognizing students for academic achievement, leadership, service, and character.

- Rho Kappa Honor Society: Honoring students for excellence in history and the social sciences. In addition, juniors completed *Civic Action Projects*, engaging with the government by addressing real-world issues in their communities.

School Spirit and Community Engagement

At NM, we live by our motto: *We Are NM*. This fall, we deepened connections with alumni and the broader community through expanded Homecoming activities:

- Homecoming Weekend: Every varsity sport competed, drawing enthusiastic support from students, families, and fans.
- Homecoming Parade: After years on hiatus, the parade returned with great success, featuring participants from all three towns in our district—Ashby, Pepperell, and Townsend. The incredible turnout showcased our community's pride and unity.

Looking ahead, we aim to strengthen alumni involvement further. To support this, we are building the *North Middlesex Alumni Database* to keep our graduates informed and engaged. Alumni can add their information by visiting Alumni Information.

(<https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfVHr-PnYyMZ2jxMiUISsXXbwI7ZFxtuIT5X21rYFKbEFjvKw/viewform>)

At North Middlesex Regional High School, we remain dedicated to fostering an environment where students achieve their fullest potential both in and out of the classroom. Be sure to follow our monthly newsletter, posted on the NMRHS website (<https://nmrhs.nmrhsd.org>) at the beginning of each month, for updates and highlights.

Thank you for your continued support. We wish you and your families a safe, joyful, and healthy 2025!

Respectfully submitted,

Laurie Smith, *Principal, North Middlesex Regional High School*

Ryan DeMar, *Assistant Principal/Athletic Director, North Middlesex Regional High School*

MONTACHUSETT REGIONAL VOCATIONAL TECHNICAL SCHOOL

Letter from Leadership

In the long-storied history of the Montachusett Regional Vocational Technical School District, I am confident that the 2023-2024 school year will stand out as one of the more memorable years in its workforce training legacy. Personally, it marked my second year as Superintendent and tenth, overall at Monty Tech. Thus, as a proud

district leader, and in support of the ground-breaking efforts of our students, faculty, staff and administration, it is my honor to highlight some of those initiatives with you, our school community, in this annual report.

Throughout 2023-2024, Monty Tech took significant steps to address a growing concern facing vocational education in the Commonwealth – the overall lack of capacity to meet the demand for vocational training. In Monty Tech’s case, well over 800 8th-grade students will typically apply for the approximately 350 available seats in the incoming freshmen class. Unable to simply accept more students here, Monty Tech implemented a creative strategy using a state-funded Lab Modernization grant to lease a nearby vacant warehouse with the intent of converting it into a contemporary workforce training facility that, when completed, will provide students training in House Carpentry, Electrical and Plumbing trades. The district navigated the design and permitting process that allowed for the initial renovation to begin, and formed meaningful partnerships with Fitchburg, Gardner and Narragansett School Districts. The Department of Elementary and Secondary Education (DESE) approved the partnerships’ applications, and as a result, the Montachusett Vocational Partnership (MVP) Academy was slated to begin in 2024-2025, serving as many as 84 high school students in its first year.

While the MVP Program will result in the largest expansion of workforce training in our region, it represents only one dedicated effort to offer such instruction to a variety of constituencies. Monty Tech remains committed to offering career skills training to adult-students who are unemployed or underemployed by providing no-cost offerings in a number of fields. In the fall of 2023, Monty Tech was awarded a \$720,000 Career Technical Initiative grant, so that even more adult learners would have an opportunity to earn valuable industry-recognized credentials, hands-on learning experiences, and receive job placement services upon program completion.

Monty Tech also identified a previously underserved population, young adults with disabilities, and successfully delivered one of its most rewarding programs to date - the Supportive Training & Education Program (STEP) in the spring of 2024. Initiated through an award of \$133,900 in funds made available through the Commonwealth Corporation, Monty Tech developed a 12-week program that included hands-on and professional skills training as well as two-weeks of paid internships through industry partners to twelve young adults (18-25 yrs. old) seeking an opportunity to overcome a variety of physical, emotional and cognitive disabilities, many of whom came from our nearby educational partner, CAPS Collaborative. In its pilot year, Monty Tech took great pride in knowing that we were the only regional vocational school district in the Commonwealth to participate in this meaningful workforce training initiative.

A defining aspect of the Monty Tech experience is certainly our countless school-to-business partnerships, developed and maintained to benefit students and graduates

alike. Last year, Monty Tech saw its largest number of students placed in real world learning opportunities through the school’s Co-operative Education Program - 235 seniors and second-semester juniors earned co-op positions, or more than 1 in 3 of all seniors and juniors, were placed by the end of the school year. These opportunities would not be possible without the ongoing support of our employer partners, and we remain so very grateful.

We fully acknowledge that our success depends upon, and is wholly enriched by, the ongoing support of the civic leadership and citizens of our eighteen communities. On behalf of everyone at Monty Tech, thank you for your continued support. We are so honored to be an educational partner to all of our communities.

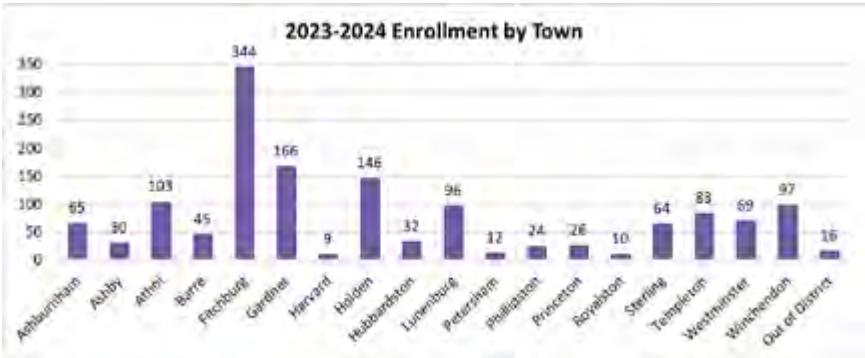
Thomas R. Browne, *Superintendent-Director*

Our School Community

Montachusett Regional Vocational Technical School, more widely known as “Monty Tech,” is a four-year career and technical high school serving eighteen member communities, including:

Ashburnham	Harvard	Princeton
Ashby	Holden	Royalston
Athol	Hubbardston	Sterling
Barre	Lunenburg	Templeton
Fitchburg	Petersham	Westminster
Gardner	Phillipston	Winchendon

In 2023-2024, Monty Tech served 1,428 students in grades nine through twelve, representing each of the district’s eighteen sending communities. Each class of students was comprised of a relatively equal balance of male and female students, all of whom were prepared to explore an interest in one of the school’s twenty-one rigorous vocational-technical programs. While the school currently offers only five non-traditional programs for male students, and twelve non-traditional programs for female students, we are proud to have a student population that is well-balanced by gender and a variety of academic interests and achievements.



Financial Report

FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024
Educational Plan • \$28,605,425	Educational Plan • \$30,796,896	Educational Plan • \$32,535,101
Grants • 3,734,533	Grants • 2,963,607	Grants • 2,760,905

Each year, Monty Tech’s Business Manager works in conjunction with the Superintendent and 22-member School Committee, to develop a cost-effective budget that reflects the values and priorities of the institution. The final fiscal year 2023-2024 Educational Plan totaled \$32,535,101 which represented a 5.6% increase over the 2022-2023 Educational Plan, driven in large part by the 7.6% increase in the District’s required minimum spending established by the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education. Remarkably, Monty Tech’s FY24 budget only exceeded the minimum spending required by Massachusetts General Law Chapter 70 by \$150,000 or 0.05%.

While we are proud to offer vital education and training programs at a minimal cost to our member communities, we understand that vocational education is, in fact, more costly than a traditional, comprehensive academic program. To that end, school officials pursue countless grant opportunities to expand and improve training programs each year. For the fiscal year 2024, state and federal grant sources provided the school with \$2,760,905. Programs funded by these grants include: Elementary and Secondary Schools Emergency Relief Funds, Improving Teacher Quality, Special Education Services and Program Improvement, Title I Support, Perkins Occupational Education, Vocational Capital Equipment Initiatives, Student Support and Academic Enrichment and Marine Corp Junior Reserve Officer Training.

Expenses for the 2023-2024 school year included:

District Expenses by Category	
District Leadership	\$1,171,797
Fixed Assets	\$460,000
Fixed Charges	\$5,776,116
Instruction.....	\$17,360,292
Operations & Maintenance.....	\$4,010,265
Student Services	\$3,716,631

Choosing Vocational

More and more we hear students and parents considering a vocational high school experience because they see the value in a balanced, well-rounded high school education that prepares the student for both college and career pathways. While

vocational programs like Health Occupations, Engineering and Early Childhood Education require a college degree to be competitive in the workforce, other programs like Carpentry, Masonry, and Cosmetology do not. Thus, it is imperative that we prepare students for both. It is not surprising, then, to see that 34% of the Class of 2024 entered the workforce, while another 44% enrolled at a 4-year college or university. What should be noted, though, are those students who do both. So often students who enroll in a 2-year college (13% of the Class of 2024) are balancing their continued studies with part-time (or even full-time) employment. Those students, no doubt, are relying on the skills they learned at Monty Tech to help as they work their way through a degree program.

We know the value of a vocational education, and we see that our students are prepared when they leave, but how can we increase access to help prepare even more students for bright futures? In recent years, vocational schools across the Commonwealth have grown in popularity. We have seen a steady increase in the number of students applying for admission to Massachusetts vocational schools, and Monty Tech is no exception. In FY24, there were 827 applications for the 355 seats available in the Freshman class. With more than 400 students placed on a waitlist each year because of a lack of space, school officials met to craft new opportunities for students who have been excluded from a vocational high school experience, due to limits imposed by existing building capacity. FY24 marked what may be considered the school's greatest collaboration and most creative solution to the capacity issue at hand. Monty Tech leased a 16,000 sq. ft. facility with the goal of renovating the space to create new vocational training labs to serve as many as 125 additional high school students and 120 adult students annually. With a goal to expand access so that more graduates enter the workforce with a set of valuable skills and industry-recognized credentials that will make them more employable and better equipped to grow and learn in the occupation of their choosing, Monty Tech, in partnership with Fitchburg Public Schools, Gardner Public Schools, and Narragansett Regional School District developed the Montachusett Partnership Academy ("MVP Academy").

Academics

While students attending Monty Tech benefit from project-based, hands-on learning often associated with a vocational-technical high school experience, they must also complete all of the same academic requirements that their peers in comprehensive districts accomplish. At Monty Tech, we believe a well-rounded high school experience includes rigorous and meaningful academic lessons. We are proud of our students' accomplishments in the classroom, as well as in their vocational shops.

During the Spring of 2024, 10th grade students took the Next Generation MCAS in English Language Arts, Mathematics, and Biology. In addition, select 9th graders also sat for the Next Generation MCAS Biology exam. Students performed well across all subject areas, with a passing rate of 97% in English Language Arts, 95%

in Mathematics, and 97% in Biology. With regard to accountability, Monty Tech continues to make substantial progress toward targets.

Monty Tech’s academic programs continue to evolve to prepare graduates for diverse and challenging college and career pathways and are widely known to effectively prepare students at all levels to reach their goals. A focus in recent years has been the incorporation of new and updated materials and coursework to expand STEM opportunities for students with PLTW, AP, and dual enrollment options, especially in math and science. In addition, three of our science teachers are planning to attend the National Science Teachers Conference in 2024 to explore innovative instructional practices and new technologies.

In May of 2024, our students participated in AP exams and student performance showed outstanding results. In general, participation was strong with high numbers of students taking AP Exams (180 total). Those students took a record number of AP exams last year with a total of 262.

	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
Total AP Students	106	142	120	184	180
Number of Exams	146	189	162	244	262
AP Students with Scores 3+	75	61	82	104	130
% of Total AP Students with Scores 3+	70.75%	42.96%	68.33%	56.52%	72.22%

Since the pandemic, the exam process and format has shifted, but our results continue to show progress. Most importantly, a record number of Monty Tech students were eligible to receive college credit with qualifying scores of 3 or higher (130 total) - an impressive 72%. With regard to specific exams, 36 of our students took the exam for AP Seminar and AP Research. More than 90% of these Monty Tech students qualified for college credit. Not only did these students outperform all subjects, they performed better than most state, national, and global averages - an outstanding result for the second year of implementation. Finally, we had 19 AP Scholars - a growing number for Monty Tech (AP Scholars earn a qualifying score on at least 3 AP exams).

Monty Tech continues to provide the following AP opportunities for students: AP English Literature & Composition, AP Language & Composition, AP Calculus, AP Statistics, AP Environmental Science, AP Chemistry, AP Physics, AP Psychology, AP Seminar, and AP Research. Due to the success of AP Seminar and AP Research, we plan to expand access to grade 10 students by adding a new course entitled English 10 AP Seminar.

Vocational Training

Preparing students for high-skill, high-wage careers requires technical proficiency, an ability to break down complex lessons into “bite sized” concepts, and a lot of patience. Our team of vocational instructors are not only skilled tradesmen and women, they are patient, collaborative and talented teachers, responsible for training the next generation’s workforce. Their commitment to student achievement, community service, and advanced technical knowledge and skills is unmatched, and we are so grateful that they have chosen this profession, sharing their expertise with our students. 2023-2024 was a busy year across the District, with students working and learning in shops, on off-campus construction sites, and with area business leaders, refining their skills. We are proud to highlight some notable accomplishments.

Advanced Manufacturing: Advanced Manufacturing students continue to work in a state-of-the-art machine shop and may earn a number of industry-recognized credentials to demonstrate their technical capacity. All junior students completed NC3 PMI 6 Certification. These students have 6 stackable credentials in precise measurement. The seniors earned an additional 6 stackable credentials in Advanced Measuring Instrument this year, which expands upon the PMI credentials earned in the Junior year, demonstrating more advanced measurement skills. All sophomores passed MACWIC level 1, while all Freshman students successfully completed safety training, earning an OSHA 10-hour general industry certification. The program is proud to have completed many projects for the community, while supporting fourteen Seniors and seven Juniors in their co-op placements, where they work and learn with employer partners in area machine shops. (Total student enrollment: 60)

Auto Body Collision Repair Technology: Monty Tech Auto Body students earned valuable industry credentials in the 2023-2024 School year. Students earned the OSHA 10-hour general industry card, EPA 6H spray certification, ALI Lift Certification, I-CAR Pro-Level 1 in refinishing, and I-CAR Pro-Level 1 in Collision Repair. Two Seniors and three juniors earned co-op placements and were reported to be valuable contributors to local repair shops in the area. At the SkillsUSA District Competition, students won a gold and a bronze medal in collision repair, a silver and bronze in estimating, and a gold medal in refinishing. A Junior student won a gold medal at the SkillsUSA State competition and travelled to the National competition in June 2024 to demonstrate their skills in Collision Repair. The program worked to maintain the school’s fleet of vehicles, vans, and trailers, and painted the wiring rack for the MVP project and completed additional work for Troop #193 Winchendon. (Total student enrollment: 65)

Automotive Technology: Seniors in the Automotive Technology program earned their NC3/Snap-On Apollo D8 Certification, while Juniors earned the NC3/Snap-On 525F Digital Multimeter certification. The Freshmen students earned the OSHA 10 Safety certification & the Shopkey Pro Service & Repair Information Level 1

certification.. The sophomores received the Shopkey Pro & SureTrack Advanced Level 2 Certification. These industry-recognized credentials will enhance the student's level of competency within the automotive industry for years to come. Seven Seniors earned Co-op placements, while the shop continued to service, repair, and diagnose approximately four hundred vehicles throughout the year. These jobs included basic maintenance, inspections, alignments, brakes, exhaust, tires, and more advanced jobs including advanced electric diagnosis. Students worked closely with instructors to rewire, replace and add electrical devices to the trailer of Troop #193 Winchendon, as well. An Automotive Technology Senior supported the program with his Eagle Badge Service Project, raising funds and purchasing six tool carts, six retractable air lines, as well as a numbering system and signage for our lifts. (Total student enrollment: 65)

Business Technology: Monty Tech's Business Technology program continues to introduce students to a broad scope of financial literacy lessons. All Juniors and Seniors earned a financial literacy certificate from the MassMutual Foundation FutureSmart program. The 2023-2024 school year saw several top students earn recognition at the various SkillsUSA competitions, with one student competing in the Customer Service competition at the District level and a first-ever Entrepreneurship Team competing at the State level. Eight Seniors and three Juniors earned co-op placements, while all Freshmen and Sophomores completed the OSHA 10-hour and CareerSafe Interview skills training and certification. (Total student enrollment: 65)

Cabinetmaking: Monty Tech Cabinetmaking students are called upon for a number of projects, small and large, across the campus and beyond. During the 2023-2024 school year, students completed projects that included: installation of cabinets for the newly renovated Early Childhood classrooms; building and installing cabinets and new countertops in the Continuing Education Office; designing, constructing and installing three bulletin boards for the main corridors of Monty Tech; building a custom design, large birdcage for the school's Veterinary Science clinic; and building new cabinets and storage units for the district's Science classrooms. Ten Seniors and seven Juniors earned co-op placements, representing the program so well. Sophomores completed OSHA Construction 10-hour training and certification program, while Freshmen completed the OSHA Careersafe 10-hour online course. (Total student enrollment: 69)

CAD/Drafting & Design: In 2023-2024, five Monty Tech CAD/Drafting & Design Senior students and one Junior earned co-op placements. Students were also able to achieve a number of valuable industry-recognized certifications including Autodesk Inventor, Revit, Autodesk AutoCAD and SolidWorks. Freshmen students completed the 10-hour OSHA CareerSafe Online course. Two students competed in the SkillsUSA States Competition in Architectural Drafting and Technical Drafting. The shop completed a variety of signs, banners, and posters for the school, as well as layout designs for the Winchendon YMCA Playground and Monty Tech's proposed Auto Body/Collision Repair spray booth. (Total student enrollment: 55)

Cosmetology: The Monty Tech Cosmetology program is one of the only programs that students may leave and directly enter the industry, fully licensed and ready for a career. The state-approved program is rigorous and provides students with countless opportunities to refine their cosmetology skills on clientele who understand and appreciate the learning environment. All 16 Seniors and five Juniors earned their cosmetology licenses – an incredibly successful pass rate and demonstration of the students’ skills and abilities. Five Seniors participated in the job shadowing program, which gave them an opportunity to learn from practicing professionals, as well as offers for full-time employment prior to graduation! (Total student enrollment: 84)

Culinary Arts: Monty Tech Culinary Arts students and instructors operate a full-service restaurant and bakery, serving approximately 70-90 patrons daily. They host a number of banquets and receptions throughout the year, to include: Welcome Back/New Teachers reception, Principals & Counselors Day luncheon, and two large scale Program Advisory Dinner/meetings annually. The program continues to donate leftover baked goods to Our Father's House in Fitchburg and the Salvation Army in Fitchburg. Freshmen earned their OSHA 10-hour Culinary certification, while Sophomores and Juniors earned their Allergen Awareness certification, and Juniors and Seniors earned their Servsafe credentials. Juniors took a field trip to Johnson and Wales University, and freshmen went to Gardner Ale House, in Gardner, to learn about restaurant management. (Total student enrollment: 68)

Dental Assisting: Monty Tech Dental Assisting instructors have emphasized the need for students to earn valuable industry-recognized credentials, as a means to demonstrate technical skill and proficiency. As a result, all students work and prepare for Dental Assisting National Board (DANB) certification exams. In 2023-2024, all students passed the DANB Infection Control exam, and the DANB Radiology exam. This excellent pass rate is a true testament to the high-quality instruction in the Monty Tech Dental Assisting program, and something the school continues to be so proud of. A total of ten Seniors and three Juniors earned co-op placements, while the remaining Juniors and Seniors earned experience in affiliation/externship in area dental clinics and offices. All Seniors & Sophomores received the American Red Cross for Basic Life Support CPR/AED certification. Through the Community Health Connections Caring for Kids Program, Monty Tech students could receive free dental cleaning, radiographs, and sealants. Monty Tech Dental students were allowed to assist in their procedures. (Total student enrollment: 57)

Early Childhood Education: Ten Seniors and one Junior in the school’s Early Childhood Education program earned co-op placements, gaining valuable experience working with young children in local childcare centers. Three Seniors and one Juniors also gained experience on externships. All Sophomore and Seniors completed their First Aid/CPR training, and six Seniors also earned the Child Development Associate National certification. All thirteen Seniors worked with instructors to submit

applications for the MA Department of Early Education and Care Teacher certification. Freshmen hosted a mock baby shower, collecting donations for Montachusett Opportunity Council to benefit families in the community. Sophomores and Juniors assisted in Head Start Preschool classrooms, earning training hours for the national certification. Sophomore students also collaborated with students enrolled in Graphic Communications to create children's books, further benefitting the Monty Tech-Head Start partnership, designed to provide meaningful hands-on learning opportunities for all students in the Early Childhood Education program. (Total student enrollment: 47)

Electrical: Throughout 2023-2024, students and instructors in the Monty Tech Electrical program wired numerous electrical projects within the school. Sixteen Seniors and eight Juniors earned co-op placements, which allowed them to gain important on-the-job skills and additional training in the industry. Students and instructors wired the Habitat for Humanity house on Granite St. in Fitchburg, changed out and added emergency lighting for the Ashburnham American Legion, worked on HVAC equipment for the Baldwinville American Legion, and added electrical service, security systems, fire alarm, and all power and lighting to the MVP Academy. The Freshman class was filled with 24 first choice students, and all successfully completed the 10-hour OSHA training and certification. (Total student enrollment: 94)

Engineering Technology: The Engineering Technology program at Monty Tech is a rigorous program, infused with a nationally certified curriculum provided by Project Lead the Way, and countless hands-on learning opportunities that provide students with opportunities to demonstrate creativity, make connections with prior learning, earn college credits, and attain industry recognized certifications. Eight Seniors earned co-op placements during the 2023-2024 school year. All Freshmen completed the OSHA 10-hour General Industry training and certification program. The program also benefitted from new technology, which was used to design and laser cut holiday and prom gifts for community service. (Total student enrollment: 58)

Graphic Communications: Throughout the 2023-2024 school year, students in the Graphic Communications program produced numerous projects for our district cities and towns, and a variety of non-profit organizations within the district. Three talented Seniors earned co-op placements, which allowed them to continue their on-the-job training in a real-world work setting. The program was extremely well represented in SkillsUSA competitions, with two students winning gold medals for Pin Design and T-Shirt Design. Both students travelled to the National Convention in Atlanta, GA and continued to make the district so proud. Instructors were delighted to receive several new pieces of equipment to enhance the training program, and look forward to additional equipment to encourage more creativity from our students in the coming years. Seniors presented their senior thesis project at the end of the year to the community and industry professionals, at the 2nd annual showcase event. (Total student enrollment: 85)

Health Occupations: The Health Occupations program continues to be one of the more competitive programs at Monty Tech, providing a rigorous education grounded in current medical knowledge and practice, balanced by hands-on learning opportunities in the on-site Sim Lab and through the use of state-of-the-art Anatomage technology. Instructors work to continuously improve instructional spaces, technology and equipment for student training purposes. Twenty-six Seniors partnered with area clinics through the co-op program, where they continued to learn and flourish in their chosen field, while back on campus, students focused on achieving important industry-recognized credentials. Twenty-four students passed the Clinical Medical Assistant exam, becoming nationally certified medical assistants. Twenty-five students passed the Nurse Aide Exam, and four Seniors passed the phlebotomy technician certification exam. All Sophomores obtained their CPR, First Aid, and Alzheimer's Association Certification, while the Freshmen completed the 10-Hour OSHA training and certification program. (Total student enrollment: 108)

House Carpentry: The Monty Tech House Carpentry program completed a number of projects, large and small during this 2023-2024 School year. Juniors and Seniors were tasked with a variety of projects to complete a single-family residence for Habitat for Humanity in Fitchburg. Students completed all framing, roofing and exterior trim details, and installed all exterior doors and windows. Afterwards, they turned their attention to the district's new training facility - the MVP Academy, located at 270 Westminster Street in Fitchburg. Staff and students continue to support local charitable organizations with donations of our Adirondack chairs built by the Freshmen in the program. Sixteen Juniors earned the Hot Work certification; Eighteen Sophomores received their OSHA 10-hour Construction certifications; All Sophomores, Juniors and Seniors also successfully completed the Scissor Lift Training. Seven Seniors and five Juniors participated in the co-op program this year. (Total student enrollment: 67)

HVAC & Property Maintenance: The 2023-2024 school year was the second year the HVAC & Property Maintenance program competed in the Facilithon, a leadership in Facilities Management competition for the SkillsUSA competition. Instructors were proud of their students' performance and remain committed to preparing students for this competition annually. Seven Seniors and four juniors earned co-op placements in area businesses. All Juniors earned EPA Universal Licenses, as well as Hot Work certifications. Freshmen completed the OSHA 10-hour General Industry certification, while Sophomores earned the OSHA 10-hour Construction Industry certification. Monty Tech HVAC students were the first high school students in Massachusetts to successfully complete a five-day Building Science and Energy auditing course, earning 3 new industry credentials (GPRO, BPI, and Health Homes). These certificates open the door to careers in energy auditing, weatherization and insulation. Students continued to service equipment ranging from lawnmowers to air compressors, and also completed two extensive rebuilds: an ATV and a lawn tractor. In Phillipston, students worked to relocate an exterior set of stairs at the Town Offices and refinished

the existing decking and railings. In Baldwinville, students completed the installation of a heating and cooling system at the American Legion. In Templeton, students also completed repairs of the gazebo on the town common, then primed and painted it. The program benefited from grant funding and donations which allowed instructors to purchase equipment needed to expand metal fabrication lessons and outfit an off-campus job trailer. (Total student enrollment: 63)

Information Technology: The Information Technology program continues to offer students opportunities to earn a wide range of industry-recognized certifications that affirm the technical skill proficiency needed for entry-level careers in networking and information technology. In 2023-2024, all Freshmen completed the OSHA 10-hour General Industry training. One Senior and one Junior competed in the SkillsUSA state Competition. Three Seniors and four Juniors enjoyed co-op placements, applying their technical skills in area businesses. Five Seniors and six Juniors achieved the TestOut Security Pro course certification, while a team of four Seniors achieved a 3rd Place Gold Tier Award in the Cyberpatriot National Youth Cyber Education State Competition. Students in the Junior Class designed a website for the Monty Tech Greenhouse, and repaired computer hardware for individuals in the community. (Total student enrollment: 37)

Masonry: The talents of Monty Tech Masonry students are on display throughout district communities, as projects that were completed during the 2023-2024 school year include: construction of a brick garden bench at the Sterling Senior Center, rebuilding a Revolution Tomb in Ashby, and completing masonry repairs at the Winchendon Housing Authority. The program also completed concrete and block work for the new MVP Academy building and built a retaining wall for a new security gate on the school's busy campus. Sophomores received their 10-hour OSHA Construction certification, while all Freshmen completed the 10-OSHA General Industry training and certification. Juniors and Seniors were Hot Work certified. Three Seniors and four Juniors earned co-op placements and continued to refine their skills working with business partners through the school's co-op program. Finally, Monty Tech Masonry students competed in the Mass Trowel Trades Competition, held at Bay Path and attended the Techo-Bloc trade show in Burlington to gain a deeper appreciation for emerging industry trends. (Total student enrollment: 62)

Plumbing: For the 2023-2024 school year, students and instructors completed the plumbing on the Habitat for Humanity house located on Taft Street in Fitchburg, and began the plumbing installation for another single family home on Granite Street in Fitchburg, another proud Habitat for Humanity project. Students worked with instructors to install an additional heating zone on the second floor at the William Bresnahan Community Center in Ashburnham, and began work at the MVP Academy building. Students also worked fixing numerous plumbing issues within the Monty Tech building. Juniors successfully completed their Hot Work safety training and earned that important credential. Freshmen also completed the 10-hour OSHA General

Industry safety training, while Sophomore students completed the 10-hour OSHA Construction safety training and certification. Eleven Seniors and three Juniors earned co-op placements, which allowed them to continue to grow in the trade, working with plumbing professionals in the area. Sophomores and Seniors were trained in Viega PEX/copper press, earning a valuable certification. One Senior earned the PHCC 2024 Vocational Plumbing All Star Award, given by the Plumbing, Heating, and Cooling Contractors Association of Massachusetts, receiving a scholarship for his continuing education in the plumbing licensure program and a fine set of tools. Another senior was awarded the Central Mass Plumbing & Gas Inspectors Association \$500 Scholarship. This will be applied to his continuing education in the profession. (Total student enrollment: 73)

Veterinary Science: For the 2023-2024 school year, the Monty Tech Veterinary Clinic completed 1300 appointments, seeing 819 dogs and cats and servicing 379 district families. The program was honored to help so many clients and patients in need. Fourteen Seniors and 1 Junior earned co-op placements, working outside of the school's busy Veterinary Clinic. Twenty-two Seniors passed the Recover CPR, Fear Free Level 1 and Human Animal Bond Certification, 1 Senior and 20 Juniors passed the Certified Veterinary Assistant qualification. Additionally, one student went to the State SkillsUSA competition in Medical Terminology, and another two for Safety Poster Design, where they won a silver medal for their efforts. All Freshmen completed the OSHA 10-hour General Industry training and certification. (Total student enrollment: 82)

Welding/Metal Fabrication: Monty Tech's Welding/Metal Fabrication Department completed over 30 community service projects in the 2023-2024 school year. Students worked with instructors to build a hitch mounted truck ramp for the dogs of the Northeast Houndsmen, repaired a horse trailer and created a new truck pull bar. Working on campus, students designed and fabricated an extension for a Kubota rack, relined the bed of the school's dump truck, rebuilt the sides for the snow pusher plow, fabricated two wire wheel racks for the electrical program, and began fabricating a complex railing system for the mezzanines at the MVP Academy. Students completed a project for their Culinary Arts peers, fabricating and installing multiple racks for the cutting boards and rolling pins in the Culinary kitchen. Seven Juniors and five Seniors earned co-op placements. Juniors completed the Hot Work certification, and all Freshmen students completed the OSHA 10-hour Construction Certification. One Senior placed 3rd in the SkillsUSA States Competition. One Senior placed 2nd in the GTAW Pipe Notch Pipe Welding Competition. Several students passed their American Welding Society D1.1 Structural Steel Code Certification in 1G FCAW & EG SMAW. Three Seniors obtained their 1G ASME section 1X Boiler and Pressure Vessel certification. Instructors were pleased to receive a new 4' box and pan brake for sheet metal fabrication, which will benefit the program immensely. (Total student enrollment: 63)

Cooperative Education

The Monty Tech Cooperative Education Program is an extension of the student's technical education that combines classroom instruction with on-the-job-training. The popular Co-op Program provides students with an opportunity to further develop academic, technical and employability skills in an industry-related work environment. All students are eligible to participate in the Co-op Program, provided they satisfy state and school grade, attendance and performance requirements, and all Co-op students must have completed the OSHA recognized Career Safe online health and safety course prior to being placed in a work environment.

The Cooperative Education Program is beneficial for both students and employers. For the student, it is a chance to gain on-the-job training that improves both their technical proficiency and employability skills, and making industry connections enhances post-graduate employment opportunities. The Co-op Program also allows students to earn while they learn, which has allowed many students to learn valuable life skills, financial literacy skills, and gain a deeper understanding of the importance of career advancement and self-advocacy.

Employer benefits include addressing workforce needs in an efficient manner. Co-op students provide a pool of trained talent, ready to assume temporary, part-time or even full-time opportunities, thus reducing employer training costs. Co-op work hours may also be tailored to suit the needs of partnering employers.

With approximately 100 area employers participating in Cooperative Education, providing valuable experience to 235 students by the end of the 2023-2024 school year, school officials remain grateful for their continued support, and look forward to future collaborations.

Student Support Services

Monty Tech's Department of Student Support Services houses the district's counseling services, oversees special education programming, and maintains efforts to provide social/emotional learning and resources to all students. Throughout the 2023-2024 school year, department staff continued to prioritize the district's effort to educate and develop the next generation of young adults, ensuring students have access to support in academic and vocational programming, as well as services related to social and emotional wellness. Our trained and compassionate staff work to provide structured supports for students as they acclimated to the demands, pace and rigor of high school academics, vocational programming and extracurricular activities, understanding that a few short years ago, during the students' developmental years, students were isolated, had minimal opportunities to grow and develop through social interactions and hadn't experienced a 'normal' school year. With increased exposure to technology and social media, the means in which young adults communicate and connect has shifted. With that, the foundational skills and social norms have also changed, taking on an array of

variances that schools must recognize and address to effectively prepare students to be successful young adults.

Recognizing the shift in experiences and brain development, Monty Tech has focused support on the growing concerns and struggles with age-appropriate interactions, use of social media, and the need for meaningful connections. The Department of Student Support has concentrated its efforts on creating a safe and supportive environment, offering opportunities and experiences that challenge our students to reflect, grow, and learn in all areas of their experiences. The department continued its important mission to break the stigma of mental health, shifting our perspective to find balance and mental wellness. This unified approach, support, and collaboration helps our student body develop socially, build resilience, communicate effectively, grow individually and meet success.

In addition to the department's current school-based counseling services, Monty Tech and partner LUK, Inc. collaborated throughout 2023-2024 with the Department of Public Health to provide services to at-risk students and their families. The district also worked with LUK to create a direct pipeline for referrals and increased access to support. Programs such as the HOPEMatters, a peer-to-peer mental wellness and suicide prevention program, Project AMP, a program to address prevention of substance use among youth ages 13-17, and Students Taking A New Direction (STAND), a program to support students displaying at-risk behaviors, have all been implemented. These services allow students to have support beyond the school days and walls of Monty Tech.

Monty Tech also joined forces with CareSolace, matching individuals with mental health and/or substance abuse counselors. CareSolace Coordinators address the growing need to locate support and match individuals with therapists, saving students and families hours of time, phone calls, waitlists and frustration. CareSolace supports the matching process and follows up with individuals to ensure each connection was a success. Most importantly, CareSolace Match Services are free to our students, family, staff and community: <https://caresolace.com/site/montytech>.

During the 2023-2024 school year, Montachusett Regional Vocational Technical School District provided specialized services to approximately three hundred students – measuring progress of over two hundred students on Individual Education Plans (IEPs) and approximately one hundred students adhering to individualized Section 504 plans. While the Student Support Services Department encompasses special education, the department provides support that is available to all Monty Tech students. Students have access to direct tutoring both before and after school. School counselors are available to assist students with vocational placement and post-secondary planning. Furthermore, our counselors are equipped with the skills to engage students in workshops and groups that support the development of social resilience, functional

academics, finding balance, and referral services for those experiencing struggles.

Technology @ Monty Tech

With an eye toward maintaining student, faculty and staff information safely, the Monty Tech Technology Department worked throughout the 2023-2024 school year to identify areas in need of improvement, and solutions that would expand the scope and security the department takes such great pride in. School officials then submitted a Municipal Local Cybersecurity Grant application and were awarded \$25,000 from the Massachusetts Executive Office of Public Safety and Security. With that generous award, Monty Tech's technology team immersed themselves in the development of a Cyber Incident Response Plan, which will help secure the district's complex network for years to come.

Supporting and maintaining student devices and instructional technology continues to comprise the bulk of the department's efforts. With each student having a school-issued Chromebook, and academic and vocational teachers using a wide variety of instructional technology, the talented technology team continues to streamline troubleshooting and support efforts to ensure student and staff are online and able to fully participate in educational activities at all times – not an easy feat in a sixty-year-old facility serving more than 1,600 faculty, staff and students daily!

Relying on PowerSchool, the district's student information system, and the schoolwide adoption of Google Classroom, we have seen increased communications between school and home. These technology-based communication systems have resulted in more regular and timely student achievement analyses, so that teachers, parents and students are able to address areas of concern more efficiently to improve understanding. The district's Director of Technology and two Instructional Technologists have been instrumental in training and providing in-house support to Monty Tech faculty and staff to improve the delivery of relevant and engaging curriculum across all subject areas.

Service Learning

The Monty Tech Marine Corps Junior Reserve Officer Training Corps (MCJROTC) is a leadership program designed to instill the values of citizenship, service, personal responsibility, and a sense of accomplishment into our young adults. The program provides students with countless opportunities to serve as ambassadors in their communities, through the routine demonstration of student leadership development, volunteerism, perseverance, and dedication.

During the 2023 - 2024 school year, Monty Tech MCJROTC Cadets participated in more than 2,500 hours of community service and volunteerism. Cadets began the school year supporting three community 5K runs - the Fitchburg Veterans 5K, the Rock and Roll 5K at the Wachusett Brewery, and the Heroes Live Forever 5K also taking place at the Wachusett Brewery - providing assistance with vehicle parking, run route coordination, and vendor support. Cadets also enjoyed participating in the

annual Blacksmith Festival held in Fitchburg, MA, where they assisted competitors and vendors, and while doing so, learned a great deal about community volunteerism and the craft of blacksmithing as a fine art.

As in years past, Cadets were actively involved with the Fitchburg Salvation Army, and proudly assisted with the collection of donations that will go on to support the less fortunate throughout the community in a variety of ways. Cadets served as traditional bell ringers in front of many different community grocery and department stores, and conducted volunteer tolls throughout the region to support this effort.

Assisting with color guards, presenting the Nation's Colors and the Marine Corps Battle Colors, is a particular honor and highlight for our young cadets. In 2023-2024, the Monty Tech Color Guard was able to support numerous events, including the Fitchburg State graduate and undergraduate ceremonies, local civic ceremonies, and numerous veteran ceremonies in and around the community especially during veteran holidays.

The highlight of the school year had to be the annual ten-mile hike that took place at Monty Tech. Each year cadets work to raise donations for a worthwhile cause of their choosing. This year, cadets chose to support the Wreaths Across America program raising in excess of \$25,000. This sizeable donation will benefit a number of veteran programs, including technology and related supports, the Wreaths Across America Teach Program, and the Wreaths Across America Mobile Education Exhibit.

Cadets were able to sponsor and participate in a Veterans Day ceremony that took place in the Monty Tech Auditorium. Veteran Monty Tech Teachers were recognized for their service. Cadets also participated in a Marine Corps Birthday Ball Celebration. This event included a full USMC Birthday ceremony, marching in the USMC birthday cake cutting ceremony, and recognition of the guest of honor, Mr. Paul Jornet.

Finally, more than 70 Cadets participated in our annual Cadet Leadership Camp during the month of June. The camp took place in Camp Moses Boy Scout Camp located in Holyoke MA. This weeklong leadership trip included team building skills, physical fitness, and visits to local area attractions. Cadets were able to develop a sense of leadership while establishing "Esprit de Corps" which is pride in the unit.

Evening Programs

In recent years, Monty Tech's popular School of Continuing Education, has been the recipient of more than \$2M in funding from Commonwealth Corporation, to provide unemployed or underemployed individuals with no-cost training and job placement services in the region's most critical industries/occupations. These grant-funded training opportunities are an example of the collaboration between the MassHire Workforce Investment Board, the Executive Office of Labor and Workforce

Development, and generous sponsorship from Commonwealth Corporation, making it possible for Monty Tech to offer meaningful job readiness training in occupations with high demand and self-sustaining wages.

In 2023-2024, school leaders were pleased to offer 200-hour training programs in carpentry, culinary, electrical, plumbing, HVAC, CNC operation, welding and property maintenance, at no cost to qualified participants. These FY24 training cohorts resulted in 34 individuals having secured full-time employment in their chosen occupations. In addition to these grant-funded opportunities, the School of Continuing Education, continues to offer the area's most affordable and comprehensive cosmetology training program, effectively preparing participants to sit for the Massachusetts State Board examinations. In FY24, seven cosmetology students graduated from the program, and all have passed the licensing exam.

Serving more than 1,700 community members annually, the School of Continuing Education is proud to offer meaningful training to a non-traditional student population, while working to develop new and important relationships with business partners in need of a talented candidate pool. The talented Continuing Education staff understands that the strength of any vocational training program is dependent upon mutually beneficial relationships between the school and our business partners, and they work tirelessly to build relationships throughout the year. One demonstration of such school-to-business collaboration is the school's annual job fair. In May of 2024, the School of Continuing Education hosted the annual event, welcoming more than seventy area employers who spent time visiting with both day and evening students seeking job opportunities. Numerous students attended the event, presented resumes to business representatives, and made contacts with employers that led to a first-time job placement and entry into the trades.

The Montachusett Regional Vocational Technical School Practical Nursing Program class of 2024 achieved a 100% NCLEX-PN Pass Rate.

We are thrilled to announce that 100% of our 2024 graduates passed the NCLEX-PN examination on their first attempt. This achievement reflects the dedication of our students, faculty, and staff to upholding the highest academic and clinical standards as well as the program's dedication to preparing future nurses for the challenges of a career in healthcare.

At the heart of this program's success lies a culture that prioritizes student success and professional readiness. Faculty members are not just educators but mentors, guiding students through a curriculum designed to build both theoretical knowledge and practical skills. The program emphasizes evidence-based learning, critical thinking, and compassionate care—key components of a well-rounded nursing education.

The program's student-centered approach extends beyond academics. A robust support system ensures that students have access to resources that address their academic,

emotional, and financial needs. Faculty advisors work closely with students to create tailored study plans as well as provide a safe space to navigate the stresses of nursing school.

Looking forward we hope to increase program enrollment as well as community clinical partnerships to address the growing demand for skilled practical nurses.

The program aims to maintain its 100% pass rate by continuously updating its curriculum, investing in faculty development, and expanding student resources. Leveraging technology and evidence-based teaching methods will remain a priority as we prepare the next generation of compassionate, skilled nurses who will make a meaningful impact on healthcare across North Central Massachusetts.

Looking Ahead

Monty Tech pride is something students, alumni, family and friends demonstrate at a remarkable and humbling rate. Bumper stickers on countless vehicles, sweatshirts and hats worn to indicate pride in affiliation with the school, and shared stories of success heard in homes and across our communities are points of pride that do not go unnoticed to Monty Tech faculty and staff. The talented instructors, paraprofessionals, counselors, cafeteria staff, custodial and maintenance crew, and invaluable support staff work so hard every day to ensure all students have access to the best academic and vocational lessons, instructional technology and training equipment available, while learning in a safe and supportive environment. When we look ahead to what is next for Monty Tech, we begin with “more of the same” – excellence in education, building relationships with employers who rely on our workforce training programs, and working with the next generation of young leaders and entrepreneurs who make us so incredibly proud.

In 2024-2025, Monty Tech leaders look forward to celebrating the opening of the school’s first satellite campus, and home to MVP Academy. Serving more than 80 students from partnering districts of Fitchburg, Gardner, and Narragansett Regional Schools, this new facility, made possible by a \$1.9M Lab Modernization Grant (FY23), is Monty Tech’s answer to the increasing number of students who seek a vocational high school experience, with no additional seats available. School leaders expect to expand even further the capacity at MVP Academy, with the addition of a Plumbing training program by the end of FY26.

Another deserving population that has had limited access to meaningful job training, are the area’s young adults with disabilities. In 2023-2024, school leaders identified a grant opportunity and crafted a unique training program designed specifically for this population. That \$133,900 award from Commonwealth Corporation enabled school leaders to roll out a small pilot program, training 12 deserving young adults in 4 different trades. Looking ahead and learning from our pilot program, school leaders are eager to apply for the grant again in FY25, so we may expand upon that

successful program, doubling the number of students served and training programs offered. Program leaders also anticipate growing the number of employer partners, so that young adults with disabilities who enroll in the Supportive Training & Education Program (STEP) are matched with internships and job placements that align with their newfound skills and their special talents and abilities.

Finally, FY25 will see two vocational program improvements that will undoubtedly please incoming and current students in the Culinary Arts and Carpentry programs. Thanks to continued partnerships with various grant agencies and donors, the school's Culinary Arts program will purchase \$300,000 of new kitchen equipment and technology. Items that students will soon be trained on include a pasta extruder and various dyes, a gorgeous wood-fired brick pizza oven, new char broilers and skillets. Carpentry students will also enjoy new equipment, with the addition of two Advanced Construction Simulator Systems, that will teach students operator skills, using the same techniques found on worksites across the Commonwealth. Students will learn how to safely and effectively operate a variety of heavy equipment machinery, using these truly innovative experiential learning devices.

Monty Tech Leadership

The district continues to benefit from a talented leadership team whose varied educational backgrounds, professional experiences, and areas of expertise contribute to the success of the school. Working collaboratively, and under the direction of the Superintendent, the team has transformed the school into one of the most sought-after high schools in North Central Massachusetts.

Thomas R. Browne, Superintendent-Director

Dayana Carlson, Principal

Tammy Crockett, Business Manager

Kim Curry, Co-Operative Education Coordinator

Taryn DiVito, Data Analysis and Accountability Coordinator

Christina Favreau, Director of Academic Programs

Michael Gormley, Director of Facilities

Donald Kitzmiller, Director of Technology

Christine Leamy, Dean of Admissions

Kathryn Schmidt, Assistant Principal

Katy Whitaker, Development Coordinator

Brian Williams, Director of Vocational Programs

Victoria Zarozinski, Director of Student Support Services

In addition, the Montachusett Regional Vocational Technical School District Committee is comprised of twenty-two dedicated individuals, whose expertise proves invaluable in advising the district's operations, policies, and procedures. Our students continue to benefit from the broad scope of their experiences and varying perspectives,

and we are thankful to the following members of the 2023-2024 School Committee for their outstanding service.

Eric Commodore, Gardner, *Chair*
John Columbus, Templeton, *Vice Chair*
Julie Marynok, *Secretary*
Jeffrey Gallant, *District Treasurer*

Diane Swenson, Ashburnham
Peter Capone, Ashby
Jeffrey Raymond, Athol
Whitney Marshall, Barre
Robert Campbell, Fitchburg
Michael Hurley, Fitchburg
Dr. Ronald Tourigny, Fitchburg
Melanie Weeks, Fitchburg
James S. Boone, Gardner
Jeanne Bartlett, Harvard

Scott Carignan, Hubbardston
Barbara Reynolds, Lunenburg
Eric Olson, Phillipston
John P. Mollica, Princeton
Sara Dilg, Royalston
William Brassard, Sterling
John Columbus, Templeton
Ross Barber, Westminster
Tamarah Estes, Winchendon

Respectfully Submitted By:

Thomas R. Browne, Superintendent-Director, January 31, 2024

Montachusett Regional Vocational Technical School
1050 Westminster Street, Fitchburg, MA 01420
(978) 345-9200
www.montytech.net

ELECTIONS AND TOWN MEETINGS

COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSTTS PRESIDENTIAL PRIMARY MARCH 5, 2024

Middlesex, ss:

To: Constable of the Town of Ashby:

GREETING:

In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby required to notify and warn the inhabitants of said Ashby who are qualified to vote in Primaries to vote at the Ashby Elementary School Auditorium, 911 Main Street on TUESDAY, THE FIFTH OF MARCH 2024, from 7:00 A.M. to 8:00 P.M. for the following purpose:

To cast their votes in the Presidential Primary for the candidates of political parties for the following offices:

PRESIDENTIAL PREFERENCE	FOR THIS COMMONWEALTH
STATE COMMITTEE MAN	WORCESTER & MIDDLESEX DISTRICT
STATE COMMITTEE WOMAN	WORCESTER & MIDDLESEX DISTRICT
TOWN COMMITTEE	ASHBY

Hereof, fail not, and make return of this warrant with your doings thereon at the time and place of said voting.

Given under our hands this _____ day of January, 2024.

_____ David Nadeau	_____ Doug Leab	_____ Jessica Kallin
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ASHBY BOARD OF SELECTMEN

By virtue of this precept, I have posted three (3) attested copies in three (3) public places at least seven days prior to the foregoing warrant.

DATE _____	_____ Derek Pepple POLICE CHIEF
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RESULTS OF PRESIDENTIAL PRIMARY
March 5, 2024

The warrant was returned to the Town Clerk at 6:15 AM.

Election Officers on duty and duly sworn were as follows: Betty Tiilikkala, Joyce Hopkins, Angie Godin, Deb Theall, Tracey Robinson-Harris, Barbara Thorpe, Deb Dancause, Susan Creighton, Linda Stacy, Gary Asher

The polls opened at 7:00 AM.

The following is a list of candidates as they appeared on the official ballots, and also the votes each received, and the total blanks:

DEMOCRATIC PARTY PRIMARY BALLOT

	VOTES
PRESIDENTIAL PREFERENCE	

Dean Phillips	10
Joseph R. Biden	239
Marianne Williamson	6
No Preference	19
All Others	3
Blanks	1
Total Ballots Cast	278

STATE COMMITTEE MAN

All Others	2
Blanks	276
Total Ballots Cast	278

STATE COMMITTEE WOMAN

Meghan K. Kilcoyne	221
All Others	0
Blanks	57
Total Ballots Cast	278

TOWN COMMITTEE

All Others	1
Blanks	5559
Total Ballots Cast	5560

LIBERTARIAN PARTY PRIMARY BALLOT

VOTES

PRESIDENTIAL PREFERENCE

Jacob George Hornberger	1
Michael D. Rectenwald	0
Chase Russell Oliver	2
Michael Ter Maat	1
Lars Damian Mapstead	0
No Preference	1
All Others	0
Blanks	2

Total Ballots Cast	7
STATE COMMITTEE MAN	
All Others	0
Blanks	7
Total Ballots Cast	7
STATE COMMITTEE WOMAN	
All Others	0
Blanks	7
Total Ballots Cast	7
TOWN COMMITTEE	
All Others	0
Blanks	70
Total Ballots Cast	70
REPUBLICAN PARTY PRIMARY BALLOT	
	VOTES
PRESIDENTIAL PREFERENCE	
Chris Christie	5
Ryan Binkley	0
Vivek Ramaswamy	2
Asa Hutchinson	0
Donald J. Trump	339
Ron DeSantis	33
Nikki Haley	137
No Preference	3
All Others	0
Blanks	2
Total Ballots Cast	521
STATE COMMITTEE MAN	
Dennis J. Galvin	207
Mark C. Bodanza	244

All Others	0
Blanks	70
Total Ballots Cast	520

STATE COMMITTEE WOMAN



Kathleen Lynch	259
Beth Joyce Lindstrom	187
All Others	0
Blanks	75
Total Ballots Cast	521

TOWN COMMITTEE



All Others	4
Blanks	18231
Total Ballots Cast	18235

The following tellers on duty and duly sworn were as follows: Dawn Roy, June McNeil, Teresa Nagle, Mary Ann Allen, Roberta Flashman, Garry Baer, Barbara Thorpe, Deb Theall, Tracey Robinson-Harris, Gary Asher, Sandi Heyes, Deb Dancause, Brendan McNeil, Nancy Richards, Matthew Carmack, Ava McNeil, Emma Jack, Angie Godin, Claire Hutchinson-Lavin, Pam Peeler, Deb Pillsbury

At the close of the polls, the ballot box read 804. The checkers' tally sheets read 277 Democratic voters, 7 Libertarian voters and 520 Republican voters had cast a ballot, for a total of 804 ballots cast. There were 2 Provisional ballots which were determined to be valid and brought the total number of ballots cast to 806. There were 7 Absentee Ballots and 236 Early Voting Ballots.

Angela M. Jack, *Ashby Town Clerk*

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION
April 22, 2024**

Middlesex, ss:

TO: Constable of the Town of Ashby:

GREETING:

In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby directed to notify and warn the

inhabitants of the Town of Ashby, qualified to vote in elections and town affairs, to meet at the Ashby Elementary School, 911 Main Street in said Ashby, Monday, the twenty-second day of April, at 12:00 PM, to give their votes on one ballot for the following officers:

- SELECTBOARD, Three Years
- ASSESSOR, Three Years
- BOARD OF HEALTH, Three years
- PLANNING BOARD, Five Years
- CEMETERY COMMISSION, Three Years
- CEMETERY COMMISSION, Two Years
- PARKS COMMISSION, Three Years
- COLLECTOR, Three Years
- 3 LIBRARY TRUSTEES, Three Years
- CONSTABLE, One Year
- FINANCE COMMITTEE, Three Years
- 2 FINANCE COMMITTEE, Two Years
- 2 FINANCE COMMITTEE, One Year

The polls will be open at 12:00 PM and shall close at 7:30 PM.

And you are hereby directed to serve this warrant by posting an attested copy in three (3) public places in said Ashby at least seven days before the holding of said election.

Hereof, fail not, and make do return of this warrant with your doings thereon, to the Town Clerk at the time and place of election aforesaid.

Given under our hands this _____ day of March 2024.

David Nadeau

Doug Leab

Jessica Kallin

ASHBY SELECTBOARD

By virtue of this precept, I have posted three (3) attested copies of the foregoing warrant in three (3) public places in said Ashby seven days at least before time of said Annual Town Election.

DATE: _____
Police Chief Derek Pepple

RESULTS OF ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION
April 22, 2024

The warrant was returned to the Town Clerk at 11:30 AM on Monday, April 22, 2024

Election officers on duty and duly sworn in were as follows: Betty Tiilikkala, Joyce Hopkins, Tracey Robinson-Harris, Deb Theall, Sue Creighton, Linda Stacy, June McNeil, and Deb Dancause

The polls opened at 12:00 PM.

The following is a list of candidates and the votes and blanks each received as they appeared on the official ballot.

	VOTES
SELECTBOARD	
Jessica Kallin	216
All Others	0
Blanks	14
Total Ballots Cast	230
BOARD OF ASSESSORS	
Jeffrey Childs	215
All Others	0
Blanks	15
Total Ballots Cast	230
BOARD OF HEALTH	
Eric Moeller	214
All Others	0
Blanks	16
Total Ballots Cast	230
PLANNING BOARD	
Andrew Leonard	209
All Others	0
Blanks	21
Total Ballots Cast	230

CEMETERY COMMISSIONER	
All Others	8
Blanks	222
Total Ballots Cast	230
CEMETERY COMMISSIONER 2YR	
All Others	1
Blanks	229
Total Ballots Cast	230
PARKS COMMISSIONER	
Patrick Lyden	38
All Others	2
Blanks	190
Total Ballots Cast	230
COLLECTOR	
Kate Stacy	212
All Others	0
Blanks	18
Total Ballots Cast	230
LIBRARY TRUSTEE	
Lynn Carpenito	207
Christina Ewald	210
Roberta Flashman	178
All Others	0
Blanks	95
Total Ballots Cast	690
CONSTABLE	
All Others	5
Blanks	225
Total Ballots Cast	230

FINANCE COMMITTEE	
All Others	4
Blanks	226
Total Ballots Cast	230
FINANCE COMMITTEE 2YR	
All Others	1
Blanks	459
Total Ballots Cast	460
FINANCE COMMITTEE 1YR	
All Others	1
Blanks	459
Total Ballots Cast	230

The polls closed at 7:30 PM.

Tellers on duty and duly sworn in were as follows: Pam Peeler, Deborah Pillsbury, Mary Allen, Katie Marsh, Dawn Roy, Jill Niemi, Deb Dancause, Teresa Nagle, Shawn Keating, Joyce Hopkins.

At the close of the polls the ballot box read 230 voters had cast a ballot: the checker's tally sheet read 230 voters had cast a ballot including 104 early ballots and 4 absentee ballots.

Angela M. Jack, *Town Clerk*

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
SPECIAL TOWN MEETING**

Middlesex ss:

To the Constable of the Town of Ashby in said County

Greeting:

In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby directed to notify and warn the inhabitants of the Town of Ashby qualified to vote in elections and town affairs, to meet at the Ashby Elementary School Gymnasium, 911 Main Street in said Ashby, Saturday, May 4, 2024 at 9:30 AM, to act on the following articles:

ARTICLE 1. To see what sum of money the Town will vote to appropriate from

available funds, to extinguish the deficit incurred in the Winter Operations budget in the current fiscal year; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 2. To see what sum of money the Town will vote to appropriate from Ashby Recycling Center and Transfer Station (ARCTS) Free Cash to augment the appropriation for ARCTS expenses for FY24; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 3. To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Selectboard, pursuant to the provisions of G.L. 44, § 21C, or any other enabling authority, to enter into a lease purchase financing agreement for the acquisition and equipping of a new police vehicle, including any costs and expenses incidental thereto, for the Police Department, such vehicle and equipment as may be acquired through the issuance of debt pursuant to G.L. c 44, §7(1), the term of such agreement not to exceed three (3) years, being the useful life of the vehicle and equipment as determined by the Selectboard; and further that the sum of \$22,941.73 for the first year payment therefor be appropriated within the Police Department annual budget for Fiscal Year 2025; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

And you are hereby directed to serve this warrant by posting an attested copy in at least three (3) public places in said Ashby, fourteen (14) days at least before the holding of said meeting. Hereof fail not, and make due return of this warrant with your doings thereon to the Town Clerk at the time and place of meeting aforesaid.

Given under our hands this ____ day of April, 2024.

David Nadeau, Chair

Doug Leab, Clerk

Jessica Kallin, Member

TOWN OF ASHBY SELECTBOARD

By virtue of this precept, I have posted three (3) attested copies of the foregoing warrant in
three (3) public places in Ashby at least fourteen days before the time of said Special Town Meeting.

DATE: _____
Derek Pepple, Police Chief

**RESULTS OF THE SPECIAL TOWN MEETING
MAY 4, 2024**

The warrant was returned to the Town Clerk at 8:15 AM.

With a quorum present, the Moderator Nancy Chew called the meeting to order at 9:34 AM.

The warrant showed it was properly served.

The motion was made and seconded to waive the reading of the warrant, and so voted.

The rules of the meeting were read.

The motion was made and seconded to allow the moderator to declare a two-thirds vote, and so voted.

Article 1. The motion was made and seconded that the Town transfer from free cash the sum of \$50,103.49 to extinguish the deficit incurred in the Winter Operations budget in the current fiscal year.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 2. The motion was made and seconded that the Town transfer from Ashby Recycling Center and Transfer Station (ARCTS) Free Cash the sum of \$2,000.00 to augment the appropriation for ARCTS expenses for FY24.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 3. The motion was made and seconded that Article 3 be approved as written in the warrant with funding of \$22,941.73 for the first year payment for the lease purchase agreement to be appropriated within the Police Department annual budget for Fiscal Year 2025

VOTE: PASSED (2/3 VOTE DECLARED BY MODERATOR)

The motion was made and seconded to dissolve the Special Town Meeting at 9:48 AM.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Angela M. Jack, *Town Clerk*

COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
ANNUAL TOWN MEETING

Middlesex ss:

To: Constable of the Town of Ashby in said County:

Greeting:

In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby directed to notify and warn the inhabitants of the Town of Ashby qualified to vote in elections and town affairs, to meet at the Ashby Elementary School Gymnasium, 911 Main Street in said Ashby, Saturday, May 4, 2024 at 9:30 AM, to act on the following articles:

ARTICLE 1. To see if the Town will vote to elect all other Town officers not required to be elected on the official ballot; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 2. To see if the Town will vote to hear the reports of the various Town officials and committees; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 3. To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Treasurer to borrow funds as necessary in anticipation or revenue, in accordance with G.L. c. 44, § 4; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 4. To see if the Town will vote to accept the following sums in trust, the income therefrom to be expended for the perpetual care of cemetery lots, as follows:

Glenwood Cemetery

Amount	Name	Avenue	Lot	Section
\$400.00	Jeffrey Thomann	E, Rear	32	Lyman II
\$400.00	Amy Egeland	E, Rear	30	Lyman II
\$400.00	William Pillsbury	F	18	Lyman II
\$200.00	James A. Ramsdell	F	17	Lyman II
\$400.00	Wendy Beals	E, Rear	31	Lyman II

Or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 5. To see what sum of money the Town will vote to appropriate from

available funds for the purpose of operating the Ashby Recycling Center & Transfer Station (ARCTS) for FY25; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 6. To see what sum of money the Town will vote to appropriate from available funds for the purpose of operating the Ashby PEG Access Department for FY25; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 7. To see if the Town will vote to set the following spending limits for the revolving funds authorized by Article XXIV of the Town By-laws:

- Library Books Revolving Funds \$3,000.00
- Cemetery Burial and Foundations Revolving Fund \$15,000.00

Or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 8. To see if the Town will vote to appropriate all funds received from the Commonwealth under the provisions of the “Chapter 90” program, to provide for eligible road resurfacing and/or other improvements or activities benefiting Town roads, as allowed by statute; said sum to be 100% reimbursable by the Commonwealth; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 9. To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate or transfer from available funds to defray the expenses of the Town for the fiscal year commencing July 1, 2024, and to set the salaries of elected officials; or take any other action relative thereto.

Budget ATM25		FY23	FY24	FY25
	<i>LINES</i>	<i>SPENT</i>	<i>BUDGET</i>	<i>SELECTBOARD RECOMMENDS</i>
Administration				
1	Salary	\$ 41,541.25	\$ 46,878.00	\$ 48,018.00
2	Expenses	\$ 5,896.57	\$ 17,750.00	\$ 17,750.00
		\$ 47,437.82	\$ 64,628.00	\$ 65,768.00
Town Administrator				
3	Salaries & Wages	\$ 72,312.19	\$ 110,000.00	\$ 104,000.00
		\$ 72,312.19	\$ 110,000.00	\$ 104,000.00
Finance Committee				
4	Expense Budget	\$ 163.00	\$ 600.00	\$ 600.00

2024 Annual Reports

5	Reserve Fund	\$ -	\$ 32,000.00	\$ 32,000.00
		\$ 163.00	\$ 32,600.00	\$ 32,600.00
Town Accountant				
6	Salaries & Wages	-	-	-
	Expenses	\$ 95,390.45	\$ 95,300.00	\$ 97,300.00
		\$ 95,390.45	\$ 95,300.00	\$ 97,300.00
Board of Assessors				
10	Wages	\$ 50,901.60	\$ 48,020.00	\$ 49,941.00
	Expenses	\$ 11,147.92	\$ 11,675.00	\$ 13,809.91
		\$ 62,049.52	\$ 59,695.00	\$ 63,750.91
Treasurer				
15	Treasurer Salary	\$ 38,051.12	\$ 39,500.00	\$ 40,437.50
	Expenses	\$ 17,835.22	\$ 22,030.00	\$ 22,029.00
		\$ 55,886.34	\$ 61,530.00	\$ 64,065.50
Tax Collector				
18	Tax Collector Salary	\$ 37,513.19	\$ 44,850.00	\$ 44,372.25
	Expenses	\$ 16,874.73	\$ 16,018.90	\$ 17,630.00
		\$ 54,387.92	\$ 60,868.90	\$ 62,002.25
Legal Services				
21	Expenses	\$ 92,499.37	\$ 45,000.00	\$ 45,000.00
		\$ 92,499.37	\$ 45,000.00	\$ 45,000.00
Technology and Systems				
22	Expenses	\$ 43,157.26	\$ 70,000.00	\$ 70,000.00
		\$ 43,157.26	\$ 70,000.00	\$ 70,000.00
Town Clerk				
23	Town Clerk Salary	\$ 51,656.26	\$ 50,000.00	\$ 51,246.00
25	Election and Registrar Stipend	\$ 6,355.74	\$ 8,300.00	\$ 8,550.00
	Expenses	\$ 9,492.01	\$ 11,900.00	\$ 13,550.00
		\$ 67,504.01	\$ 70,200.00	\$ 73,346.00
Town Reports				
30	Expenses	\$ 1,899.00	\$ 2,500.00	\$ 2,500.00
		\$ 1,899.00	\$ 2,500.00	\$ 2,500.00
Conservation Commission				
31	Expenses	\$ 771.90	\$ 1,150.00	\$ 1,150.00
		\$ 771.90	\$ 1,150.00	\$ 1,150.00
Planning				
32	Expenses	\$ 967.14	\$ 2,275.00	\$ 2,275.00
		\$ 967.14	\$ 2,275.00	\$ 2,275.00
Zoning				
33	Expenses	\$ 1,814.12	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00

		\$ 1,814.12	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00
Land Use				
34	Agent	\$ 4,153.50	\$ 11,000.00	\$ 4,000.00
	Expenses	\$ 1,128.92	\$ 1,857.15	\$ 1,886.00
		\$ 5,282.42	\$ 12,857.15	\$ 5,886.00
Town Office				
	Expenses	\$ 44,607.32	\$ 49,030.00	\$ 49,030.00
		\$ 44,607.32	\$ 49,030.00	\$ 49,030.00
Town Clock				
40	Stipend	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 500.00	\$ 500.00
		\$ 1,000.00	\$ 500.00	\$ 500.00
Municipal Buildings/Grounds				
47	Wages/Stipend	\$ 9,426.64	\$ 9,900.00	\$ 10,100.00
48	Buildings/Grounds Expenses	\$ 69,061.27	\$ 64,000.00	\$ 64,000.00
		\$ 78,487.91	\$ 73,900.00	\$ 74,100.00
Police				
49	Police Salaries	\$ 661,013.70	\$ 845,857.00	\$ 847,236.22
	Expenses	\$ 108,915.44	\$ 129,050.00	\$ 121,950.00
		\$ 769,929.14	\$ 974,907.00	\$ 969,186.22
Public Safety Building				
53b	Expenses	\$ 21,665.80	\$ 51,500.00	\$ 51,500.00
Fire				
54	Fire Salaries	\$ 210,438.61	\$ 236,425.00	\$ 283,872.00
	Expenses	\$ 122,813.35	\$ 93,350.00	\$ 93,350.00
		\$ 333,251.96	\$ 329,775.00	\$ 377,222.00
EMS				
64	Wages - Coverage	\$ 110,758.24	\$ 122,150.00	\$ 124,375.00
	Expenses	\$ 58,191.94	\$ 67,750.00	\$ 67,750.00
		\$ 168,950.18	\$ 189,900.00	\$ 192,125.00
Emergency Management				
67(2)	Stipend	\$ 654.66	\$ 654.66	\$ 654.66
68	Expenses	\$ -	\$ 2,500.00	\$ 2,500.00
		\$ 654.66	\$ 3,154.66	\$ 3,154.66
E-911				
69	Expenses	\$ -	\$ 175.00	\$ 175.00
		\$ -	\$ 175.00	\$ 175.00
Building Inspector				
70	Salaries & Wages	\$ 19,148.11	\$ 19,723.00	\$ 20,216.00

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71	Expenses	\$ 300.00	\$ 300.00	\$ 450.00
		\$ 19,448.11	\$ 20,023.00	\$ 20,666.00
Plumbing Inspector				
72	Salaries & Wages	\$ 7,500.00	\$ 7,650.00	\$ 7,850.00
73	Expenses	\$ 112.50	\$ 150.00	\$ 250.00
		\$ 7,612.50	\$ 7,800.00	\$ 8,100.00
Electrical Inspector				
74	Salaries & Wages	\$ 7,500.00	\$ 7,634.00	\$ 7,834.00
75	Expenses	-	900.00	900.00
		\$ 7,500.00	\$ 8,534.00	\$ 8,734.00
Dog Officer				
76	Salaries & Wages	\$ 16,651.08	\$ 16,651.00	\$ 16,651.00
77	Expenses	\$ 1,200.06	\$ 1,400.00	\$ 1,400.00
		\$ 17,851.14	\$ 18,051.00	\$ 18,051.00
Emergency Dispatch				
79	Expenses	\$ 180,393.56	\$ 139,000.00	\$ 139,000.00
		\$ 180,393.56	\$ 139,000.00	\$ 139,000.00
Monty Tech				
80	Assessment	\$ 350,957.32	\$ 392,887.00	\$ 342,708.00
		\$ 350,957.32	\$ 392,887.00	\$ 342,708.00
NMRSD				
	Assessment	\$ 4,421,476.00	\$ 5,086,974.00	\$ 4,890,915.00
		\$ 4,421,476.00	\$ 5,086,974.00	\$ 4,890,915.00
Highway				
83	Highway Salaries	\$ 302,853.18	\$ 349,000.00	\$ 339,616.00
	Expenses	\$ 520,058.84	\$ 376,980.00	\$ 372,980.00
		\$ 822,912.02	\$ 725,980.00	\$ 712,596.00
Snow & Ice				
92	Winter Overtime	\$ 18,351.58	\$ 13,000.00	\$ 13,000.00
93	Winter Expenses	\$ 290,072.49	\$ 87,000.00	\$ 87,000.00
		\$ 308,424.07	\$ 100,000.00	\$ 100,000.00
Street Lights				
94	Expenses	\$ 822.25	\$ 1,080.00	\$ -
		\$ 822.25	\$ 1,080.00	\$ -
Tree Warden				
95	Expenses	-	2,000.00	-
		-	2,000.00	-
Cemetery				
96	Salaries	\$ 12,146.23	\$ 15,000.00	\$ 15,000.00
97	Expenses	\$ 1,676.81	\$ 3,500.00	\$ -
		\$ 13,823.04	\$ 18,500.00	\$ 15,000.00
Board of Health				

	Expenses	\$ 21,489.47	\$ 25,028.76	\$ 26,590.54
		\$ 21,489.47	\$ 25,028.76	\$ 26,590.54
Animal Inspector				
102	Stipend	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,200.00
102A	Rabies Testing	-	400.00	400.00
		\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,400.00	\$ 1,600.00
Council on Aging				
103	Wages	\$ 30,551.15	\$ 36,210.00	\$ 38,122.00
103A	Expense	\$ 4,643.13	\$ 5,100.00	\$ 5,400.00
		\$ 35,194.28	\$ 41,310.00	\$ 43,522.00
Veterans' Services				
104	Salaries & Wages	\$ 499.73	\$ 2,058.94	\$ 2,058.94
	Expenses	\$ 18,467.49	\$ 42,000.00	\$ 39,400.00
		\$ 18,967.22	\$ 44,058.94	\$ 41,458.94
Library				
107	Librarian Salary	\$ 60,265.50	\$ 61,880.00	\$ 64,502.00
	Expenses	\$ 46,212.77	\$ 51,477.00	\$ 51,677.00
		\$ 106,478.27	\$ 113,357.00	\$ 116,179.00
Band Concerts				
113	Expenses	\$ 9,556.76	\$ 9,850.00	\$ 9,850.00
		\$ 9,556.76	\$ 9,850.00	\$ 9,850.00
July 3rd				
114	Expenses	\$ 1,200.00	\$ 1,200.00	\$ 1,200.00
		\$ 1,200.00	\$ 1,200.00	\$ 1,200.00
Allen Field				
115	Expenses	\$ 4,692.38	\$ 6,750.00	\$ -
		\$ 4,692.38	\$ 6,750.00	\$ -
Town Common				
116	Expenses	\$ 1,360.87	\$ 6,500.00	\$ -
		\$ 1,360.87	\$ 6,500.00	\$ -
Debt Service				
118	Temporary Loan Interest	\$ 78,500.00	\$ 1,000.00	\$ -
119	LT Debt Principal	\$	\$	\$ 156,739.50
120	LT Debt Interest	\$	\$	\$ 149,962.50
		\$ 78,500.00	\$ 307,702.00	\$ 348,533.00
Middlesex Retirement				
123	Middlesex Retirement System	\$ 253,936.00	\$ 254,095.00	\$ 268,891.00
		\$ 253,936.00	\$ 254,095.00	\$ 268,891.00
Unemployment				
124	Unemployment Compensation	\$ 6,048.01	\$ 15,000.00	\$ 15,000.00

		\$ 6,048.01	\$ 15,000.00	\$ 15,000.00
Employee Ins. Benefits				
125	Employee Benefits Expense	\$ 515,421.87	\$ 683,627.12	\$ 642,000.00
		\$ 515,421.87	\$ 683,627.12	\$ 642,000.00
Workers Compensation				
126	Insurance Not Health	\$ 368.00	\$ 20,400.00	\$ 20,000.00
		\$ 368.00	\$ 20,400.00	\$ 20,000.00
Insurance P & C				
127	Liability P&C, E,F&P	\$ 99,671.08	\$ 136,500.00	\$ 143,813.00
		\$ 99,671.08	\$ 136,500.00	\$ 143,813.00
FICA				
128	Employee Costs	\$ 25,233.46	\$ 29,389.12	\$ 30,270.79
		\$ 25,233.46	\$ 29,389.12	\$ 30,270.79
	Total	\$ 9,328,741.31	\$ 10,579,442.65	\$ 10,372,314.81

Elective Salaries:

Town Clerk: \$51,246.00

Town Treasurer: \$40,437.50 (includes \$1,000 certification stipend & \$1000 Longevity Bonus for Treasurer)

Town Tax Collector: \$38,437.50

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 10. To see if the Town will vote to raise and appropriate or transfer from available funds the sum of \$643,300 for the purpose of additionally funding the Fiscal Year 2025 North Middlesex Regional School District operating and transportation budget; provided, however, that the appropriation authorized herein shall be subject to and contingent upon approval of the voters at the Town Election to assess additional real estate and personal property taxes in accordance with the provisions of G.L. c. 59, §21C, Proposition 2 1/2 so called; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 11. To see what sum of money the Town will vote to transfer from available funds for deposit into the Stabilization Fund; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 12. To see if the Town will vote to amend Zoning By-Laws Section 8.2.5 Marijuana Establishment to delete the strikethrough terms and add underlined terms as follows:

8.2.5 Marijuana Establishments. ~~A maximum of one~~ One (1) or more Marijuana Establishment(s) may be located in the Industrial Zoning District subject to approval of a special permit by the Zoning Board of Appeals. Marijuana social consumption shall not be permitted. All special permits shall be subject to Section 12.3 (“Special Permits”), Paragraph 12.3.3 (“Requirements, Marijuana Establishments and Registered Marijuana Dispensaries.”)

or take any other action relative thereto.

(Submitted by: Planning Board)

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved ✓ No Action

ARTICLE 13. To see if the Town will vote to amend the General By-Laws, Article II, Town Meetings, Section 5, by deleting the language shown in strikethrough and inserting language shown as bold and underlined as follows; and further deleting Article 2, Town Meetings, Section 6 in its entirety, with subsequent sections to be renumbered consecutively as appropriate; or take any other action relative thereto:

At least five days before the day fixed in the warrant for the Annual Town Meeting and any Special Town Meeting, the Selectmen Selectboard shall cause to be mailed to or left at each occupied dwelling in the Town a copy copies of the warrant for said meeting and recommendations relating to said meeting. Copies of the Town Report will to be available at the Town Clerk’s office, the Library, the Public Safety Building, and on the Town web site.

Selectboard Action: ✓ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

ARTICLE 14. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the care, custody, management and control of the property located at 1140 Greenville Road, shown as Ashby Assessors Map 5, Parcel 28 (Assessors Parcel ID 005.0-0028-000.0), further described in a deed recorded with the Middlesex Southern District Registry of Deeds in Book 12488, Page 467, currently held for landfill and transfer station purposes, from the Selectboard for such purpose to the Selectboard for such purpose and for the additional purpose of leasing for telecommunications purposes; and further, to authorize the Selectboard to enter into such a lease or leases for such purposes, for all or a portion of the property upon such terms and conditions as the Selectboard determines to be in the best interest of the Town, such lease or leases to exceed three years; and to authorize the Selectboard to grant such non-exclusive access and utility easements as the Selectboard deems appropriate in support of such uses; and to further authorize the Selectboard to enter into such agreements and execute such instruments as may be necessary to effectuate the purposes of this article; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ✓ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

ARTICLE 15. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the care, custody, management and control of the property located at 1093 Main Street, shown as Ashby Assessors Map 6, Parcel 16, Lot 2 (Assessors Parcel ID 006.0-0016-0002.0), further described in a deed recorded with the Middlesex Southern District Registry of Deeds in Book 11441, Page 578, currently held for fire station and public safety purposes, from the Selectboard for such purpose to the Selectboard for such purpose and for the additional purposes of leasing for telecommunications, battery energy storage systems, and solar energy generation purposes; and further, to authorize the Selectboard to enter into such a lease or leases for such purposes, for all or a portion of the property upon such terms and conditions as the Selectboard determines to be in the best interest of the Town, such lease or leases to exceed three years; and to authorize the Selectboard to grant such non-exclusive access and utility easements as the Selectboard deems appropriate in support of such uses; and to further authorize the Selectboard to enter into such agreements and execute such instruments as may be necessary to effectuate the purposes of this article; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

(Selectboard Vote: 2 Approve, 1 Abstain)

ARTICLE 16. To see if the Town will vote to accept the provisions of G.L. c. 60A, § 10(a) allowing the Town to increase the assessed amount of the excise tax assessed pursuant to G.L. c. 60A, § 1 by a rate of 5 percent, such increase to take effect on assessments in the next calendar year; such acceptance contingent upon enactment by the Legislature of the so-called Municipal Empowerment Act; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 17. To see if the Town will vote to accept the provisions of G.L. c. 40, § 22F to allow, subject to the restrictions set forth in the statute, Town boards or officers to fix reasonable fees for the issuance of a license, permit, or certificate, or for services rendered or work performed; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ☒ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ No Action

ARTICLE 18. To see if the Town will vote to amend the General By-Laws, Article XVI, Scenic Roads, by inserting therein a new Section 3.1 as follows, with subsequent subsections to be renumbered consecutively as appropriate, or take any other action relative thereto:

Section 3.1 DESIGNATION The Town designates all municipal ways as Scenic Roads other than as excepted pursuant to G.L. c.40, § 15C.

(Submitted by: Planning Board)

Selectboard Action: ☐ Approved ☐ Disapproved ☒ No Action

ARTICLE 19. To see if the Town will vote amend the Ashby Zoning By-laws as follows, or take any other action relative thereto.

1. Amend Section 3 of the Zoning By-laws to add the following definitions and renumber succeeding definitions accordingly:
 - 32) INDUSTRIAL USE, LIGHT: Includes manufacturing practices and spaces that do not use capital or energy intensive machinery or production equipment.
 - 33) INDUSTRIAL USE, HEAVY Includes manufacturing practices and spaces that use capital and/or energy-intensive machinery or production equipment to produce large and complex products.
2. Amend the Zoning Map of the Town of Ashby to rename the “Industrial” zoning district the “Light Industrial” zoning district;
3. Amend Section 2.1.4 of the Zoning Bylaws to delete the strikethrough text and insert the underlined text, as follows:

Section 2.1.4 ~~Industrial~~—Light Industrial--LI

and amend the remaining sections of the Zoning By-laws to replace “Industrial” with "Light Industrial" wherever it further appears and is capitalized;

4. Delete Section 8: Industrial of the Zoning By-laws in its entirety and replace it with the following:

SECTION 8 LIGHT INDUSTRIAL DISTRICT

8.1 Purpose:

The Light Industrial District is intended primarily for production, processing, and assembly plants that are operated so that noise, odor, dust, and glare of such operations are completely confined within an enclosed building. These industries will, by their nature, generate traffic; however, the size and volume of raw materials and finished products should not produce the volume of traffic generated by heavy industrial uses. The Light Industrial District is also intended for the development of office/warehouse uses.

8.2 Permitted Uses:

8.2.1 Permitted Uses: office; warehouse; distribution facilities; professional service establishment; self-storage facilities; light manufacturing; processing of materials; fabrication of products; assembly of products; packaging and

storage of products; and indoor reclamation, processing, storage, and sale of scrap materials.

8.2.2 Prohibited Uses: Slaughter houses; crematoriums; outdoor uses; and uses that generate in excess of an average of 20 vehicle trips per hour over any eight (8) hour period.

8.3 Special Permits:

8.3.1 Activities, accessory to activities otherwise permitted within the district as a matter of right, which activities are necessary in connection with scientific research or scientific development or related production, whether or not on the same parcel as activities permitted as a matter of right, subject to the provisions of Section 11.3 for a Special Permit.

8.3.2 Marijuana Establishment. A maximum of one (1) Marijuana Establishment may be located in the Light Industrial District subject to approval of a special permit by the Zoning Board of Appeals. Marijuana social consumption shall not be permitted. All special permits shall be subject to Section 12.3 (“Special Permits”), Paragraph 12.3.3 (“Requirements, Marijuana Establishments and Registered Marijuana Dispensaries.”). All Marijuana Establishments shall be located a minimum of 500 (five hundred) feet from any public or private school. All Marijuana Establishments shall be licensed by the State, meet all applicable State regulations and State permit conditions, and conform to all provisions of this section.

8.3.3 Registered Marijuana Dispensaries. A Registered Marijuana Dispensary may be located in the Light Industrial District subject to approval of a special permit by the Zoning Board of Appeals. All special permits shall be subject to Paragraph 12.3.3 Requirements, Marijuana Establishments and Registered Marijuana Dispensaries. Marijuana social consumption shall not be permitted.

8.3.4 Waste handling facilities; screening, reclamation, processing and storage of scrap materials. Where such uses meet the definition of “facilities” pursuant to G.L. c. 111, § 150A, and have received a site assignment pursuant to said § 150A, they shall be allowed subject to such reasonable conditions on the construction or operation of the facility as the special permit granting authority may impose.

8.4 Performance Standards for Uses in the Light Industrial District:

8.4.1 Any use established in the Light Industrial District after the effective date of this bylaw shall be operated as to comply with performance standards governing:

1. Emissions including smoke and particulate matter

2. Vibration
3. Heat, odors, glare, and/or steam
4. Noise
5. Water supply, drainage, rubbish, and waste disposal systems
6. Air contaminants
7. General light industrial activities
8. Toxic matter
9. Stormwater

Any use already established on the effective date of this chapter shall be permitted to be altered, enlarged, expanded, or modified, provided that such changes comply with the performance standards below and all other applicable laws and regulations.

8.4.1.1 Emissions including smoke and particulate matter:

Emissions of smoke, dust, and other particulate matter, and of toxic and noxious gases must comply with Massachusetts and Federal standards.

1. The total emission of particulate matter from all sources within the boundaries of the site occupied by the use shall not exceed the net amount permitted in the Zoning District in which the use is located.

2. For the purpose of grading the density of smoke, the Ringelmann Chart, published and used by the United States Bureau of Mines, shall be employed. The emission of smoke or particulate matter of a density greater than No. 2 on the Ringelmann Chart is prohibited at all times, except as otherwise provided hereinafter.

3. The emissions of particulate matter containing more than 5% by weight of particles having a particle diameter larger than 44 microns is prohibited.

4. Dust and other types of air pollution, borne by the wind from such sources as storage areas, yards, roads and so forth within site boundaries shall be kept to a minimum by appropriate landscaping, paving, oiling or other acceptable means. Emission of particulate matter from such sources in excess of the weight limitations set forth in this bylaw is prohibited.

5. The rate of particulate matter emission from all sources within the boundaries of the site occupied by the use shall not exceed a net figure of one pound per acre of site area during any one-hour period. Determination of the total net rate of emission of particulate matter shall be made as follows:

(a) Determine the maximum emission in pounds per hour from each source of emission and divide this figure by the number of acres of site area, thereby obtaining the gross hourly rate of emission in

pounds per acre.

(b) Add together the individual net rates of emission derived in the above item to obtain the total net rate of emission from all sources of emission within the boundaries of the site; such total shall not exceed one pound per acre of site area during any one hour.

8.4.1.2 Vibration

Vibration caused by every use shall be so minimized that the ground vibration does not occur at any point on or beyond the lot in which the use is located.

8.4.1.3 Heat, odors, glare, and/or steam

Heat, odors, glare and/or steam produced by any activity shall not intrude beyond the boundary lines of the lot within which the use is located.

8.4.1.4 Noise

All uses and activities in the Light Industrial District shall comply with the Ashby Board of Health Noise Regulations.

8.4.1.5 Water supply, drainage, rubbish, and waste disposal systems

Water supply, drainage, rubbish, and waste disposal systems shall conform with all applicable federal, state, and Town of Ashby rules, regulations, codes, and standards.

8.4.1.6 Air contaminants

Discharge into the atmosphere of air contaminants shall be subject to all requirements of the Massachusetts Department of Environmental Protection and U.S. Environmental Protection Agency, as applicable.

8.4.1.7 General light industrial activities

Light industrial activities shall be of such nature as not to cause damage or nuisance to health, safety, peace, or general welfare of persons residing or working in the vicinity of the Light Industrial District.

8.4.1.8 Toxic matter

No activity or operation shall cause, at any time, the discharge of toxic or noxious matter across lot lines in such concentrations as to be detrimental to or endanger the public health, safety, comfort or welfare or cause injury or damage to property or business.

8.4.1.9 Stormwater

The developer and/or owner of any use in the Light Industrial District shall obtain coverage under the National Pollutant Discharge Elimination System (NPDES) Construction General Permit for Stormwater Discharges from Construction Activities, as applicable. Post construction runoff from the lot shall not exceed preconstruction runoff at all lot lines.

8.5 Table of Dimensional Requirements:

Minimum Area 60,000 sq feet (5574 sq m)

Minimum Frontage 150 feet (45.72 m)

Minimum Set-Back from Street Center 75 feet (22.86 m)

Minimum Side and Rear Yard Set-Back 25 feet (7.62 m)

Building area shall not exceed thirty-five percent (35%) of the lot area.

All structures must meet minimum set-back requirements.

(Submitted by: Planning Board)

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved ✓ No Action

ARTICLE 20. To see if the Town will vote to amend the General By-Laws, Article XIII, Earth Removal, by deleting the language therein in its entirety and inserting in its place the following; or take any other action relative thereto.

ARTICLE XIII EARTH REMOVAL

Section 1. PURPOSE:

The purpose of this bylaw is to prevent the degradation of the Town's natural resources including its soil, surface and groundwater, and naturally occurring vegetation due to improper or uncontrolled removal of earth, trees, and vegetation; and to protect the right of every resident to enjoy the natural, scenic, historic, and aesthetic qualities of the environment.

Section 2. GENERAL PROVISIONS:

The excavation in any one year of more than 25 cubic yards of soil, sod, loam, peat, humus, clay, sand, rock, or gravel (herein "earth") from any land within the town shall not be permitted.

The Earth Removal Board (herein "ERB") is hereby established and shall consist of five members as follows: The Selectboard, Conservation Commission, Planning Board, Board of Health, and Zoning Board of Appeals shall each appoint one member to serve a three-year term.

Section 3. EXEMPTIONS:

The following activities are exempted from this bylaw:

1. Earth Removal from municipal property for a municipal purpose.
2. Earth Removal incidental to the construction of buildings for which all other permits have been issued. "Incidental to the construction" means excavations necessary to construct foundations and install utilities for buildings to be completed approximately consistent with the surface topography prior to earth removal. "Incidental to construction" does not include excavation that substantially alters the lot topography

such that the volume removed is disproportionate to the volume of the basement and utility lines.

3. Earth Removal associated with the installation of walks, driveways, septic systems, swimming pools, or other accessory uses to buildings for which all other permits have been issued, provided that permits are in hand for the walks, driveways, septic systems, swimming pools, or other accessory uses. The volume of earth removed must not substantially exceed the volume of these items.
4. Earth Removal associated with the construction of fire ponds, fire cisterns, and other water storage for fire suppression that are approved by the Fire Department.
5. Earth Removal associated with the construction of roads and associated drainage shown on an approved subdivision plan.

Section 4. PRE-EXISTING OPERATIONS:

Any continuous legal operation at the time that the original Ashby Earth Removal bylaw was adopted on April 26, 1988 (herein “the original bylaw”) may continue until abandoned for more than twelve (12) consecutive months. However, the following conditions apply to pre-existing operations:

1. The earth removal operation shall be contained within the property limits of such operation on the effective date of the original bylaw. Expansion to additional parcels is prohibited.
2. The depth of excavation shall not be increased below the lowest point excavated on the effective date of this bylaw, or five (5) feet above maximum high-water table as specified by the original bylaw, or whichever is higher.
3. The excavation shall remain at least 100 feet from abutter’s property lines and public ways. Where current or completed earth removal operations are less than 100 feet to an abutter’s property line or a public way, no further expansion shall be permitted.
4. The excavation shall not encroach on the setbacks as required by the Wetlands Protection Act.

Portions of the operations that exceed the dimensional limits above shall be deemed to be not part of the pre-existing operation, and therefore to be a violation of the Earth Removal bylaw.

Section 5: RESTORATION STANDARDS

Unless otherwise approved by the Earth Removal Board, following cessation of operations, all land shall be graded leaving no slopes with a grade steeper than a two (2) foot horizontal to a one (1) foot vertical (2:1); 4:1 is preferred for erosion control and shall be required in sensitive areas.

Retained subsoil and topsoil, or other organic material approved by the Earth Removal Board, shall be spread over the disturbed area to a minimum depth of four (4) inches. This area shall be seeded with a grass or legume mixture or other plantings as approved by the ERB to reduce erosion. The planted area shall be protected from erosion during the establishment period using good conservation practices.

Final restoration work must be completed within one year after cessation of operations, or other reasonable time period as approved by the ERB.

Section 6. ENFORCEMENT:

The Earth Removal Board shall enforce this bylaw and may issue orders as it deems necessary and appropriate to obtain compliance with the requirements of this bylaw and to prevent a threatened violation thereof. In carrying out its duties the Earth Removal Board may, at its discretion, conduct posted public hearings to investigate and determine alleged violations of the Earth Removal bylaw. The ERB shall cause notice of such public hearings to be published in a newspaper of general circulation in the Town a notice of said hearing once in each of two successive weeks, the first publication being not less than 14 days before such hearing, and at the hearing shall provide proof of such notification. At least fourteen (14) days prior to said hearing the ERB shall notify the owner of the parcel on which the alleged violation is occurring, the person or entity responsible for the earth removal, if different, and all direct abutters, by certified mail as to the date, time and place of the public hearing.

Following the hearing the ERB shall make a written decision as to whether or not the earth removal operation is in violation of this bylaw. The decision shall include specific findings for each alleged violation. The decision shall be filed with the Town Clerk not less than 45 days following the hearing and notice thereof sent to the abutters, the owner of the parcel and person or entity responsible, and the Selectboard.

Decisions of the ERB may be appealed to the Selectboard by persons aggrieved within 45 days of the filing with the Town Clerk.

Section 7. PENALTY:

This bylaw may be enforced by any lawful means in law or in equity, including, but not limited to, a request for injunctive relief in a court of competent jurisdiction,

and by non-criminal disposition pursuant to G.L. c. 40, §21D. Any person who violates any provision of this bylaw may be punished by a fine as specified in Article 1 Section 4 of the Ashby Town Bylaws. Each day or portion thereof during which violation continues shall constitute a separate offense. The imposition of a fine shall not be construed to prevent enforcement by all other means available.

(Submitted by: Earth Removal Board)

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved ✓ No Action

ARTICLE 21. To see if the Town will vote amend the Ashby Zoning By-laws as follows, or take any other action relative thereto.

1. Delete Sections 5.1.2 and 6.1.5 of the Zoning By-laws in their entirety, including their subsections, and renumber the remaining subsections of Sections 5.1 and 6.1 accordingly;
2. Amend SECTION 2: Definitions, to insert the underlined language, as follows:

30) HOME OCCUPATION. Any use customarily conducted for profit by the inhabitants of a dwelling, provided such use is clearly incidental and secondary to the use of the building for dwelling purposes and does not change the residential character thereof. Home occupations shall include, but are not limited to:

- a) Use of space in a dwelling for a professional office or studio maintained by resident occupants;
- b) Use of premises in connection with their trade by a resident carpenter, electrician, painter, plumber, or other artisan provided that no manufacturing or business requiring substantially continuous employment shall be within the principal residential structure or within suitable accessory buildings.
- c) Renting of rooms or furnishing of board for not more than 3 non-transient persons in a dwelling regularly occupied for residential purposes.

3. Add a new Section 4.1.3 to SECTION 4: Permitted Uses, as follows:

4.1.3 Home Occupations

4.1.3.1 Home Occupations are allowed by right in all residential districts only if the use is by a resident of the premises provided that:

4.1.3.1.1 The home occupation use has been granted a use

permit by the building official.

4.1.3.1.2 The home occupation is conducted within the primary dwelling or an accessory structure suited for its use.

4.1.3.1.3. The home occupation occupies no more than 25% of the gross living space or no more than 500 square feet of the dwelling or accessory structure, whichever is less.

4.1.3.1.4. The use is customary and incidental to the primary use of the lot for dwelling purposes.

4.1.3.1.5. The use is conducted solely indoors and is indiscernible from the street and view except for a properly permitted sign. One sign of one or two sides no larger than 6 square feet (.55 sq. m.) per side may be displayed. Electrified signs are prohibited.

4.1.3.1.6. There are no deliveries other than those normally seen in the residential district.

4.1.3.1.7. There is no stockpiling of materials or storage of equipment or vehicles outside associated with the home occupation.

4.1.3.1.8. No commercial vehicle in excess of 33,000 pounds gross vehicle weight is used or parked on the premises associated with the home occupation use.

4.1.3.1.9. There is not more than one customer or visitor associated with the home occupation per day.

4.1.3.1.10. There are no employees other than the residents of the dwelling.

4.1.3.1.11. There are no outdoor displays of merchandise.

4.1.3.1.12. The use does not produce offensive noise, dust, odor, vibrations, electrical interference, radioactive emissions or environmental pollutants.

4.1.3.1.13. The use is registered with the town.

4.1.3.2 Special Permit Home Occupation. The following home occupation uses may be allowed in all residential districts by special permit issued by the Board of Appeals after a public hearing and subject to appropriate conditions, if determined to be neither offensive nor detrimental to the residential area. The Board of Appeals may subject uses to conditions including, but not limited to, hours of operation, maximum floor area for the use, off street parking and numbers of visitors or customers daily visits.

4.1.3.2.1. To allow the use to exceed 25 % of the gross living space or 500 square feet, whichever is less.

4.1.3.2.2. To allow up to two employees not part of the resident family.

4.1.3.2.3 To allow traffic from clients and delivery vehicles that is greater volume than that which would be anticipated in the residential district.

4.1.3.2.4. In making its decision the Board of Appeals will determine that the lot contains adequate parking for all uses of the lot and that no hazard or nuisance including excessive noise, dust, odor, heat, glare, noxious fumes or vibrations shall be created to any greater degree than what would normally be expected under normal conditions where no home occupation exists.

(Submitted by: Building Inspector)

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved √ No Action

ARTICLE 22. To see if the Town will vote pursuant to the provisions of G.L. c. 41, § 1B to change the separate positions of elected Treasurer and elected Collector into a single combined appointed Treasurer-Collector position to be appointed by the Selectboard for a term of up to three years; provided, however, that such change shall not take effect unless it is also approved by the voters at a Town Election; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: √ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

ARTICLE 23. To see if the Town will vote to accept the provisions of G.L. c. 166, § 32A allowing the appointed Inspector of Wires to practice for hire or engage in the business for which the Inspector is licensed under and pursuant to the applicable provisions of law as specified in the statute while serving as such Inspector, as well as

allowing for the appointment of an Assistant Inspector who shall exercise the duties of inspector of wires as provided therein; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: ✓ Approved Disapproved No Action

And you are hereby directed to serve this warrant by posting an attested copy hereof in at least three (3) public places in Ashby seven (7) days at least before the holding of said meeting. Hereof fail not, and make due return of this warrant, with your doings thereon, to the Town Clerk at the time and place of meeting aforesaid.

Given under our hands this day of April, 2024.

David Nadeau, Chair

Doug Leab, Clerk

Jessica Kallin, Member

ASHBY SELECTBOARD

DATE: _____

Derek Pepple, Chief of Police

**RESULTS OF THE ANNUAL TOWN MEETING
MAY 4, 2024**

The warrant was returned to the Town Clerk at 8:15 AM.

With a quorum present, the Moderator Nancy Chew called the meeting to order at 9:49 AM.

The warrant showed it was properly served.

The motion was made and seconded to waive the reading of the warrant, and so voted.

The moderator stated that the rules of the meeting are to be the same as the Special Town Meeting.

The motion was made and seconded to allow the moderator to declare a two-thirds vote, and so voted.

Article 1. The motion was made and seconded to elect all other Town officers not required to be elected on the official ballot; or take any other action relative thereto.

VOTE: **PASSED MAJORITY**

Article 2. The motion was made and seconded to hear the reports of the various Town officials and committees; or take any other action relative thereto.

VOTE: **UNANIMOUS**

Article 3. The motion was made and seconded that the Treasurer be authorized to borrow funds as necessary in anticipation of revenue, in accordance with MGL Chapter 44, Section 4.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 4. The motion was made and seconded that the Town accept the sums in trust, as specified in the warrant, the income therefrom to be expended for the perpetual care of cemetery lots.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 5. The motion was made and seconded that the Town appropriate \$40,000.00 from the ARCTS Enterprise Fund Revenues and \$250.00 from ARCTS free cash for the operation of the Ashby Recycling Center & Transfer Station for FY25.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 6. The motion was made and seconded move that the Town appropriate \$25,000.00 from the PEG Access special revenue fund for the operation of the PEG Access Department for FY25.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 7. The motion was made and seconded that the Town establish the fiscal year 2025 spending limits for each revolving fund as specified in the warrant.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 8. The motion was made and seconded that the Town appropriate all funds received from the Commonwealth under the provisions of the "Chapter 90" program as specified in the warrant.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 9. The motion was made and seconded move that the Town raise and appropriate the sum of \$9,698,052.81 and transfer from free cash the sum of \$675,262.00 to defray the expenses of the Town for the fiscal year commencing July 1, 2025, and to set the salaries of elected officials as specified in the warrant.

Motion made and seconded to revise the fiscal commencing date to July 1, 2024.

VOTE (on above motion): UNANIMOUS

VOTE (on original motion with amendment): UNANIMOUS

Budget ATM25		FY23	FY24	FY25
	LINES	SPENT	BUDGET	SELECTBOARD RECOMMENDS
Administration				
1	Salary	\$ 41,541.25	\$ 46,878.00	\$ 48,018.00
2	Expenses	\$ 5,896.57	\$ 17,750.00	\$ 17,750.00

		\$ 47,437.82	\$ 64,628.00	\$ 65,768.00
Town Administrator				
3	Salaries & Wages	\$ 72,312.19	\$ 110,000.00	\$ 104,000.00
		\$ 72,312.19	\$ 110,000.00	\$ 104,000.00
Finance Committee				
4	Expense Budget	\$ 163.00	\$ 600.00	\$ 600.00
5	Reserve Fund	\$ -	\$ 32,000.00	\$ 32,000.00
		\$ 163.00	\$ 32,600.00	\$ 32,600.00
Town Accountant				
6	Salaries & Wages	-	-	-
	Expenses	\$ 95,390.45	\$ 95,300.00	\$ 97,300.00
		\$ 95,390.45	\$ 95,300.00	\$ 97,300.00
Board of Assessors				
10	Wages	\$ 50,901.60	\$ 48,020.00	\$ 49,941.00
	Expenses	\$ 11,147.92	\$ 11,675.00	\$ 13,809.91
		\$ 62,049.52	\$ 59,695.00	\$ 63,750.91
Treasurer				
15	Treasurer Salary	\$ 38,051.12	\$ 39,500.00	\$ 40,437.50
	Expenses	\$ 17,835.22	\$ 22,030.00	\$ 22,029.00
		\$ 55,886.34	\$ 61,530.00	\$ 64,065.50
Tax Collector				
18	Tax Collector Salary	\$ 37,513.19	\$ 44,850.00	\$ 44,372.25
	Expenses	\$ 16,874.73	\$ 16,018.90	\$ 17,630.00
		\$ 54,387.92	\$ 60,868.90	\$ 62,002.25
Legal Services				
21	Expenses	\$ 92,499.37	\$ 45,000.00	\$ 45,000.00
		\$ 92,499.37	\$ 45,000.00	\$ 45,000.00
Technology and Systems				
22	Expenses	\$ 43,157.26	\$ 70,000.00	\$ 70,000.00
		\$ 43,157.26	\$ 70,000.00	\$ 70,000.00
Town Clerk				
23	Town Clerk Salary	\$ 51,656.26	\$ 50,000.00	\$ 51,246.00
25	Election and Registrar Stipend	\$ 6,355.74	\$ 8,300.00	\$ 8,550.00
	Expenses	\$ 9,492.01	\$ 11,900.00	\$ 13,550.00
		\$ 67,504.01	\$ 70,200.00	\$ 73,346.00
Town Reports				
30	Expenses	\$ 1,899.00	\$ 2,500.00	\$ 2,500.00
		\$ 1,899.00	\$ 2,500.00	\$ 2,500.00
Conservation Commission				
31	Expenses	\$ 771.90	\$ 1,150.00	\$ 1,150.00

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		\$ 771.90	\$ 1,150.00	\$ 1,150.00
Planning				
32	Expenses	\$ 967.14	\$ 2,275.00	\$ 2,275.00
		\$ 967.14	\$ 2,275.00	\$ 2,275.00
Zoning				
33	Expenses	\$ 1,814.12	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00
		\$ 1,814.12	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00
Land Use				
34	Agent	\$ 4,153.50	\$ 11,000.00	\$ 4,000.00
	Expenses	\$ 1,128.92	\$ 1,857.15	\$ 1,886.00
		\$ 5,282.42	\$ 12,857.15	\$ 5,886.00
Town Office				
	Expenses	\$ 44,607.32	\$ 49,030.00	\$ 49,030.00
		\$ 44,607.32	\$ 49,030.00	\$ 49,030.00
Town Clock				
40	Stipend	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 500.00	\$ 500.00
		\$ 1,000.00	\$ 500.00	\$ 500.00
Municipal Buildings/Grounds				
47	Wages/Stipend	\$ 9,426.64	\$ 9,900.00	\$ 10,100.00
48	Buildings/Grounds Expenses	\$ 69,061.27	\$ 64,000.00	\$ 64,000.00
		\$ 78,487.91	\$ 73,900.00	\$ 74,100.00
Police				
49	Police Salaries	\$ 661,013.70	\$ 845,857.00	\$ 847,236.22
	Expenses	\$ 108,915.44	\$ 129,050.00	\$ 121,950.00
		\$ 769,929.14	\$ 974,907.00	\$ 969,186.22
Public Safety Building				
53b	Expenses	\$ 21,665.80	\$ 51,500.00	\$ 51,500.00
Fire				
54	Fire Salaries	\$ 210,438.61	\$ 236,425.00	\$ 283,872.00
	Expenses	\$ 122,813.35	\$ 93,350.00	\$ 93,350.00
		\$ 333,251.96	\$ 329,775.00	\$ 377,222.00
EMS				
64	Wages - Coverage	\$ 110,758.24	\$ 122,150.00	\$ 124,375.00
	Expenses	\$ 58,191.94	\$ 67,750.00	\$ 67,750.00
		\$ 168,950.18	\$ 189,900.00	\$ 192,125.00
Emergency Management				
67(2)	Stipend	\$ 654.66	\$ 654.66	\$ 654.66
68	Expenses	\$ -	\$ 2,500.00	\$ 2,500.00

		\$ 654.66	\$ 3,154.66	\$ 3,154.66
E-911				
69	Expenses	\$ -	\$ 175.00	\$ 175.00
		\$ -	\$ 175.00	\$ 175.00
Building Inspector				
70	Salaries & Wages	\$ 19,148.11	\$ 19,723.00	\$ 20,216.00
71	Expenses	\$ 300.00	\$ 300.00	\$ 450.00
		\$ 19,448.11	\$ 20,023.00	\$ 20,666.00
Plumbing Inspector				
72	Salaries & Wages	\$ 7,500.00	\$ 7,650.00	\$ 7,850.00
73	Expenses	\$ 112.50	\$ 150.00	\$ 250.00
		\$ 7,612.50	\$ 7,800.00	\$ 8,100.00
Electrical Inspector				
74	Salaries & Wages	\$ 7,500.00	\$ 7,634.00	\$ 7,834.00
75	Expenses	-	900.00	900.00
		\$ 7,500.00	\$ 8,534.00	\$ 8,734.00
Dog Officer				
76	Salaries & Wages	\$ 16,651.08	\$ 16,651.00	\$ 16,651.00
77	Expenses	\$ 1,200.06	\$ 1,400.00	\$ 1,400.00
		\$ 17,851.14	\$ 18,051.00	\$ 18,051.00
Emergency Dispatch				
79	Expenses	\$ 180,393.56	\$ 139,000.00	\$ 139,000.00
		\$ 180,393.56	\$ 139,000.00	\$ 139,000.00
Monty Tech				
80	Assessment	\$ 350,957.32	\$ 392,887.00	\$ 342,708.00
		\$ 350,957.32	\$ 392,887.00	\$ 342,708.00
NMRSD				
	Assessment	\$ 4,421,476.00	\$ 5,086,974.00	\$ 4,890,915.00
		\$ 4,421,476.00	\$ 5,086,974.00	\$ 4,890,915.00
Highway				
83	Highway Salaries	\$ 302,853.18	\$ 349,000.00	\$ 339,616.00
	Expenses	\$ 520,058.84	\$ 376,980.00	\$ 372,980.00
		\$ 822,912.02	\$ 725,980.00	\$ 712,596.00
Snow & Ice				
92	Winter Overtime	\$ 18,351.58	\$ 13,000.00	\$ 13,000.00
93	Winter Expenses	\$ 290,072.49	\$ 87,000.00	\$ 87,000.00
		\$ 308,424.07	\$ 100,000.00	\$ 100,000.00
Street Lights				
94	Expenses	\$ 822.25	\$ 1,080.00	\$ -
		\$ 822.25	\$ 1,080.00	\$ -
Tree Warden				
95	Expenses	-	2,000.00	-

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		-	2,000.00	-
Cemetery				
96	Salaries	\$ 12,146.23	\$ 15,000.00	\$ 15,000.00
97	Expenses	\$ 1,676.81	\$ 3,500.00	\$ -
		\$ 13,823.04	\$ 18,500.00	\$ 15,000.00
Board of Health				
	Expenses	\$ 21,489.47	\$ 25,028.76	\$ 26,590.54
		\$ 21,489.47	\$ 25,028.76	\$ 26,590.54
Animal Inspector				
102	Stipend	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,200.00
102A	Rabies Testing	-	400.00	400.00
		\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,400.00	\$ 1,600.00
Council on Aging				
103	Wages	\$ 30,551.15	\$ 36,210.00	\$ 38,122.00
103A	Expense	\$ 4,643.13	\$ 5,100.00	\$ 5,400.00
		\$ 35,194.28	\$ 41,310.00	\$ 43,522.00
Veterans' Services				
104	Salaries & Wages	\$ 499.73	\$ 2,058.94	\$ 2,058.94
	Expenses	\$ 18,467.49	\$ 42,000.00	\$ 39,400.00
		\$ 18,967.22	\$ 44,058.94	\$ 41,458.94
Library				
107	Librarian Salary	\$ 60,265.50	\$ 61,880.00	\$ 64,502.00
	Expenses	\$ 46,212.77	\$ 51,477.00	\$ 51,677.00
		\$ 106,478.27	\$ 113,357.00	\$ 116,179.00
Band Concerts				
113	Expenses	\$ 9,556.76	\$ 9,850.00	\$ 9,850.00
		\$ 9,556.76	\$ 9,850.00	\$ 9,850.00
July 3rd				
114	Expenses	\$ 1,200.00	\$ 1,200.00	\$ 1,200.00
		\$ 1,200.00	\$ 1,200.00	\$ 1,200.00
Allen Field				
115	Expenses	\$ 4,692.38	\$ 6,750.00	\$ -
		\$ 4,692.38	\$ 6,750.00	\$ -
Town Common				
116	Expenses	\$ 1,360.87	\$ 6,500.00	\$ -
		\$ 1,360.87	\$ 6,500.00	\$ -
Debt Service				
118	Temporary Loan Interest	\$ 78,500.00	\$ 1,000.00	\$ -
119	LT Debt Principal	\$	\$	\$ 156,739.50
120	LT Debt Interest	\$	\$	\$ 149,962.50
		\$ 78,500.00	\$ 307,702.00	\$ 348,533.00

Middlesex Retirement				
123	Middlesex Retirement System	\$ 253,936.00	\$ 254,095.00	\$ 268,891.00
		\$ 253,936.00	\$ 254,095.00	\$ 268,891.00
Unemployment				
124	Unemployment Compensation	\$ 6,048.01	\$ 15,000.00	\$ 15,000.00
		\$ 6,048.01	\$ 15,000.00	\$ 15,000.00
Employee Ins. Benefits				
125	Employee Benefits Expense	\$ 515,421.87	\$ 683,627.12	\$ 642,000.00
		\$ 515,421.87	\$ 683,627.12	\$ 642,000.00
Workers Compensation				
126	Insurance Not Health	\$ 368.00	\$ 20,400.00	\$ 20,000.00
		\$ 368.00	\$ 20,400.00	\$ 20,000.00
Insurance P & C				
127	Liability P&C, E,F&P	\$ 99,671.08	\$ 136,500.00	\$ 143,813.00
		\$ 99,671.08	\$ 136,500.00	\$ 143,813.00
FICA				
128	Employee Costs	\$ 25,233.46	\$ 29,389.12	\$ 30,270.79
		\$ 25,233.46	\$ 29,389.12	\$ 30,270.79
	Total	\$ 9,328,741.31	\$ 10,579,442.65	\$ 10,372,314.81

Elective Salaries:

Town Clerk: \$51,246.00

Town Treasurer: \$40,437.50 (includes \$1,000 certification stipend & \$1000 Longevity Bonus for Treasurer)

Town Tax Collector: \$38,437.50

Article 10. The motion was made and seconded that the Town raise and appropriate the sum of \$595,693.00 for the purpose of additionally funding the Fiscal Year 2025 North Middlesex Regional School District operating and transportation budget; provided, however, that the appropriation authorized herein shall be subject to and contingent upon approval of the voters at the Town Election to assess additional real estate and personal property taxes in accordance with the provisions of G.L. c. 59, §21C, Proposition 2 1/2 so called.

VOTE: PASSED MAJORITY

Article 11. The motion was made and seconded that this article be passed over.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 12. The motion was made and seconded that the Town amend Zoning By-Laws Section 8.2.5 Marijuana Establishment as written in the warrant.

VOTE: DEFEATED

Article 13. The motion was made and seconded that the Town amend the General By-Laws, Article II, Town Meetings, Section 5 as written in the warrant.

VOTE: DEFEATED

Article 14. The motion was made and seconded that that the Town approve Article 14 as written in the warrant.

VOTE: PASSED (2/3 VOTE DECLARED BY MODERATOR)

Article 15. The motion was made and seconded that the Town approve Article 15 as written in the warrant.

Motion made and seconded to remove the word “telecommunications” from article 15.

VOTE (on above motion): PASSED MAJORITY

VOTE (on original motion with amendment): PASSED (2/3 VOTE DECLARED BY MODERATOR)

Article 16. The motion was made and seconded that the Town accept the provisions of G.L. c. 60A, § 10(a) as written in the warrant, contingent upon enactment by the Legislature of the so-called Municipal Empowerment Act or similar enabling legislation.

VOTE: PASSED (STANDING COUNT 52 YES / 31 NO)

Article 17. The motion was made and seconded that the Town accept the provisions of G.L. c. 40, § 22F as written in the warrant.

VOTE: PASSED MAJORITY

Article 18. The motion was made and seconded that the Town amend the General By-Laws, Article XVI, Scenic Roads as written in the warrant.

VOTE: DEFEATED (STANDING COUNT 42 YES / 43 NO)

Article 19. The motion was made and seconded that the Town amend Zoning By-Laws as written in Article 19 of the warrant.

VOTE: PASSED (2/3 VOTE DECLARED BY MODERATOR)

Article 20. The motion was made and seconded that the Town amend the General By-Laws, Article XIII, Earth Removal as written in the warrant.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 21. The motion was made and seconded that this article be passed over.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 22. The motion was made and seconded that the Town vote pursuant to the provisions of G.L. c. 41, § 1B to change the separate positions of elected Treasurer and elected Collector into a single combined appointed Treasurer-Collector position to be appointed by the Selectboard for a term of up to three years; provided, however, that such change shall not take effect unless it is also approved by the voters at the Annual Town Election.

VOTE: PASSED (STANDING COUNT 43 YES / 37 NO)

Article 23. The motion was made and seconded that the Town vote to accept the provisions of G.L. c. 166, § 32A as written in the warrant.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

The motion was made and seconded to dissolve the Annual Town Meeting at 12:55 PM.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Angela M. Jack, *Town Clerk*

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
SPECIAL TOWN ELECTION
June 18, 2024**

Middlesex, ss:

To: Constable of the Town of Ashby in said County:

GREETING:

In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby directed to notify and warn the inhabitants of the Town of Ashby, who are qualified to vote in elections and town affairs, to meet at the Ashby Elementary School, 911 Main Street, Ashby, Tuesday, the 18th day of June 2024, 12:00 PM, to give in their votes on one ballot for the following question:

• PROPOSITION 2 ½ OVERRIDE

QUESTION 1

Shall the Town of Ashby be allowed to assess an additional \$595,693.00 in real estate and personal property taxes for the purposes of additionally funding the North Middlesex Regional School District operating and transportation budget for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2024?

YES _____ NO _____

The polls will be open at 12:00 PM and shall close at 7:30 PM.

And you are hereby directed to serve this warrant by posting an attested copy in three (3) public places in said Ashby at least fourteen days before holding of said election.

Hereof, fail not, and make due return of this warrant with your doings theron, to the Town Clerk at the time and place of election aforesaid.

Given under our hands this _____ day of May 2024.

David Nadeau, Chair

Doug Leab, Clerk

Jessica Kallin, Member

ASHBY SELECTBOARD

By virtue of this precept, I have posted three (3) copies of the foregoing warrant in three (3) public places in said Ashby fourteen days at least before time of said Special Town Election.

DATE _____

Derek Pepple
POLICE CHIEF

RESULTS OF SPECIAL TOWN ELECTION
June 18, 2024

The warrant was returned to the Town Clerk at 11:15AM on Tuesday, June 18, 2024.

Election officers on duty and duly sworn in were as follows: Betty Tiilikkala, Joyce Hopkins, Tracey Robinson-Harris, Barbara Thorpe, Angie Godin, Sandi Heyes, Emma Jack, Linda Stacy, and Gary Asher.

The polls opened at 12:00 PM.

The following is a question and the votes and blanks it received as they appeared on the official ballot.

	VOTES
QUESTION #1	
YES	275
NO	410
Blanks	1
Total Ballots Cast	686

The polls closed at 7:30 PM.

Tellers on duty and duly sworn in were as follows: Pam Peeler, Deb Pillsbury, Garry Baer, Tracey Robinson-Harris, Katie Marsh, Teresa Nagle, Gary Asher, Mary Ann Allen, Patricia Wayrynen, Sandi Heyes, Michael Harrison, Emma Jack, Martha Morgan, Nancy Richards, Angie Godin, Ava McNeil, and, Brendan McNeil.

At the close of the polls the ballot box read 686 voters had cast a ballot: the checker's tally sheet read 686 voters had cast a ballot. This included 21 absentee votes and 199 early votes.

Angela M. Jack, *Town Clerk*

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
SPECIAL TOWN MEETING
AUGUST 20, 2024**

Middlesex ss:

To the Constable of the Town of Ashby in said County

Greeting:

In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby directed to notify and warn the inhabitants of the Town of Ashby qualified to vote in elections and town affairs, to meet at the Ashby Elementary School Gymnasium, 911 Main Street in said Ashby, Tuesday, August 20, 2024 at 6:00 PM, to act on the following articles:

ARTICLE 1: To see if the Town will vote to appropriate the sum of \$256,133.00, in addition to \$4,890,915 appropriated at the May 4, 2024 Annual Town Meeting, for the purpose of additionally funding the Town's assessed portion of the reapportioned and recertified Fiscal Year 2025 Northern Middlesex Regional School District budget, for a total FY25 Regional School District budget appropriation of \$5,147,048.00; said appropriation to be funded by transferring \$125,000.00 from the Stabilization Fund, \$62,133.00 from the item FY25 Police Salary line, and \$69,000.00 from the FY25 Employee Health Benefit line item,; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: √ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

And you are hereby directed to serve this warrant by posting an attested copy in at least three (3) public places in said Ashby, fourteen (14) days at least before the holding of said meeting. Hereof fail not, and make due return of this warrant with your doings thereon to the Town Clerk at the time and place of meeting aforesaid.

Given under our hands this _____ day of July, 2024.

David Nadeau, Chair	Doug Leab, Clerk	Jessica Kallin, Member
TOWN OF ASHBY SELECTBOARD		

By virtue of this precept, I have posted three (3) attested copies of the foregoing warrant in three (3) public places in Ashby at least fourteen days before the time of said Special Town Meeting.

DATE: _____
Derek Pepple, Chief of Police

RESULTS OF THE SPECIAL TOWN MEETING
August 20, 2024

The warrant was returned to the Town Clerk at 5:15 PM.

With a quorum present and the Town Moderator being absent, the Town Clerk, Angela Jack, called the meeting to order at 6:04 PM.

The Town Clerk asked for nominations to elect a temporary moderator for this meeting.

Terri Cantor was nominated with no other nominations put forth.

A motion was made and seconded to allow the selectboard chair to cast a single ballot in favor of the nominee.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

The Selectboard chair cast his ballot in favor of Terri Cantor being appointed as temporary moderator for this special town meeting.

The Town Clerk announced that the remainder of this special town meeting would be presided over by the temporary moderator – Terri Cantor.

The warrant showed it was properly served.

The rules of the meeting were read.

A motion was made and seconded to waive the reading of the warrant, and so voted.

A motion was made and seconded to allow the moderator to declare a two-thirds vote, and so voted.

Article 1. A motion was made and seconded to appropriate the sum of \$256,133.00,

in addition to \$4,890,915 appropriated at the May 4, 2024 Annual Town Meeting, for the purpose of additionally funding the Town's assessed portion of the reapportioned and recertified Fiscal Year 2025 Northern Middlesex Regional School District budget, for a total FY25 Regional School District budget appropriation of \$5,147,048.00; said appropriation to be funded by transferring \$125,000.00 from the Stabilization Fund, \$62,133.00 from the item FY25 Police Salary line, and \$69,000.00 from the FY25 Employee Health Benefit line item.

A motion was made and seconded to amend Article 1 by striking the words "\$125,000 from Stabilization Fund" and striking the words "\$69,000 from the FY25 Health Benefits line item; or take any other action relative thereto and substituting the words: "\$194,000 from the FY25 Employee Health Benefits line item."

VOTE ON AMENDMENT: FAILED

VOTE ON ORIGINAL MOTION: PASSED (2/3 MAJORITY DECLARED BY MODERATOR)

The motion was made and seconded to dissolve the Special Town Meeting at 6:37 PM.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Angela M. Jack, *Town Clerk*

**THE COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
WILLIAM FRANCIS GALVIN
SECRETARY OF THE COMMONWEALTH
2024 STATE PRIMARY**

MIDDLESEX, SS:

To: Constable of the Town of Ashby

GREETINGS:

In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby required to notify and warn the inhabitants of said Town who are qualified to vote in Primaries to vote at the ASHBY ELEMENTARY SCHOOL, 911 Main Street on TUESDAY, THE 3rd DAY OF SEPTEMBER 2024 from 7:00 AM to 8:00 PM for the following purpose:

To cast their votes in the State Primary for the candidates of political parties for the following offices:

SENATOR IN CONGRESS

For the Commonwealth

REPRESENTATIVE IN CONGRESS	Third District
COUNCILLOR	Seventh District
SENATOR IN GENERAL COURT	Worcester & Middlesex District
REPRESENTATIVE IN GENERAL COURT	First Middlesex District
CLERK OF COURTS	Middlesex County
REGISTER OF DEEDS	Middlesex Southern District

Hereof, fail not and make do return of this warrant with your doings thereon at the time and place of said voting.

Given under our hands this _____ day of July 2024.

David Nadeau, Chair	Doug Leab, Clerk	Jessica Kallin, Member
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ASHBY SELECTBOARD

By virtue of this precept, I have posted three (3) attested copies of the foregoing warrant in three (3) public places in said Ashby at least seven days before the time of the State Primary.

DATE: _____
Derek Pepple, Police Chief

RESULTS OF STATE PRIMARY
September 3, 2024

The warrant was returned to the Town Clerk at 6:15AM.

Election officers on duty and duly sworn were as follows: Betty Tiilikkala, Joyce Hopkins, Angie Godin, Deb Theall, Tracey Robinson-Harris, Emma Jack, June McNeil, Deb Dancause, Linda Stacy and Gary Asher.

The polls opened at 7:00 AM.

The following is a list of candidates as they appeared on the official ballots, the votes each received and the total blanks:

Democratic Ballot

	VOTES
SENATOR IN CONGRESS	
Elizabeth Ann Warren	198
All Others	0
Blanks	11
Total Ballots Cast	209
REPRESENTATIVE IN CONGRESS	
Lori Loureiro Trahan	202
All Others	0
Blanks	7
Total Ballots Cast	209
COUNCILOR	
Paul M. DePalo	189
All Others	0
Blanks	20
Total Ballots Cast	209
SENATOR IN GENERAL COURT	
John J. Cronin	194
All Others	0
Blanks	15
Total Ballots Cast	209
REPRESENTATIVE IN GENERAL COURT	
Margaret R. Scarsdale	203
All Others	0
Blanks	6
Total Ballots Cast	209
CLERK OF COURTS	
Michael A. Sullivan	19
All Others	0
Blanks	118

Total Ballots Cast	209
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REGISTER OF DEEDS	
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Maria C. Curtatone	191
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All Others	0
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Blanks	18
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Total Ballots Cast	209
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Libertarian Ballot

VOTES

SENATOR IN CONGRESS	
---------------------	--

All Others	0
------------	---

Blanks	6
--------	---

Total Ballots Cast	6
--------------------	---

REPRESENTATIVE IN CONGRESS	
----------------------------	--

All Others	0
------------	---

Blanks	6
--------	---

Total Ballots Cast	6
--------------------	---

COUNCILOR	
-----------	--

All Others	0
------------	---

Blanks	6
--------	---

Total Ballots Cast	6
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SENATOR IN GENERAL COURT	
--------------------------	--

All Others	0
------------	---

Blanks	6
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Total Ballots Cast	6
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REPRESENTATIVE IN GENERAL COURT	
---------------------------------	--

All Others	0
------------	---

Blanks	6
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Total Ballots Cast	6
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CLERK OF COURTS	
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All Others	0
Blanks	6
Total Ballots Cast	6

REGISTER OF DEEDS

All Others	0
Blanks	6
Total Ballots Cast	6

Republican Ballot

VOTES

SENATOR IN CONGRESS

Robert J. Antonellis	47
Ian Cain	7
John Deaton	118
All Others	0
Blanks	4
Total Ballots Cast	176

REPRESENTATIVE IN CONGRESS

All Others	0
Blanks	176
Total Ballots Cast	176

COUNCILOR

Andrew J. Couture	144
All Others	0
Blanks	32
Total Ballots Cast	176

SENATOR IN GENERAL COURT

Nicholas A. Pirro, III	149
All Others	0
Blanks	27
Total Ballots Cast	176

REPRESENTATIVE IN GENERAL COURT	
Lynn E. Archambault	149
All Others	0
Blanks	27
Total Ballots Cast	176
CLERK OF COURTS	
All Others	0
Blanks	176
Total Ballots Cast	176
REGISTER OF DEEDS	
All Others	0
Blanks	176
Total Ballots Cast	176

The polls closed at 8:00 PM.

Tellers on duty and duly sworn in were as follows: Pam Peeler, Deb Pillsbury, Shawn Keating, Tracey Robinson-Harris, Katie Marsh, Deb Theall, June McNeil, Gary Asher, Barbara Thorpe, Terri Cantor, Deb Dancause, Angie Godin, Teresa Nagle, Brendan McNeil and Roberta Flashman.

At the close of the polls the ballot box read 390 voters had cast a ballot; the checkers’ lists tallied 209 Democrats, 6 Libertarians and 176 Republicans had cast ballots, plus 1 Democratic UOCAVA voter for a total of 391 voters.

Angela M. Jack, *Town Clerk*

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
WILLIAM FRANCIS GALVIN
SECRETARY OF THE COMMONWEALTH
2024 STATE ELECTION**

MIDDLESEX, SS:

To: Constable of the Town of Ashby

GREETINGS:

In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby required to notify and warn the inhabitants of said city or town who are qualified to vote in the State Election to vote at The Ashby Elementary School, 911 Main St, Ashby on **TUESDAY, THE FIFTH DAY OF NOVEMBER 2024** from 7:00 A.M. to 8:00 P.M. for the following purpose:

To cast their votes in the State Election for the candidates for the following offices and questions:

ELECTORS OF PRESIDENT AND VICE PRESIDENT	FOR THIS COMMONWEALTH
SENATOR IN CONGRESS	FOR THIS COMMONWEALTH
REPRESENTATIVE IN CONGRESS	THIRD DISTRICT
COUNCILLOR	SEVENTH DISTRICT
SENATOR IN GENERAL COURT	WORCESTER & MIDDLESEX DISTRICT
REPRESENTATIVE IN GENERAL COURT	FIRST MIDDLESEX DISTRICT
CLERK OF COURTS	MIDDLESEX COUNTY
REGISTER OF DEEDS	MIDDLESEX SOUTHERN DISTRICT

QUESTION 1: LAW PROPOSED BY INITIATIVE PETITION

Do you approve of a law summarized below, on which no vote was taken by the Senate or the House of Representatives before May 1, 2024?

SUMMARY

This proposed law would specify that the State Auditor has the authority to audit the Legislature.

A YES VOTE would specify that the State Auditor has the authority to audit the Legislature.

A NO VOTE would make no change in the law relative to the State Auditor’s authority.

QUESTION 2: LAW PROPOSED BY INITIATIVE PETITION

Do you approve of a law summarized below, on which no vote was taken by the Senate or the House of Representatives before May 1, 2024?

SUMMARY

This proposed law would eliminate the requirement that a student pass the

Massachusetts Comprehensive Assessment System (MCAS) tests (or other statewide or district-wide assessments) in mathematics, science and technology, and English in order to receive a high school diploma. Instead, in order for a student to receive a high school diploma, the proposed law would require the student to complete coursework certified by the student’s district as demonstrating mastery of the competencies contained in the state academic standards in mathematics, science and technology, and English, as well as any additional areas determined by the Board of Elementary and Secondary Education.

A YES VOTE would eliminate the requirement that students pass the Massachusetts Comprehensive Assessment System (MCAS) in order to graduate high school but still require students to complete coursework that meets state standards.

A NO VOTE would make no change in the law relative to the requirement that a student pass the MCAS in order to graduate high school.

QUESTION 3: LAW PROPOSED BY INITIATIVE PETITION

Do you approve of a law summarized below, on which no vote was taken by the Senate or the House of Representatives before May 1, 2024?

SUMMARY

The proposed law would provide Transportation Network Drivers (“Drivers”) with the right to form unions (“Driver Organizations”) to collectively bargain with Transportation Network Companies (“Companies”)-which are companies that use a digital network to connect riders to drivers for pre-arranged transportation-to create negotiated recommendations concerning wages, benefits and terms and conditions of work. Drivers would not be required to engage in any union activities. Companies would be allowed to form multicompany associations to represent them when negotiating with Driver Organizations. The state would supervise the labor activities permitted by the proposed law and would have responsibility for approving or disapproving the negotiated recommendations.

The proposed law would define certain activities by a Company or a Driver Organization to be unfair work practices. The proposed law would establish a hearing process for the state Employment Relations Board (“Board”) to follow when a Company or Driver Organization is charged with an unfair work practice. The proposed law would permit the Board to take action, including awarding compensation to adversely affected Drivers, if it found that an unfair work practice had been committed. The proposed law would provide for an appeal of a Board decision to the state Appeals Court.

This proposed law also would establish a procedure for determining which Drivers are Active Drivers, meaning that they completed more than the median number

of rides in the previous six months. The proposed law would establish procedures for the Board to determine that a Driver Organization has signed authorizations from at least five percent of Active Drivers, entitling the Driver Organization to a list of Active Drivers; to designate a Driver Organization as the exclusive bargaining representative for all Drivers based on signed authorizations from at least twenty-five percent of Active Drivers; to resolve disputes over exclusive bargaining status, including through elections; and to decertify a Driver Organization from exclusive bargaining status. A Driver Organization that has been designated the exclusive bargaining representative would have the exclusive right to represent the Drivers and to receive voluntary membership dues deductions.

Once the Board determined that a Driver Organization was the exclusive bargaining representative for all Drivers, the Companies would be required to bargain with that Driver Organization concerning wages, benefits and terms and conditions of work. Once the Driver Organization and Companies reached agreement on wages, benefits, and the terms and conditions of work, that agreement would be voted upon by all Drivers who has completed at least 100 trips the previous quarter. If approved by a majority of votes cast, the recommendations would be submitted to the state Secretary of Labor for approval and if approved, would be effective for three years.

The proposed law would establish procedures for the mediation and arbitration if the Driver Organization and Companies failed to reach agreement within a certain period of time. An arbitrator would consider factors set forth in the proposed law, including whether the wages of Drivers would be enough so that Drivers would not need to rely upon any public benefits.

The proposed law also sets out procedures for the Secretary of Labor's review and approval of recommendations negotiated by a Driver Organization and the Companies and for judicial review of the Secretary's decision. The proposed law states that neither its provisions, an agreement nor a determination by the Secretary would be able to lessen labor standards established by other laws. If there were any conflict between the proposed law and existing Massachusetts labor relations law, the proposed law would prevail.

The Board would make rules and regulations as appropriate to effectuate the proposed law.

The proposed law states that, if any of its parts were declared invalid, the other parts would stay in effect.

A YES VOTE would provide transportation network drivers the option to form unions to collectively bargain with transportation network companies regarding wages, benefits, and terms and conditions of work.

A NO VOTE would make no change in the law relative to the ability of transportation network drivers to form unions.

QUESTION 4: LAW PROPOSED BY INITIATIVE PETITION

Do you approve of a law summarized below, on which no vote was taken by the Senate or the House of Representatives before May 1, 2024?

SUMMARY

This proposed law would allow persons aged 21 and older to grow, possess, and use certain natural psychedelic substances in certain circumstances. The psychedelic substances allowed would be two substances found in mushrooms (psilocybin and psilocyn) and three substances found in plants (dimethyltryptamine, mescaline, and ibogaine). These substances could be purchased at an approved location for use under the supervision of a licensed facilitator. This proposed law would otherwise prohibit any retail sale of natural psychedelic substances. This proposed law would also provide for the regulation and taxation of these psychedelic substances.

This proposed law would license and regulate facilities offering supervised use of these psychedelic substances and provide for the taxation of proceeds from those facilities' sales of psychedelic substances. It would also allow persons aged 21 and older to grow these psychedelic substances in a 12-foot by 12-foot area at their home and use these psychedelic substances at their home. This proposed law would authorize persons aged 21 or older to possess up to one gram of psilocybin, one gram of psilocyn, one gram of dimethyltryptamine, 18 grams of mescaline, and 30 grams of ibogaine ("personal use amount"), in addition to whatever they might grow at their home, and to give away up to the personal use amount to a person aged 21 or over.

This proposed law would create a Natural Psychedelic Substances Commission of five members appointed by the Governor, Attorney General, and Treasurer which would administer the law governing the use and distribution of these psychedelic substances. The Commission would adopt regulations governing licensing qualifications, security, recordkeeping, education and training, health and safety requirements, testing, and age verification. This proposed law would also create a Natural Psychedelic Substances Advisory Board of 20 members appointed by the Governor, Attorney General, and Treasurer which would study and make recommendations to the Commission on the regulation and taxation of these psychedelic substances.

This proposed law would allow cities and towns to reasonably restrict the time, place, and manner of the operation of licensed facilities offering psychedelic substances, but cities and towns could not ban those facilities or their provision of these substances.

The proceeds of sales of psychedelic substances at licensed facilities would be subject to the state sales tax and an additional excise tax of 15 percent. In addition, a city or town could impose a separate tax of up to two percent. Revenue received from the additional state excise tax, license application fees, and civil penalties for violations of this proposed law would be deposited in a Natural Psychedelic Substances

Regulation Fund and would be used, subject to appropriation, for administration of this proposed law.

Using the psychedelic substances as permitted by this proposed law could not be a basis to deny a person medical care or public assistance, impose discipline by a professional licensing board, or enter adverse orders in child custody cases absent clear and convincing evidence that the activities created an unreasonable danger to the safety of a minor child.

This proposed law would not affect existing laws regarding the operation of motor vehicles while under the influence, or the ability of employers to enforce workplace policies restricting the consumption of these psychedelic substances by employees. This proposed law would allow property owners to prohibit the use, display, growing, processing, or sale of these psychedelic substances on their premises. State and local governments could continue to restrict the possession and use of these psychedelic substances in public buildings or at schools. This proposed law would take effect on December 15, 2024.

A YES VOTE would allow persons over age 21 to use certain natural psychedelic substances under licensed supervision and to grow and possess limited quantities of those substances in their home, and would create a commission to regulate those substances.

A NO VOTE would make no change in the law regarding natural psychedelic substances.

QUESTION 5: LAW PROPOSED BY INITIATIVE PETITION

Do you approve of a law summarized below, on which no vote was taken by the Senate or the House of Representatives before May 1, 2024?

SUMMARY

This proposed law would gradually increase the minimum hourly wage an employer must pay a tipped worker, over the course of five years, on the following schedule:

- To 64% of the state minimum wage on January 1, 2025;
- To 73% of the state minimum wage on January 1, 2026;
- To 82% of the state minimum wage on January 1, 2027;
- To 91% of the state minimum wage on January 1, 2028; and
- To 100% of the state minimum wage on January 1, 2029.

The proposed law would require employers to continue to pay tipped workers the difference between the state minimum wage and the total amount a tipped worker receives in hourly wages plus tips through the end of 2028. The proposed law would also permit employers to calculate this difference over the entire weekly or bi-weekly

payroll period. The requirement to pay this difference would cease when the required hourly wage for tipped workers would become 100% of the state minimum wage on January 1, 2029.

Under the proposed law, if an employer pays its workers an hourly wage that is at least the state minimum wage, the employer would be permitted to administer a “tip pool” that combines all the tips given by customers to tipped workers and distributes them among all the workers, including non-tipped workers.

A YES VOTE would increase the minimum hourly wage an employer must pay a tipped worker to the full state minimum wage implemented over five years, at which point employers could pool all tips and distribute them to all non-management workers.

A NO VOTE would make no change in the law governing tip pooling or the minimum wage for tipped workers.

Hereof fail not and make return of this warrant with your doings thereon at the time and place of said voting.

Given under our hands this ____ day of October 2024.

_____ David Nadeau, Chair	_____ Doug Leab, Clerk	_____ Jessica Kallin, Member
ASHBY SELECTBOARD		

By virtue of this precept, I have posted three (3) attested copies of the foregoing warrant in three (3) public places in said Ashby at least seven days before the time of the State Election.

DATE: _____
Derek Pepple, Police Chief

RESULTS OF STATE ELECTION
November 5, 2024

The warrant was returned to the Town Clerk at 6:15AM.

Election officers on duty and duly sworn were as follows: Betty Tiilikkala, Joyce Hopkins, Angie Godin, Tracey Robinson-Harris, Deb Theall, Sandi Heyes, June McNeil, Emma Jack, Linda Stacy, Katie Marsh, and Jill Niemi

The polls opened at 7:00 AM.

The following is a list of candidates as they appeared on the official ballot along with the question numbers, the votes each received and the total blanks:

	VOTES
ELECTORS OF PRESIDENT AND VICE PRESIDENT	
AYYADARAI and ELLIS	8
DE LA CRUZ and GARCIA	5
HARRIS and WALZ	936
OLIVER and TER MAAT	13
STEIN and CABALLERO-ROCA	11
TRUMP and VANCE	1009
All Others	0
Blanks	21
Total Ballots Cast	2003

	VOTES
SENATOR IN CONGRESS	
ELIZABETH ANN WARREN	853
JOHN DEATON	1112
All Others	0
Blanks	38
Total Ballots Cast	2003

REPRESENTATIVE IN CONGRESS	
LORI LOUREIRO TRAHAN	1329
All Others	0
Blanks	674
Total Ballots Cast	2003

COUNCILOR	
PAUL M. DePALO	834
ANDREW J. COUTURE	1035
All Others	0
Blanks	134
Total Ballots Cast	2003

SENATOR IN GENERAL COURT	
JOHN J. CRONIN	980
NICHOLAS A. PIRRO, III	938
All Others	0
Blanks	85
Total Ballots Cast	2003
REPRESENTATIVE IN GENERAL COURT	
MARGARET R. SCARSDALE	914
LYNNE E. ARCHAMBAULT	1017
All Others	0
Blanks	72
Total Ballots Cast	2003
CLERK OF COURTS	
MICHAEL A. SULLIVAN	1307
All Others	0
Blanks	696
Total Ballots Cast	2003
REGISTER OF DEEDS	
MARIA C. CURTATONE	929
WILLIAM "BILLY" TAURO	801
All Others	0
Blanks	273
Total Ballots Cast	2003
QUESTION 1	
YES	1375
NO	519
Blanks	109
Total Ballots Cast	2003
QUESTION 2	
YES	1227
NO	729

Blanks	47
Total Ballots Cast	2003

QUESTION 3

YES	928
NO	985
Blanks	90
Total Ballots Cast	2003

QUESTION 4

YES	841
NO	1086
Blanks	76
Total Ballots Cast	2003

QUESTION 5

YES	482
NO	1444
Blanks	77
Total Ballots Cast	2003

The polls closed at 8:00 PM.

Tellers on duty and duly sworn in were as follows: Pam Peeler, Deb Pillsbury, Emma Jack, Katie Marsh, Dan Dufour, Roberta Flashman, Tracy Robinson-Harris, Teresa Nagle, Susan Peinkofer, Sandi Heyes, Jill Niemi, Patricia Wayrynen, Mary Ann Allen, Dawn Roy, June McNeil, Deb Theall, Angie Godin, Nancy Richards, Matthew Carmack, Brendan McNeil, Martha Morgan, Michael Harrison, Neal Anderson, Terri Cantor, Ava McNeil, and Barbara Thorpe.

At the close of polls, the ballot box read 2035 voters had cast a ballot (The ballot box had overcounted by a total of 46 times due to the ballots getting jammed while being inserted. This was most likely due to the thickness of the ballots. This was properly recorded throughout the day and the actual number that should have shown on the box was 1989); the checkers' lists tallied 1989 voters had cast ballots on election day (483 mail-in ballots, 205 in-person early ballots, 10 absentee ballots and 1291 election day ballots), plus 10 UOCAVA voters, 2 provisional ballots and 2 ballots arriving after election day but postmarked by 11/5 for a total of 2003 total voters.

Angela M. Jack, *Town Clerk*

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
SPECIAL TOWN MEETING**

Middlesex ss:

To the Constable of the Town of Ashby in said County

Greeting:

In the name of the Commonwealth, you are hereby directed to notify and warn the inhabitants of the Town of Ashby qualified to vote in elections and town affairs, to meet at the Ashby Elementary School Gymnasium, 911 Main Street in said Ashby, Tuesday, December 3, 2024 at 6:30 PM, to act on the following articles:

ARTICLE 1: To see if the Town will vote to rescind that portion of the vote taken under Article 9 of the May 4, 2024 Annual Town Meeting appropriating the sum of \$675,262.00 from free cash to defray the expenses of the Town for the fiscal year commencing July 1, 2025 and to rescind the vote taken under Article 1 of the May 4, 2024 Special Town Meeting appropriating the sum of \$50,103.49 from free cash to extinguish the deficit incurred in the Winter Operations budget for Fiscal Year 2024; and further to appropriate from certified free cash the sum of \$675,262.00 to defray the expenses of the Town for the fiscal year commencing July 1, 2025 and the sum of \$50,103.49 to meet the deficit incurred in the Winter Operations budget for Fiscal Year 2024; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

ARTICLE 2: To see if the Town will vote to increase the demand for delinquent real estate, personal property and motor vehicle bills from \$5.00 to \$15.00, pursuant to the provisions of MGL Chapter 60, Section 15(2), which authorizes such fees for each written demand provided for by law, so long as the fee does not exceed \$30.00; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

ARTICLE 3: To see what sum of money the Town will vote to appropriate from available funds for the purpose of operating the Ashby PEG Access Department for FY25; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

ARTICLE 4: To see if the Town will vote to transfer from available funds a sum of money to meet the deficit incurred in the operation of the Ashby Recycling Center and Transfer Station (ARCTS) for FY24; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

ARTICLE 5: To see if the Town will vote to transfer from free cash the sum of

\$4,134.80 to pay for invoices received for services rendered in Fiscal Year 2024 for Software Licensing; or take any other action relative thereto.

- SHI International Corp. \$4,134.80

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

ARTICLE 6: To see if the Town will vote to appropriate the sum of \$10,500 from free cash, to be added to the FY 2025 Police Budget wages line item, to fund the cost items of the first fiscal year of a Collective Bargaining Agreement between the Town and the Ashby Police Patrolman's Association Local 385, which has a term of July 1, 2025 through June 30, 2027; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

ARTICLE 7: To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$3,200.00 from the Police Department FY 25 expense line-item for College Reimbursement to a new Police Department FY 25 expense line-item for College Incentive Expenses; or take any other action relative thereto.

Selectboard Action: _____ Approved _____ Disapproved _____ No Action

And you are hereby directed to serve this warrant by posting an attested copy in at least three (3) public places in said Ashby, fourteen (14) days at least before the holding of said meeting. Hereof fail not, and make due return of this warrant with your doings thereon to the Town Clerk at the time and place of meeting aforesaid.

Given under our hands this _____ day of November, 2024.

TOWN OF ASHBY SELECTBOARD

David Nadeau, Chair

Doug Leab, Clerk

Jessica Kallin, Member

By virtue of this precept, I have posted three (3) attested copies of the foregoing warrant in three (3) public places in Ashby at least fourteen days before the time of said Special Town Meeting.

DATE: _____
Derek Pepple, Chief of Police

**RESULTS OF THE SPECIAL TOWN MEETING
December 3, 2024**

The warrant was returned to the Town Clerk at 5:15 PM.

With a quorum present, the Moderator Nancy Chew called the meeting to order at 6:49 PM.

The warrant showed it was properly served.

The rules of the meeting were read.

The motion was made and seconded to waive the reading of the warrant, and so voted.

Article 1. A motion was made and seconded that Article 1 be approved as written in the warrant with references to the fiscal year commencing on July 1, 2025 being amended to reference the fiscal year commencing on July 1, 2024.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 2. A motion was made and seconded that Article 2 be approved as written in the warrant.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 3. A motion was made and seconded that \$15,000 be transferred from the PEG Access Account and appropriated for the purpose of operating the Ashby PEG Access Apartment for the current fiscal year 2025.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 4. A motion was made and seconded that \$10,000 be transferred from certified free cash and appropriated to supplement the FY25 budget for the operations of the Ashby Recycling Center and Transfer Station (ARCTS).

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 5. A motion was made and seconded that Article 5 be approved as written in the warrant.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 6. A motion was made and seconded that Article 6 be approved as written in the warrant.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Article 7. A motion was made and seconded that Article 7 be approved as written in the warrant.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

The motion was made and seconded to dissolve the Special Town Meeting at 6:55 PM.

VOTE: UNANIMOUS

Angela M. Jack, *Town Clerk*

BALLOT FOR ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION APRIL 28, 2025

Moderator, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
Nancy E. Chew, Candidate for Re-Election	
775 Piper Rd	

Selectboard, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
Paul F. Lasorsa	
239 Turnpike Rd	

Town Clerk, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
Angela M. Jack, Candidate for Re-Election	
98 Heywood Rd	

Treasurer, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
Kate E. Stacy, Candidate for Re-Election	
75 Frost Rd	

Board of Assessors, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
Charles E. Perna, Candidate for Re-Election	
571 Jones Hill Rd	

Board of Health, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
Cedwyn D. Morgan, Candidate for Re-Election	
593 Erickson Rd	

NMRSD Committee, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
Keri-Anne Mahoney	
391 Frost Rd	

Constable, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
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Planning Board, Five Years	VOTE FOR ONE
Patricia E. Foster, Candidate for Re-Election	
735 Mason Rd	

Cemetery Commissioner, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
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Parks Commissioner, Three Years	VOTE FOR ONE
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Library Trustee, Three Years
Deirdre Haynie, Candidate for Re-Election
570 Richardson Rd

VOTE FOR THREE

Jane E. Pankosky, Candidate for Re-Election
51 Piper Rd

Amy F. Redder
460 South Rd

Finance Committee, Three Years

VOTE FOR TWO

Question #1

Shall the Town vote to have its elected Treasurer and elected Collector become an appointed Treasurer-Collector of the Town?

☐ YES

☐ NO